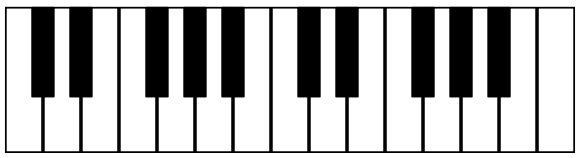
Read at Sight

A graded sight-reading course for piano

Volume 1 - First Steps



Middle C

Hundreds of short, new exercises at exactly your level,
with tips, checkpoints and real pieces along the way.

Exercises generated to graded rules; pieces are original or public domain.

How to use this book

Why this book is built this way

You get better at sight-reading by reading a lot of new music that is easy for you, not by struggling through hard pieces. So every unit gives you many short exercises that use only what you have learned so far, plus a few real pieces.

The five rules

1. Never stop: keep the beat going, even after a wrong note. 2. Count out loud and use a metronome at the speed shown. 3. Keep your eyes on the music, not your hands. 4. Read the shape: up, down, or the same, and by how much. 5. Play each exercise once, tick its box, and move on. Come back only after a few weeks.

Before every exercise: 10 seconds

Check the clef and time signature. Find the first note and its finger number. Scan for the highest and lowest note, and for any bar that repeats an earlier one. Then count one bar in and play.

How each unit is laid out

A unit opens with what is new, a keyboard picture of the hand position, and reading tips. Then come Parts A, B and C, which grow slightly harder. Pieces come next, and the unit ends with a checkpoint that tells you when to move on.

A daily routine (15-20 minutes)

Warm up by playing the five notes of the hand position up and down, saying their names (2 minutes). Read 6-10 new exercises, one pass each (10 minutes). Play one piece, aiming for steady and musical (5 minutes).

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Each unit adds exactly one new idea to everything before it.

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Both thumbs on middle C; notes near the middle of the grand staff

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Moving the hands to G; fourths and fifths

Unit 9 Eighth Notes 105
Two eighths per beat; counting 1-and-2-and

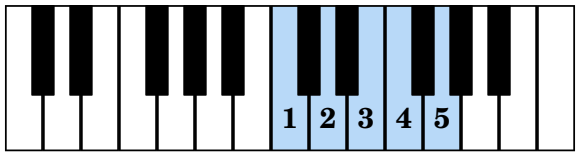
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Unit 1

The Right Hand Finds Its Home

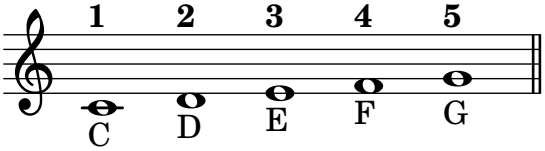
New: Treble clef, right hand C position, whole / half / quarter notes, 4/4

In this unit your right hand learns its first home on the keyboard: the C position. Put your right thumb (finger 1) on middle C and let fingers 2, 3, 4 and 5 rest on the next four white keys: D, E, F and G. Your hand does not move for the whole unit, so every note you read is already under a finger.



Right hand C position: finger numbers on the keys

Your five notes



What is new

The treble clef

The curl of the treble clef wraps around the second line from the bottom. That line is G, the note under your little finger.

Middle C

Middle C sits on its own short line (a ledger line) just below the treble staff. It is your thumb.

Lines and spaces

Notes alternate line, space, line, space as they go up: C (ledger line), D (space under the staff), E (bottom line), F (first space), G (second line).

Note values

Whole note = 4 beats (open, no stem). Half note = 2 beats (open, with stem). Quarter note = 1 beat (filled in, with stem).

4/4 time

The top 4 means four beats in every bar. Count 1 - 2 - 3 - 4 out loud, steadily, in every bar.

Reading tips

1. Read the direction, not the names. Ask: does the next note go up, down, or stay the same? A step goes from a line to the very next space (or space to line), and is always the next finger.

2. Keep your eyes on the page. Your fingers already sit on the right keys, so there is no need to look down.

3. Count out loud and never stop. If you play a wrong note, keep going: the beat matters more than the note.

4. Before each exercise, take 10 seconds: find the starting note and finger, then scan for where the line goes up and where it goes down.

Part A: Whole and half notes ♩ = 60

Long notes only: whole notes (4 beats) and half notes (2 beats). Set the metronome to 60 and count every beat aloud.

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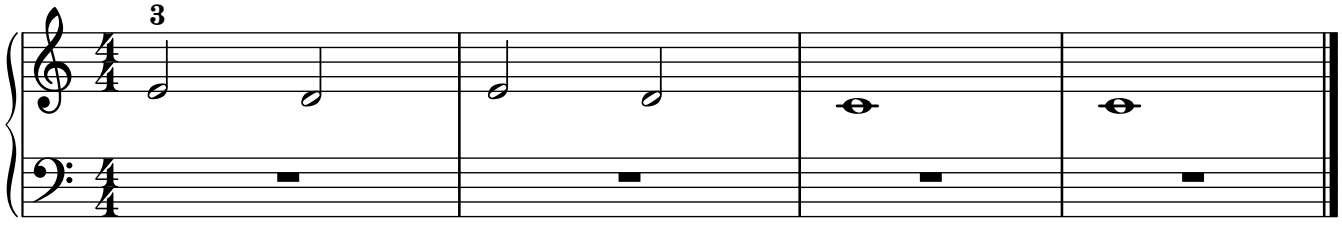
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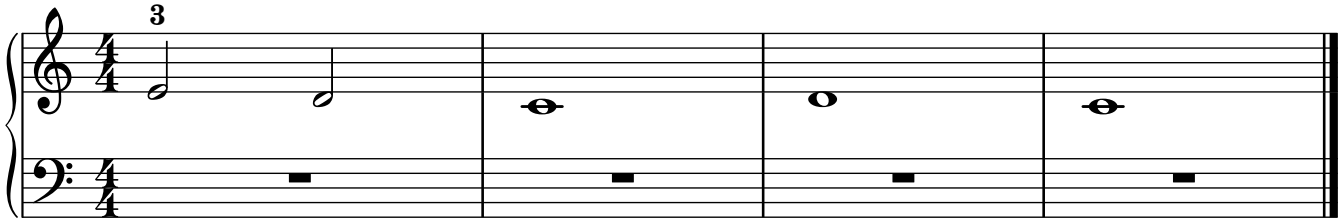
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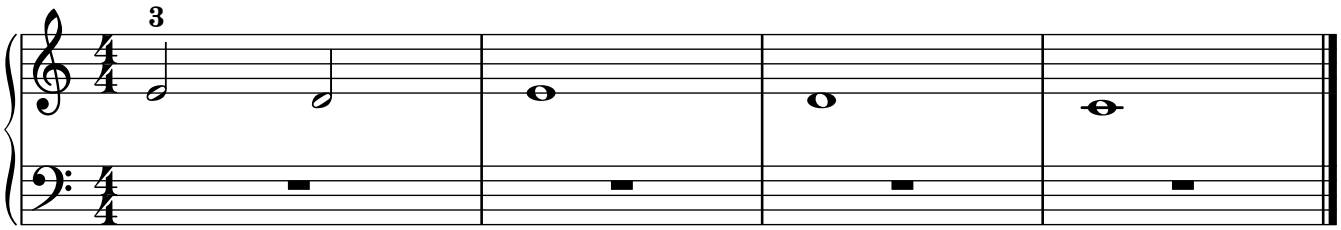
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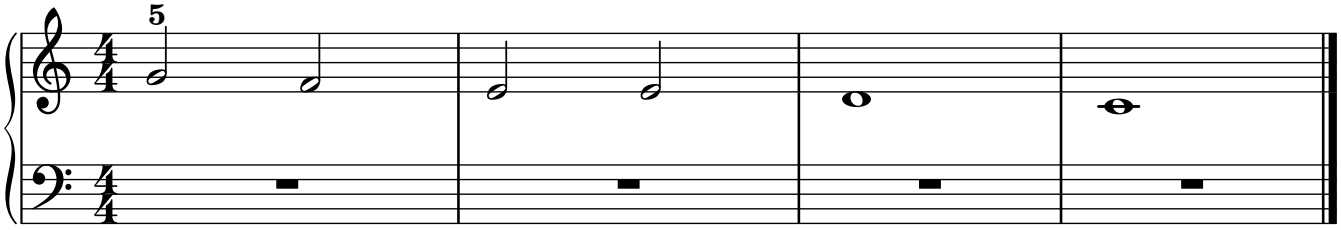
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☐ **1.7**



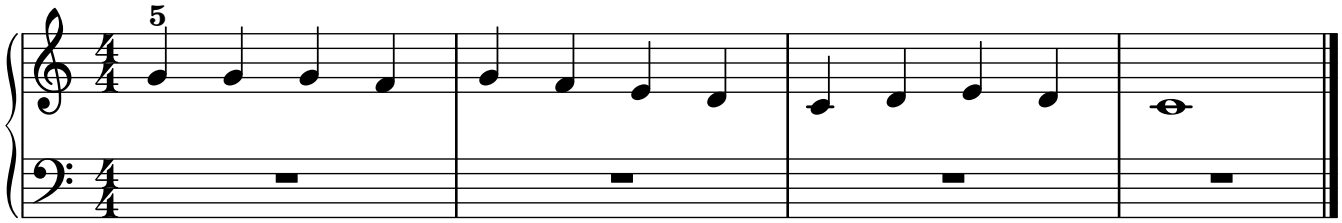
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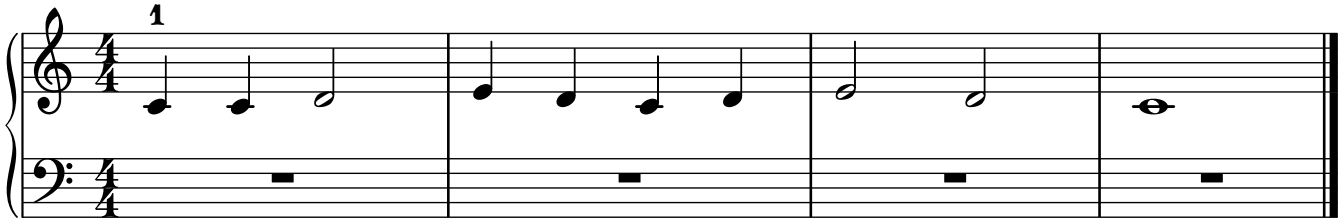
Part B: Quarter notes join in ♩ = 60

Now quarter notes (1 beat) join in. Keep the same steady 60. Notice how many exercises move in steps of a single finger.

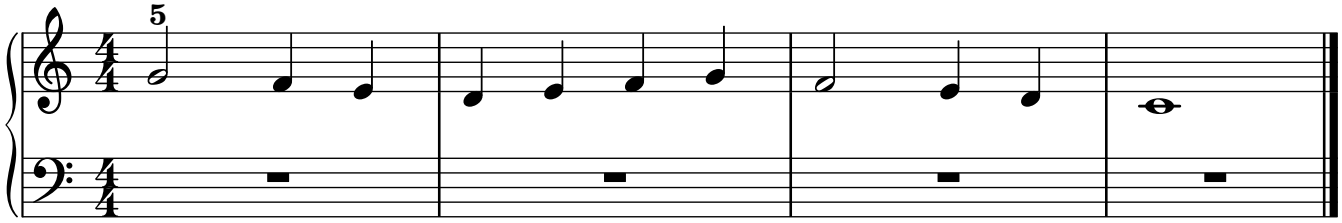
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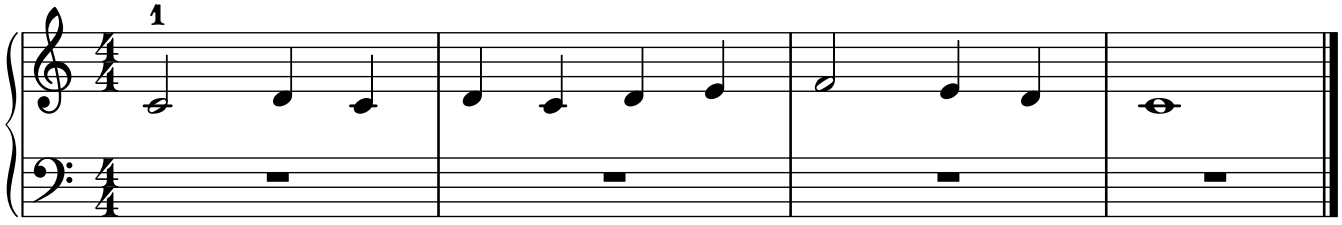
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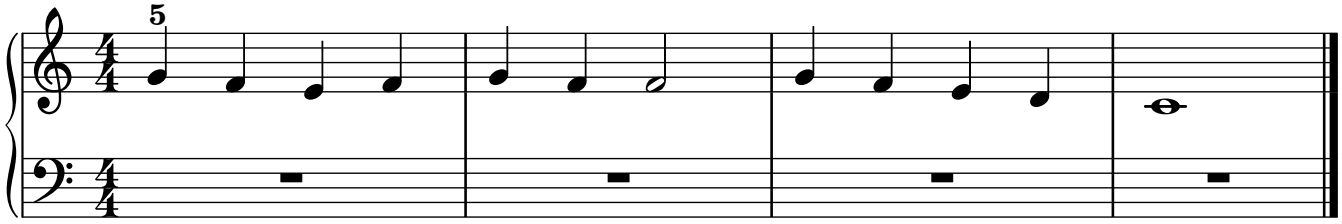
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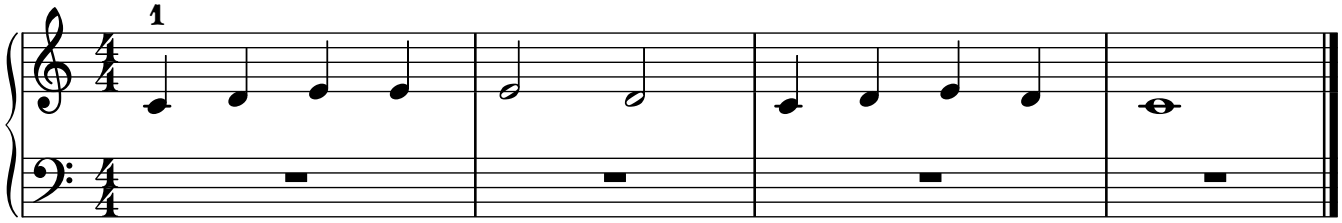
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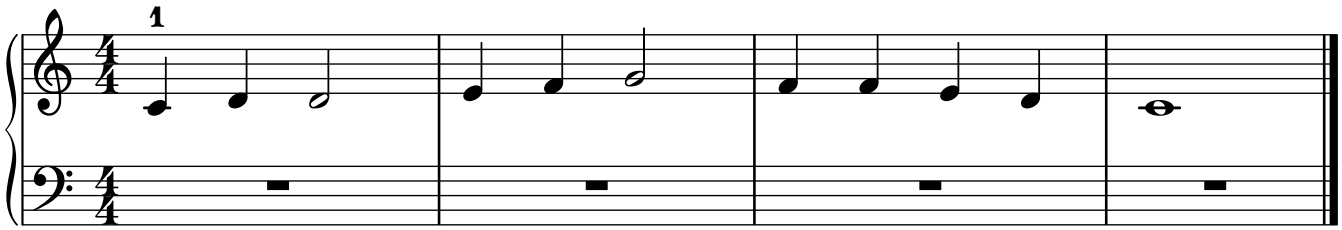
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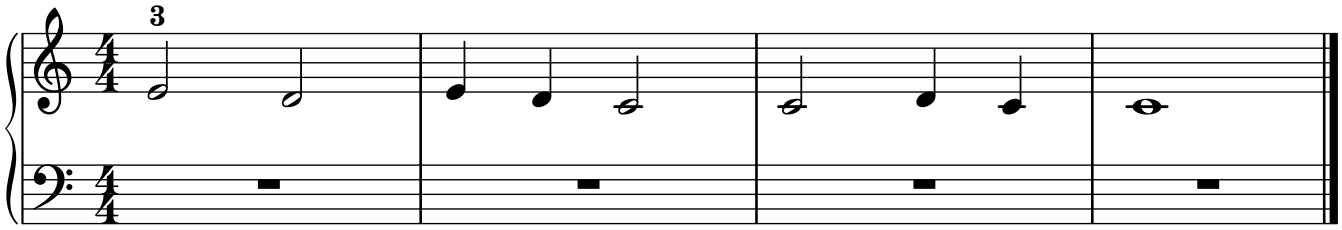
☐ **1.14**



☐ **1.15**



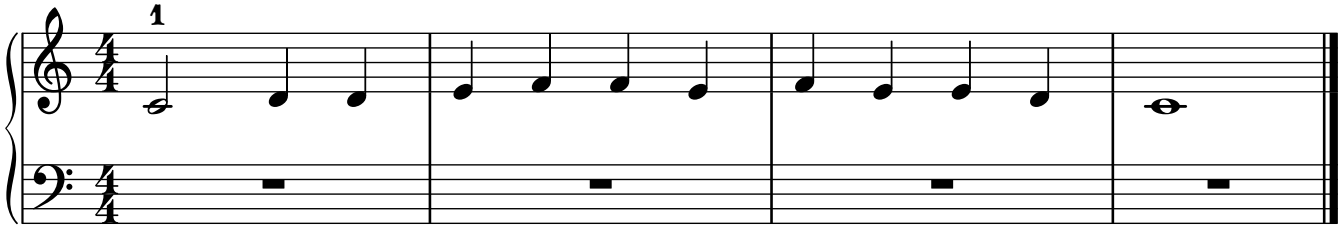
☐ **1.16**



☐ **1.17**



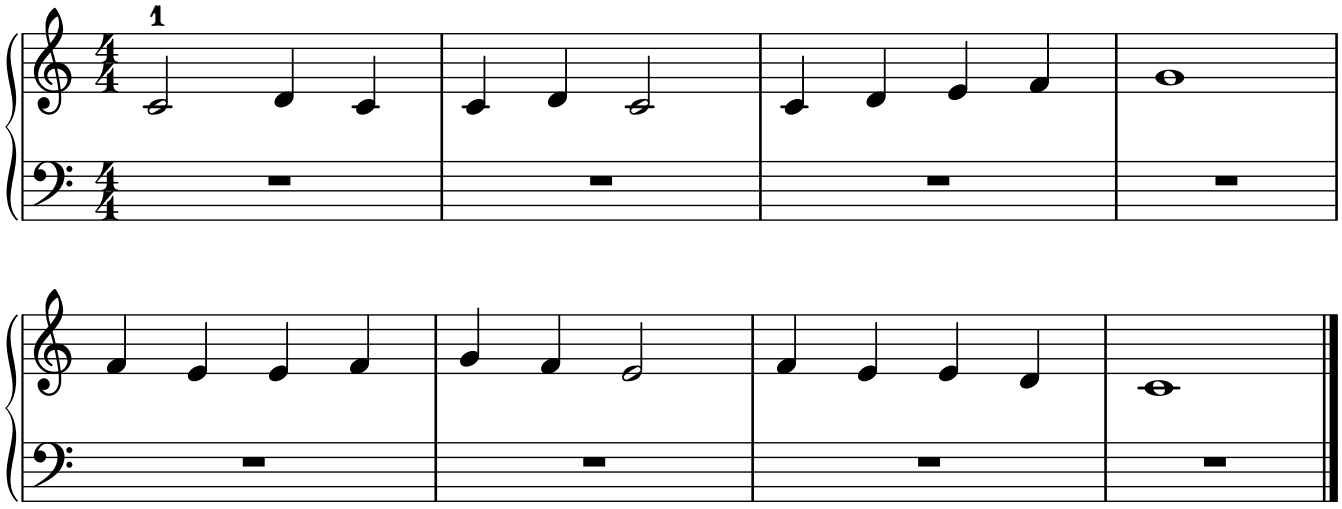
☐ **1.18**



Part C: Eight-bar phrases ♩ = 66

Eight-bar phrases, written on two lines. Look for bars that repeat: many phrases restart in bar 5 the same way they began in bar 1. Spotting a repeat means less to read.

☐ **1.19**



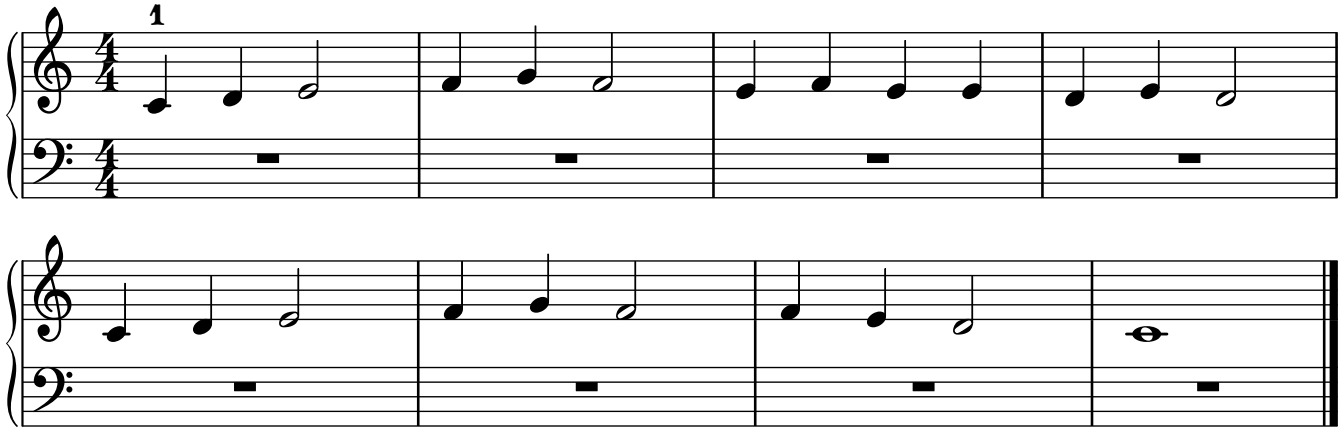
☐ **1.20**



☐ **1.21**



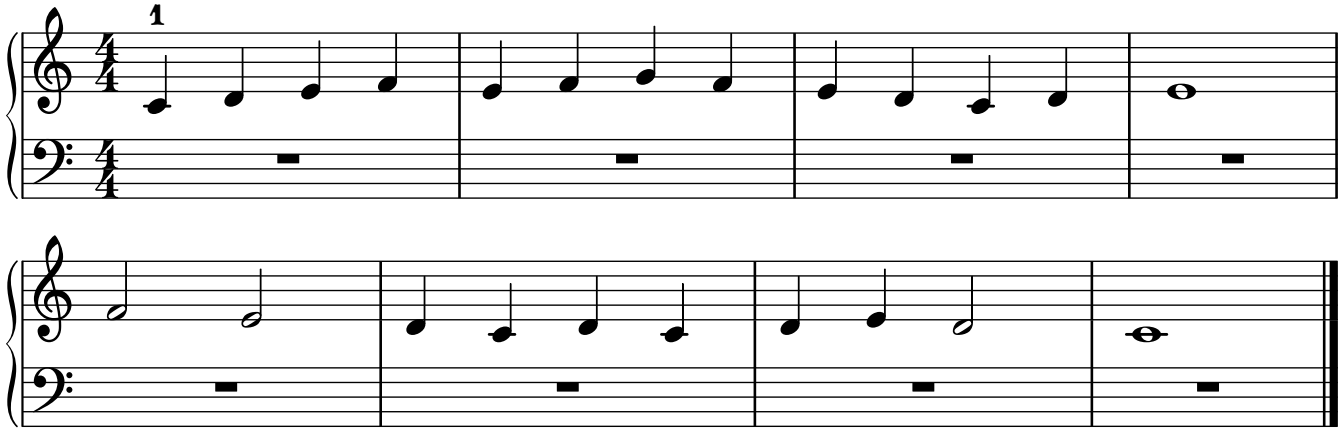
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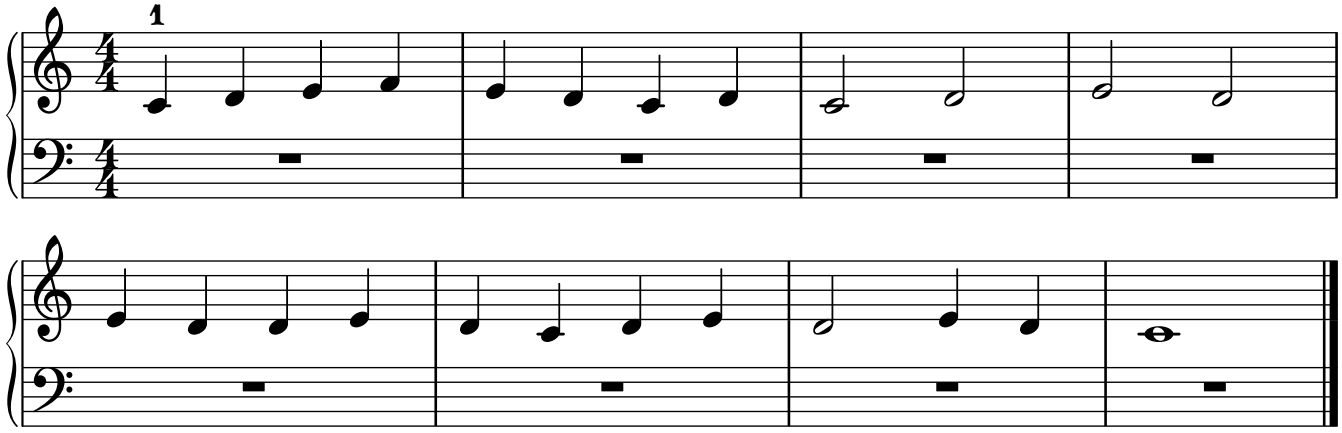
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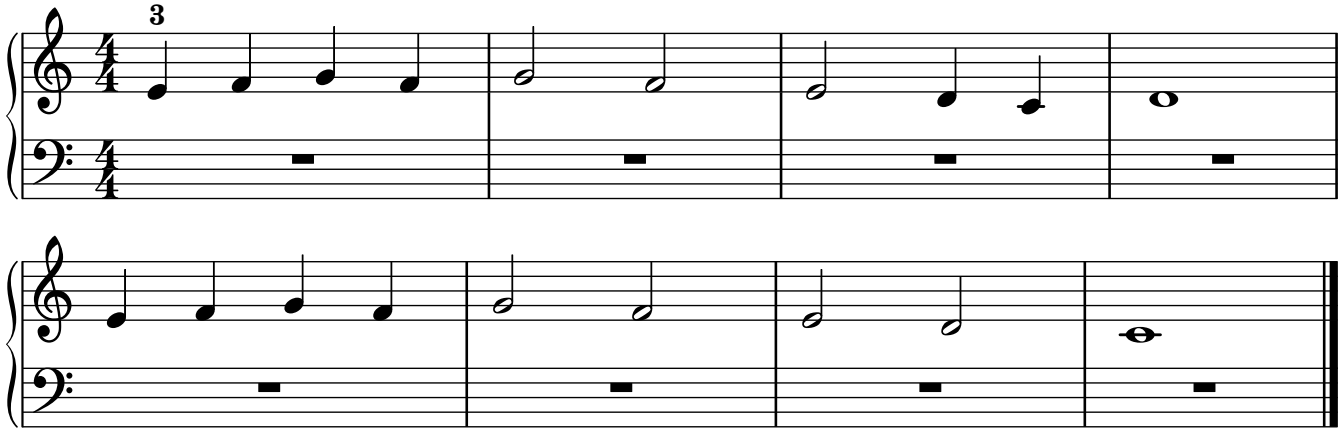
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1.30



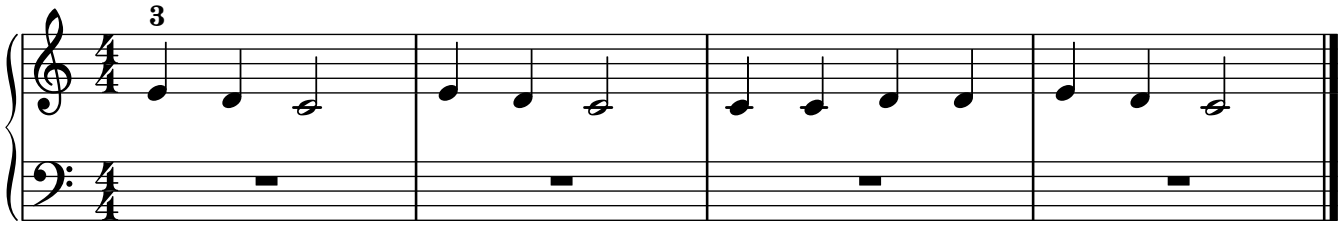
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Hot Cross Buns ♩ = 72

Traditional (bar 3 simplified to quarter notes)

Three notes, one pattern. Bars 1, 2 and 4 are almost the same. One new move: after each C, skip back up to E (finger 1 to finger 3).



First Steps ♩ = 72

Original

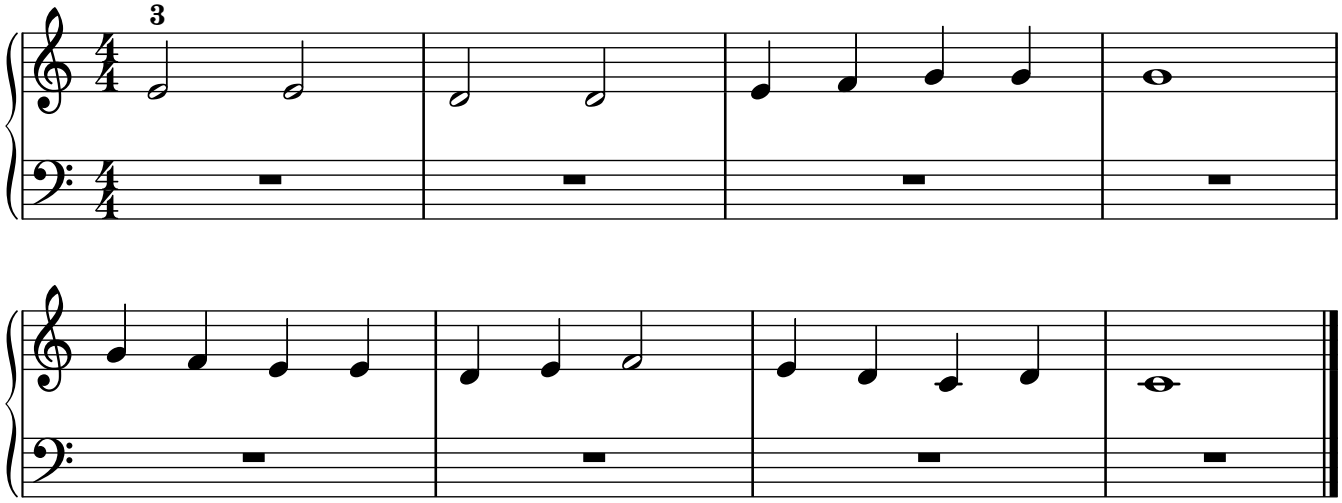
A question (bars 1-4) and an answer (bars 5-8). The answer starts exactly like the question.



Seesaw ♩ = 76

Original

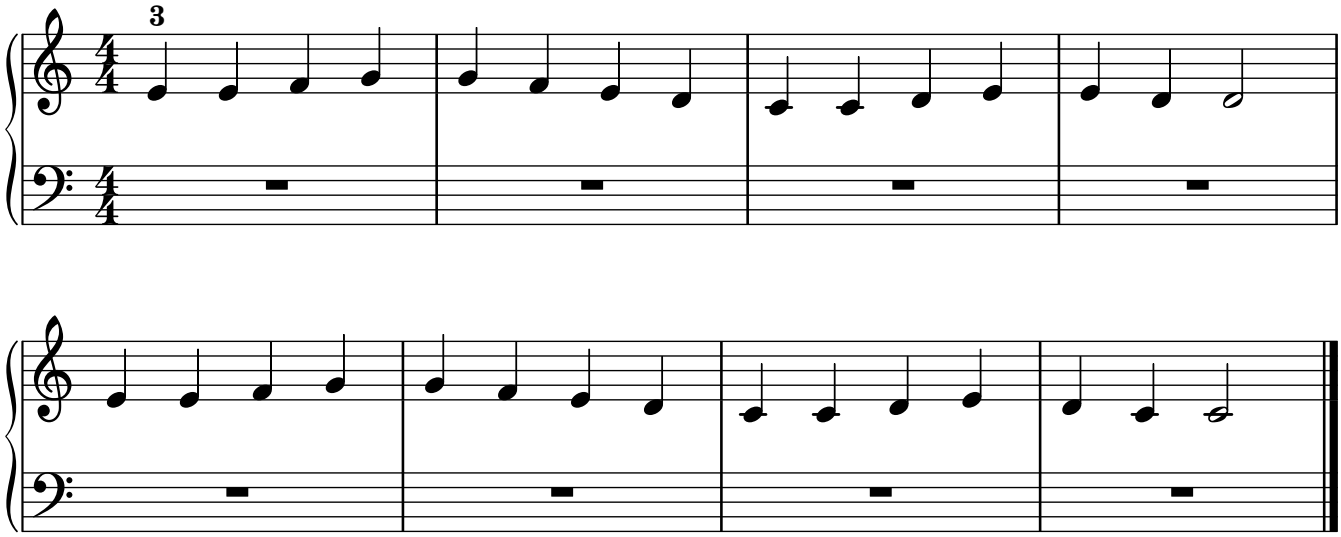
Repeated notes stay on the same line or space. Keep the half notes full: count 1 - 2, 3 - 4.



Ode to Joy ♩ = 80

Ludwig van Beethoven (1824), simplified

The famous theme from the Ninth Symphony uses only your five C-position notes. Bars 1-3 and 5-7 are identical; only the endings differ.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 2?

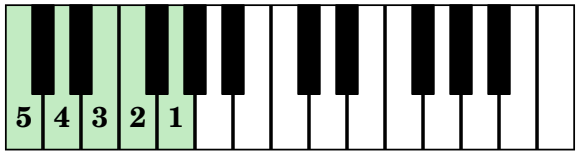
- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 66 beats per minute.
- Pass if you keep the beat going to the end of each one, with no more than one stop per exercise.
- Pass if at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 2. If not, play Part B and C exercises again in a week; by then you will have forgotten them.

Unit 2

The Left Hand and the Bass Clef

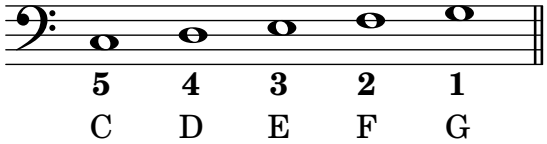
New: Bass clef, left hand C position (C3-G3)

Now the left hand gets its own home. Put your left little finger (finger 5) on the C one octave below middle C, and let fingers 4, 3, 2 and 1 rest on D, E, F and G. Your thumb ends up on G, a little below middle C. The left hand reads from the lower staff, which uses the bass clef.



Left hand C position: finger numbers on the keys

Your five notes



What is new

The bass clef

The bass clef is also called the F clef: its two dots sit on either side of the fourth line from the bottom. That line is F, the note under your finger 2.

Your five notes

C sits in the second space, D on the middle line, E in the third space, F on the fourth line (between the clef dots) and G in the top space.

Left-hand finger numbers

Thumb is still finger 1, so in the left hand the numbers run the other way: going up the keyboard means 5, 4, 3, 2, 1.

A new staff, not a copy

The bass staff is not the treble staff moved down. The bottom line is G in the bass clef but E in the treble clef. Learn the bass notes as a new set, from their own landmarks.

Reading tips

1. Use two landmarks: F is the line between the clef's dots, and C is the space just below the middle line. Read everything else as a step up or down from one of them.

2. Higher on the staff still means further to the right on the keyboard. In the left hand that means a smaller finger number.

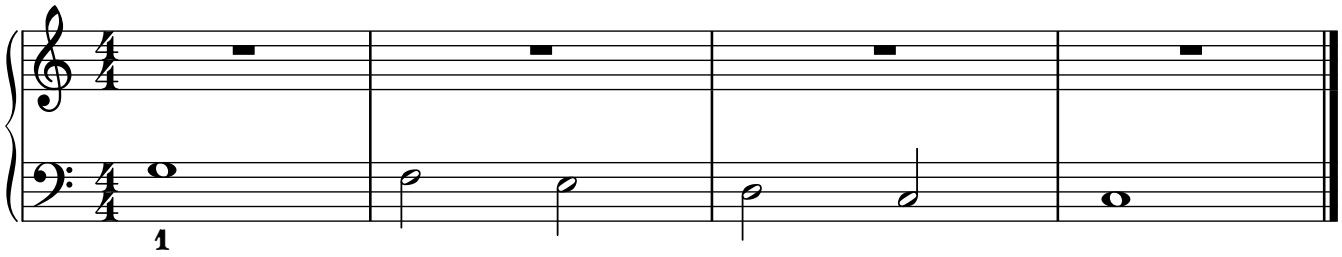
3. Never work a bass note out by thinking of the treble clef. That habit makes the bass clef slow for years. Go straight from the line or space to the key.

4. Keep the beat going and your eyes on the page, exactly as in Unit 1.

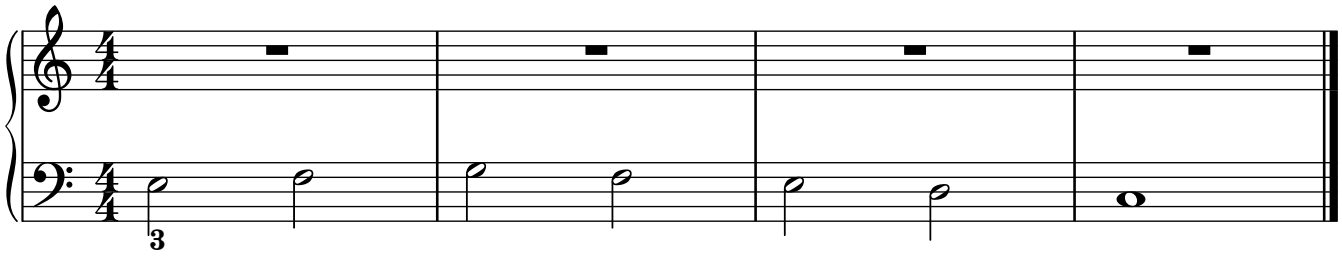
Part A: Long notes in the bass ♩= 60

Whole and half notes in the bass clef. Metronome at 60; count every beat aloud. Say the finger number as you play if it helps.

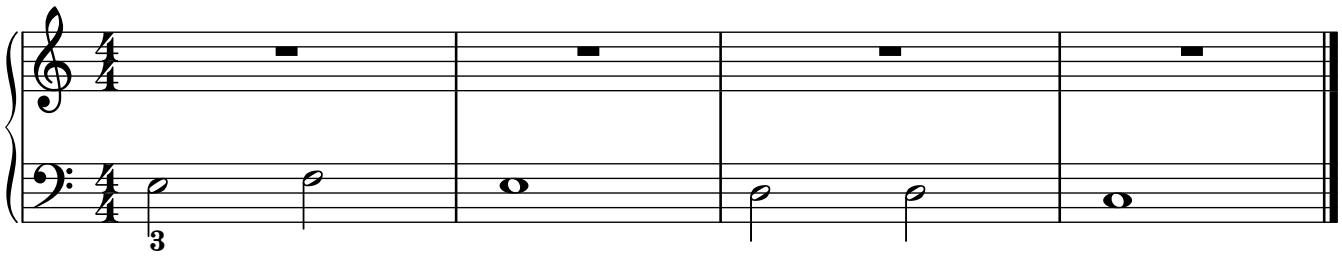
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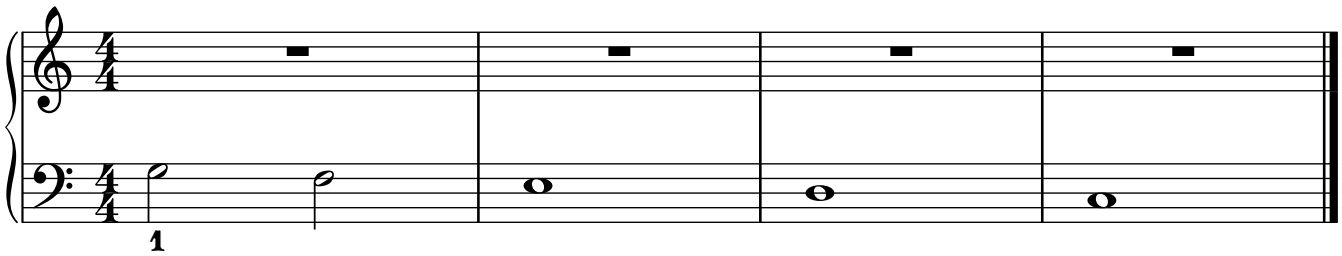
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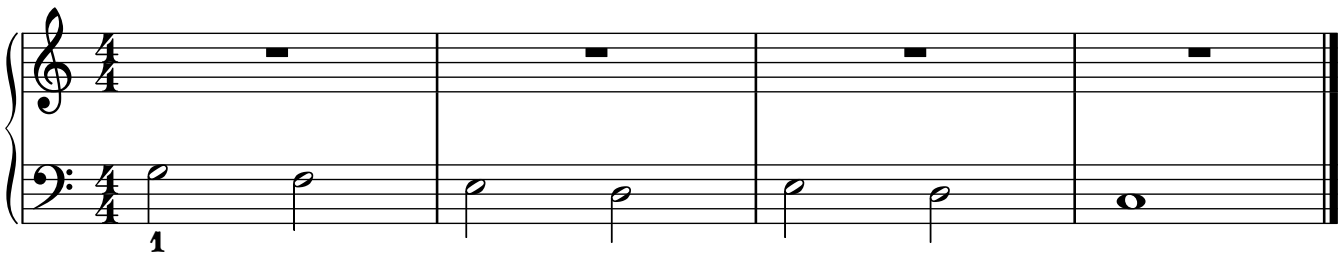
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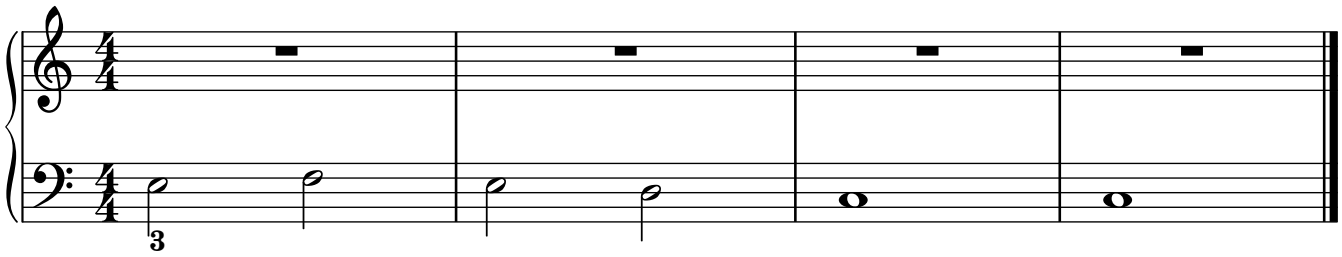
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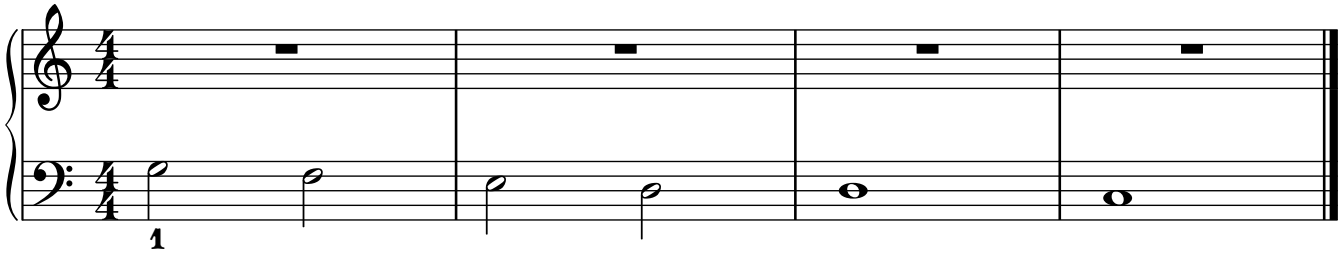
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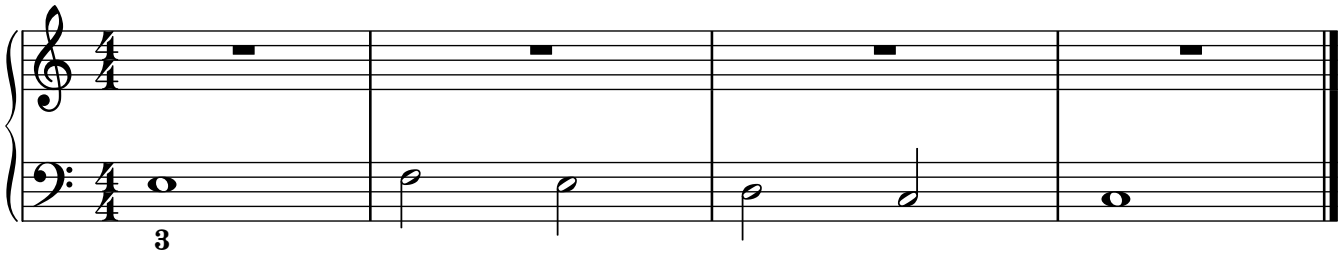
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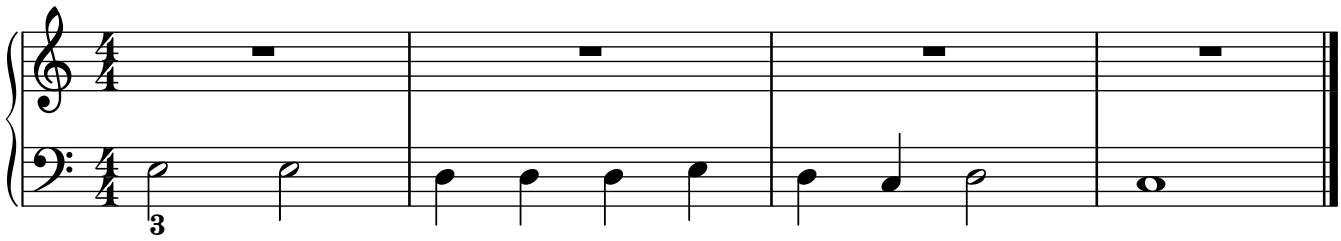
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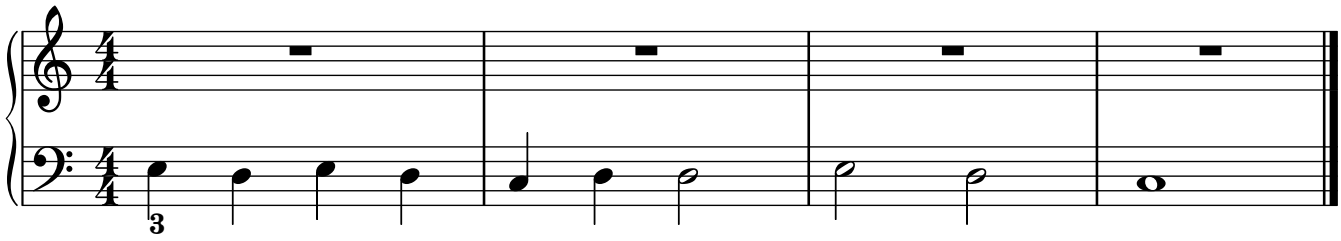
Part B: Quarter notes in the bass ♩ = 60

Quarter notes join in. Watch for runs of steps: they are always the next finger.

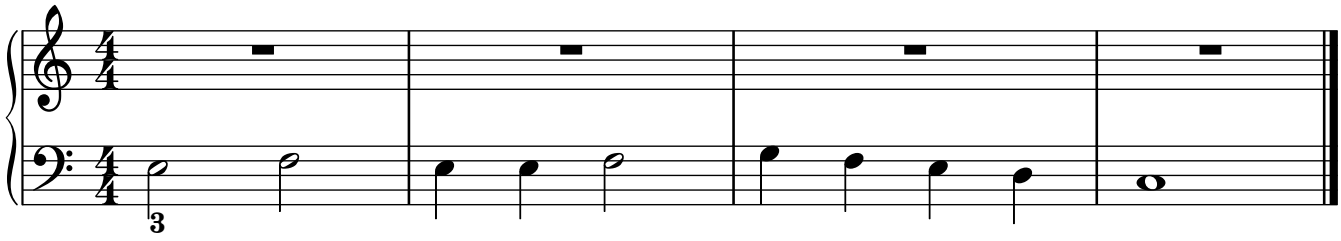
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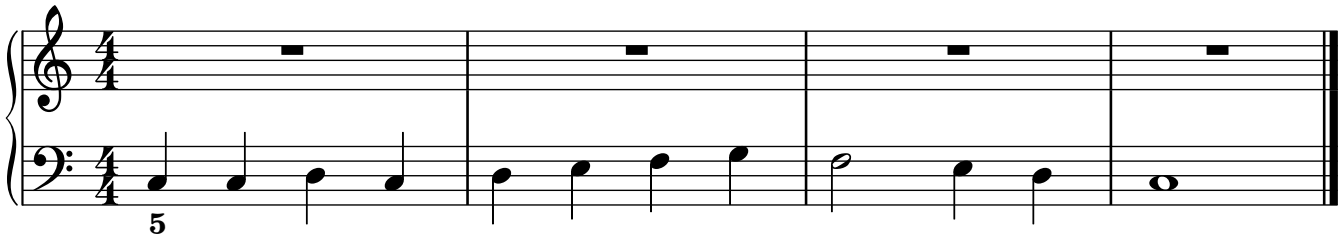
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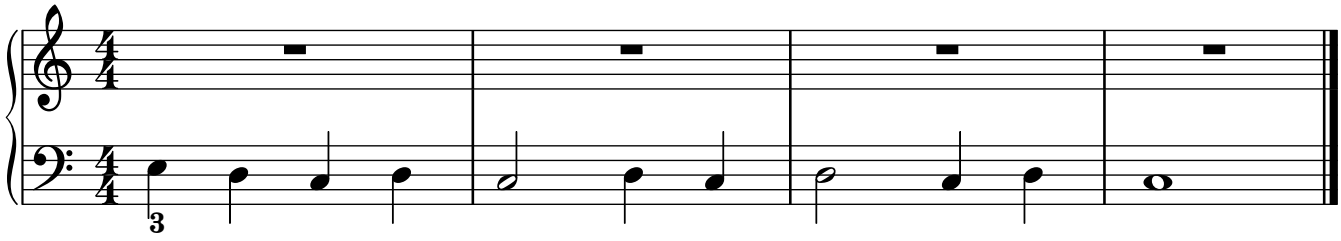
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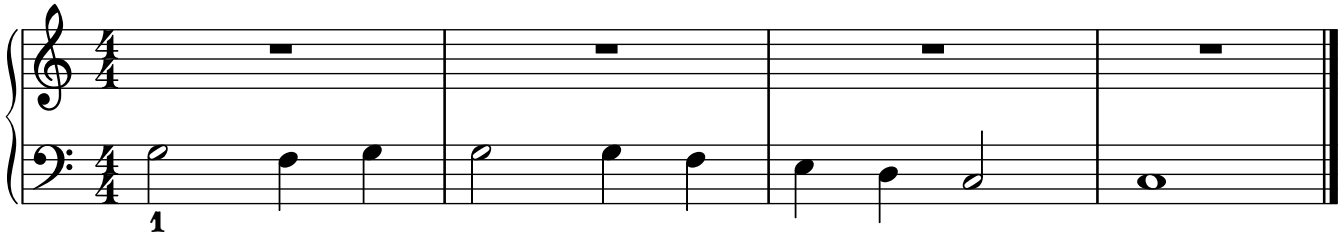
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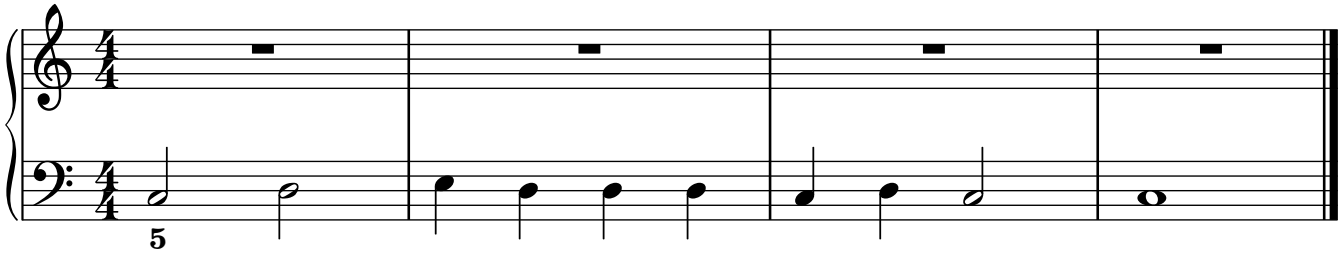
☐ **2.13**



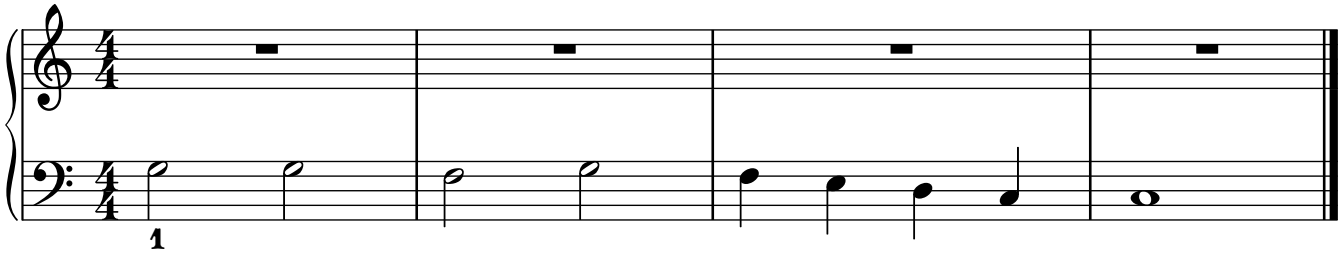
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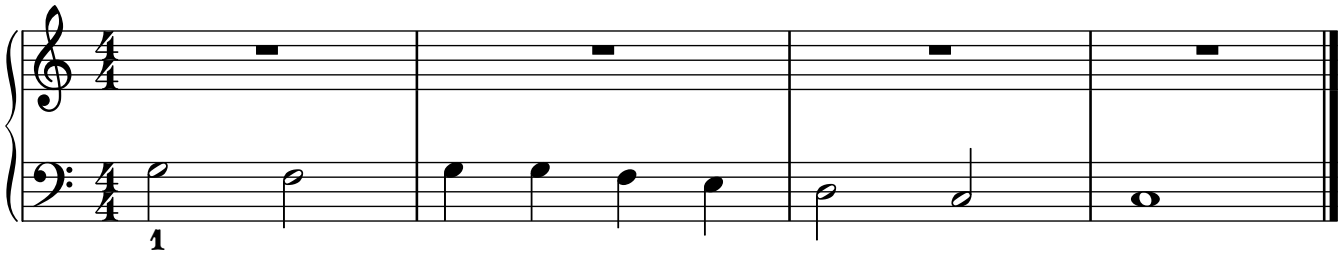
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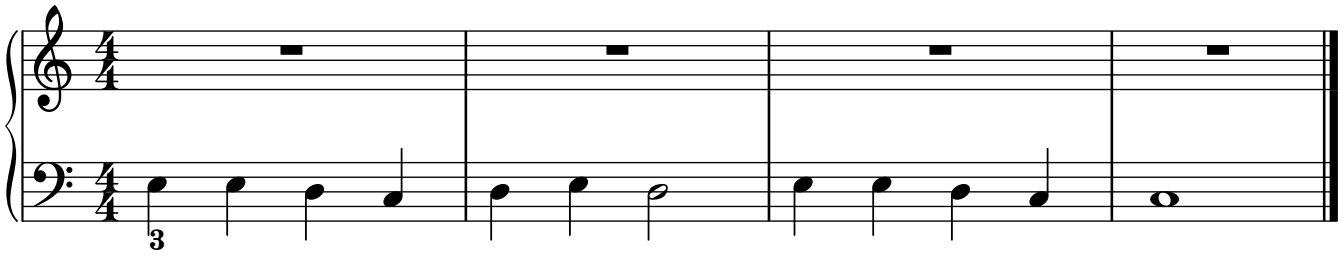
2.16



2.17



2.18



Part C: Eight-bar phrases ♩ = 66

Eight-bar phrases on two lines. Look for bar 5 repeating bar 1.

☐ **2.19**



☐ **2.20**



☐ **2.21**



2.22



2.23



2.24



2.25



2.26



2.27



☐ **2.28**



☐ **2.29**



☐ **2.30**



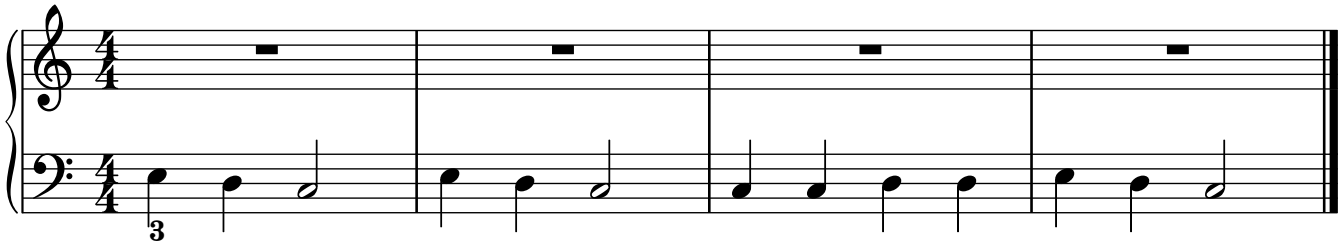
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Hot Cross Buns (left hand) ♩ = 72

Traditional (bar 3 simplified to quarter notes)

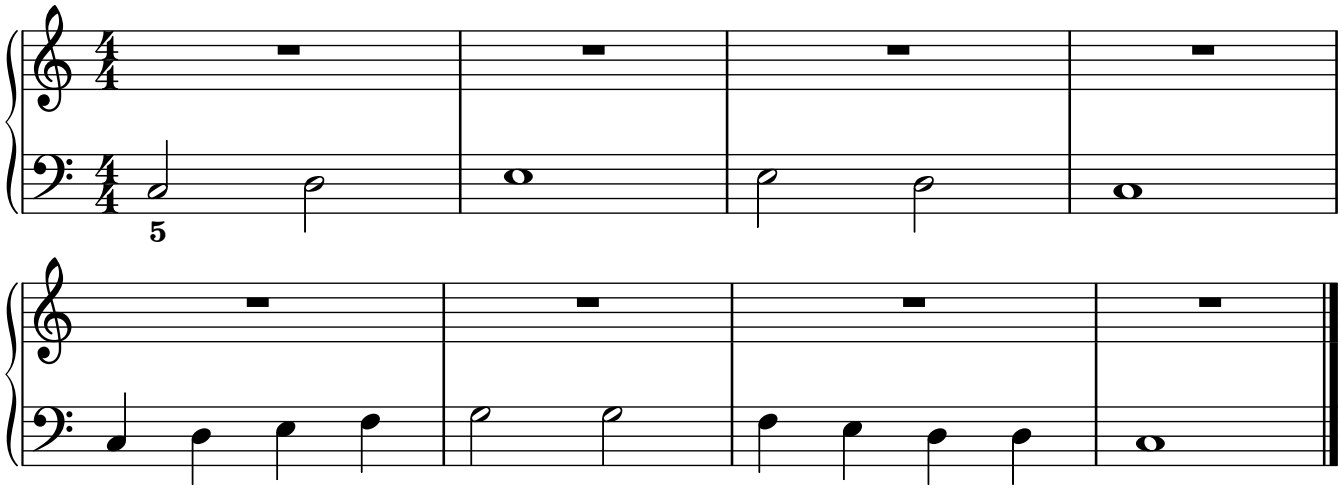
The same tune you played in Unit 1, now in the bass clef. Notice that it looks quite different, yet you play the same keys an octave lower. After each C, skip back up to E (finger 5 to finger 3).



Bear Walk ♩ = 66

Original

Heavy, slow steps. Play firmly, and keep the whole notes held for all four beats.



Evening Bells ♩ = 72

Original

The bells ring from high to low. Bars 5-6 echo bars 1-2. Start with your thumb.



Ode to Joy (left hand) ♩= 80

Ludwig van Beethoven (1824), simplified

A tune you know, read in a new clef. Trust the staff rather than your memory of the tune.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 3?

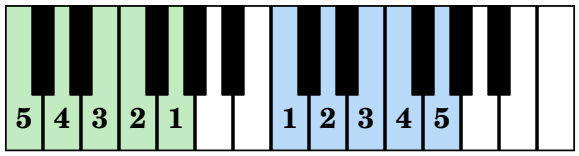
- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 66 beats per minute.
- Pass if you keep the beat going to the end of each one, with no more than one stop per exercise.
- Pass if at least 9 notes out of 10 are right, and you never worked a note out through the treble clef.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 3, where the two hands take turns. If not, play Part B and C exercises again in a week.

Unit 3

Hands Take Turns

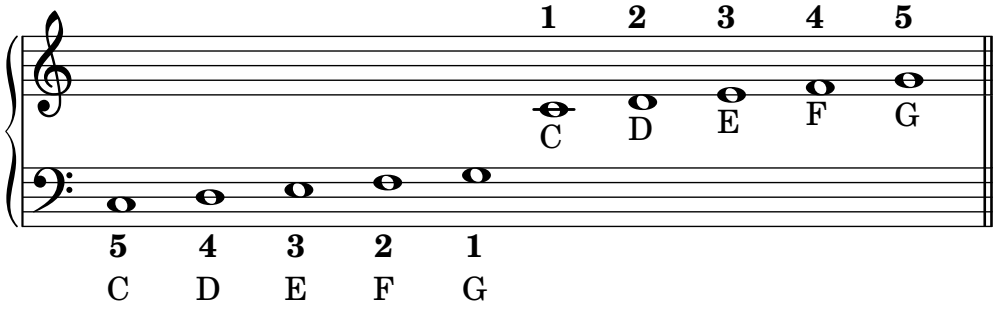
New: Melody passes between hands; 3/4 time and the dotted half note

From now on both hands sit in C position at the same time: the left hand on C to G below middle C, the right hand on C to G from middle C. In this unit they take turns. One hand plays while the other waits, resting on its keys and ready. You will also meet a new time signature, 3/4.



Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

Taking turns

The melody moves from one staff to the other. When it moves to the bass staff, the left hand plays; when it moves back up, the right hand plays.

Full-bar rests

A bar with only a rest in it means that hand is silent for the whole bar. In every time signature this is the whole-rest sign, a small block hanging under the fourth line.

3/4 time

Three beats in every bar. Count 1 - 2 - 3, and lean a little on beat 1, like a waltz.

The dotted half note

A dot adds half of the note's value: a half note (2 beats) plus its dot (1 beat) makes 3 beats, a full bar in 3/4.

Reading tips

1. Look ahead to the bar where the melody changes staff. Know which hand plays next before you get there.

2. The resting hand stays on its five keys, so it can start without looking down.

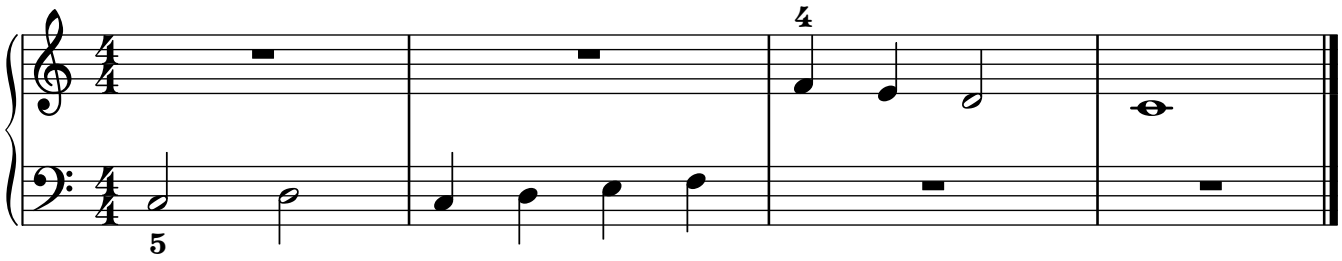
3. In 3/4, keep counting 1 - 2 - 3 right through a dotted half note. It is easy to cut it short to two beats.

4. As always: keep the beat going, even after a mistake.

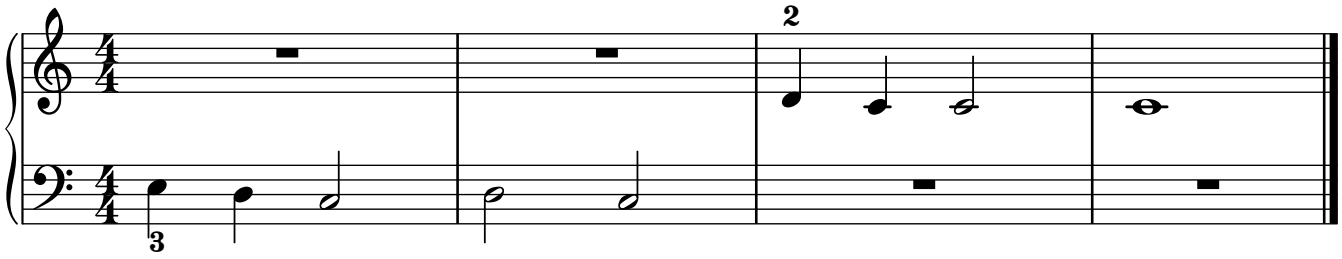
Part A: Two bars each ♩ = 60

The melody passes between the hands every two bars. 4/4 time, metronome 60.

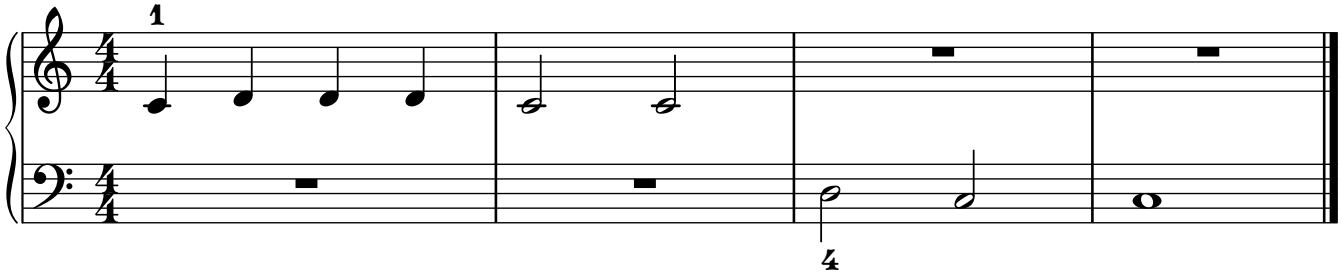
☐ **3.1**



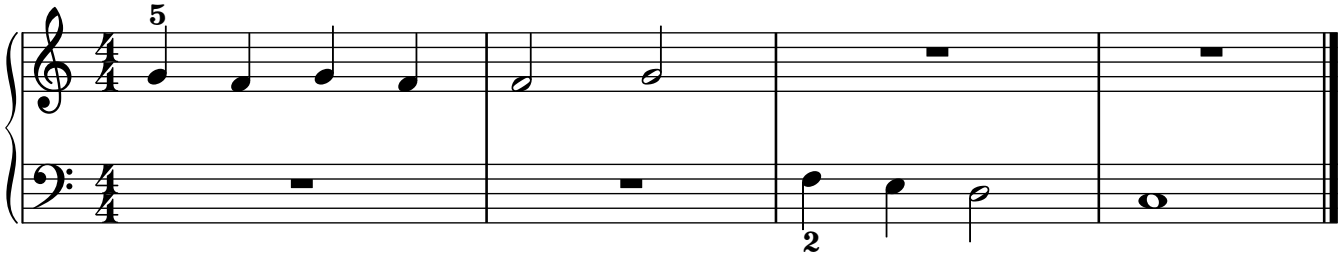
☐ **3.2**



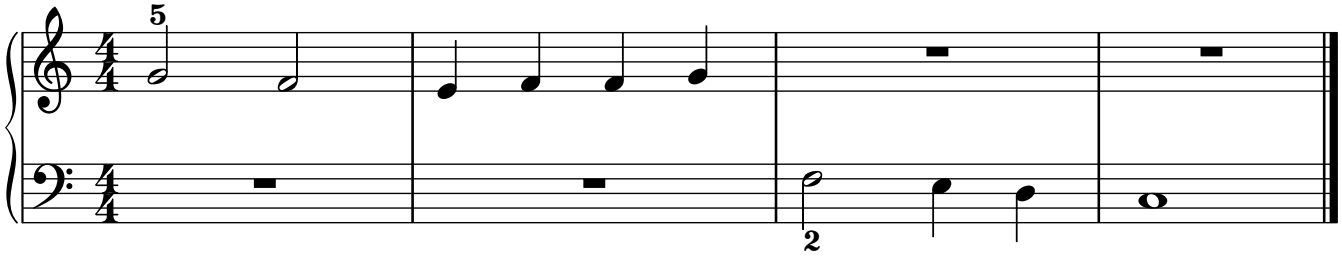
☐ **3.3**



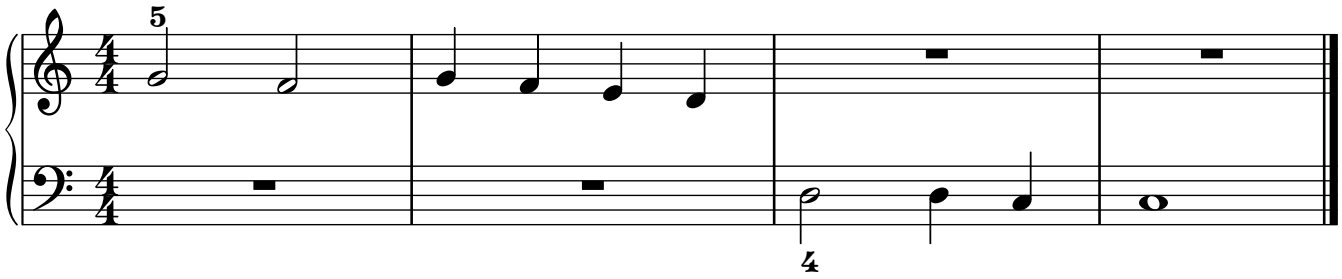
☐ **3.4**



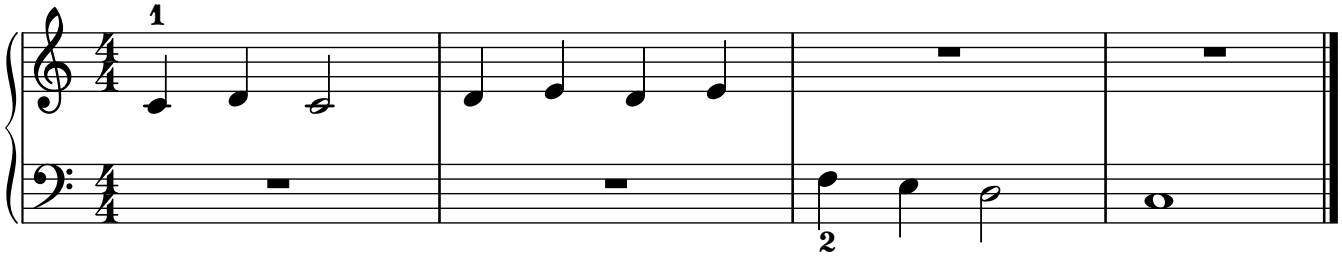
☐ **3.5**



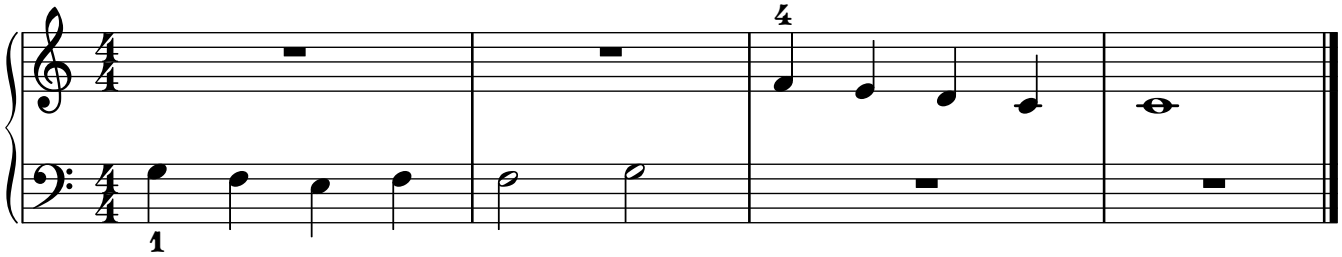
☐ **3.6**



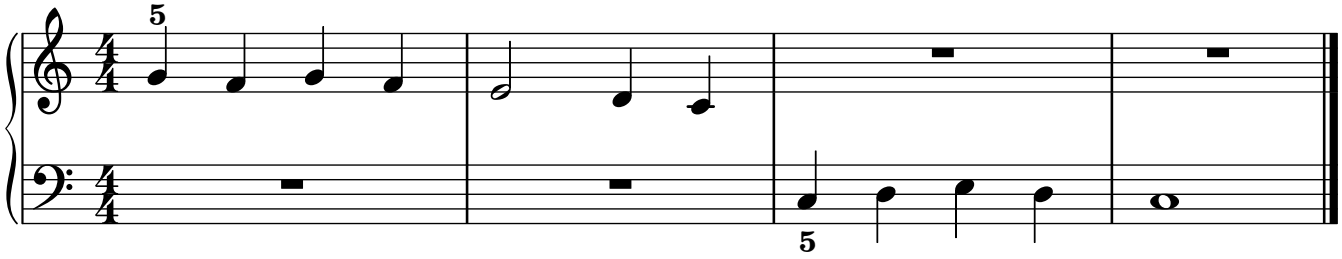
☐ **3.7**



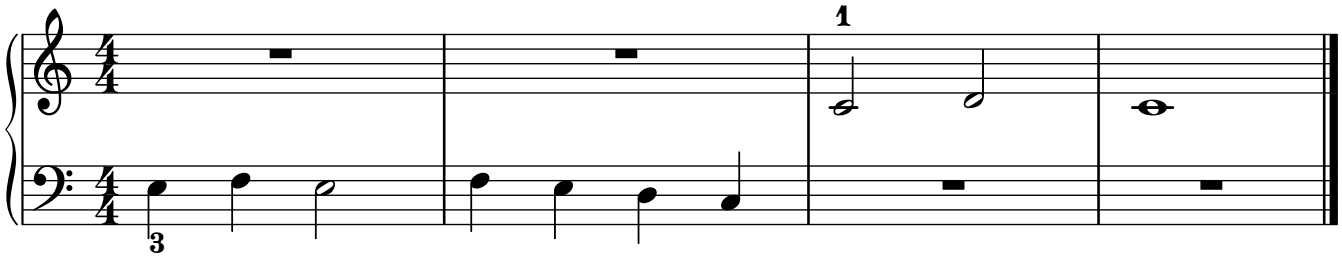
☐ **3.8**



☐ **3.9**



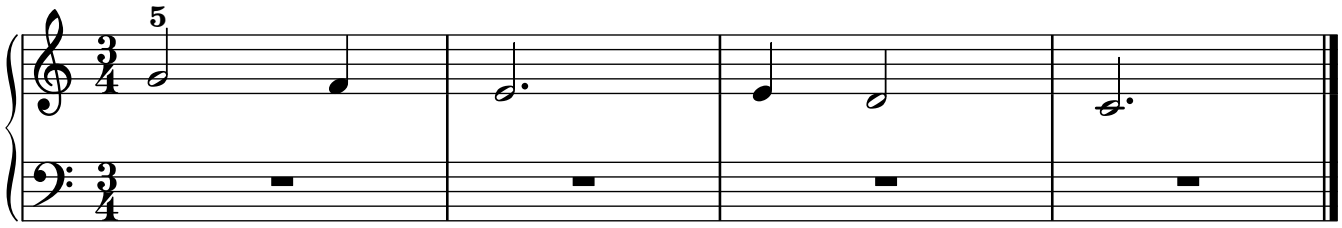
☐ **3.10**



Part B: Three beats in a bar ♩ = 72

3/4 time, right hand only. New rhythm: the dotted half note, worth three beats.

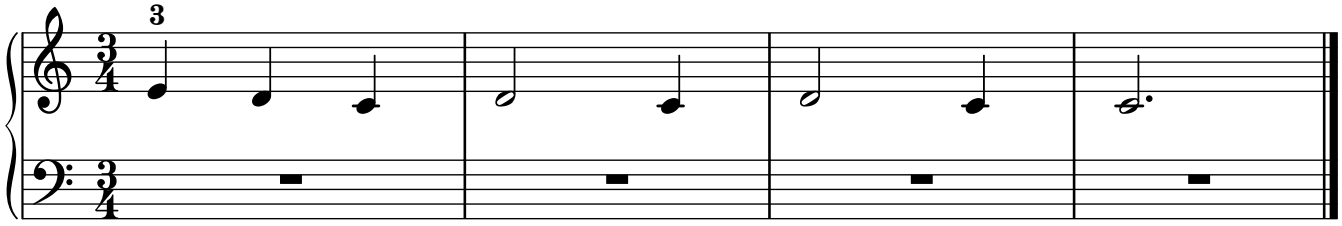
☐ **3.11**



☐ **3.12**



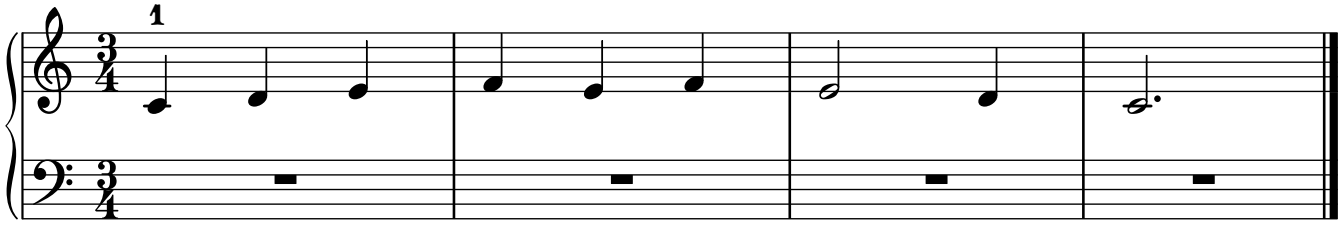
☐ **3.13**



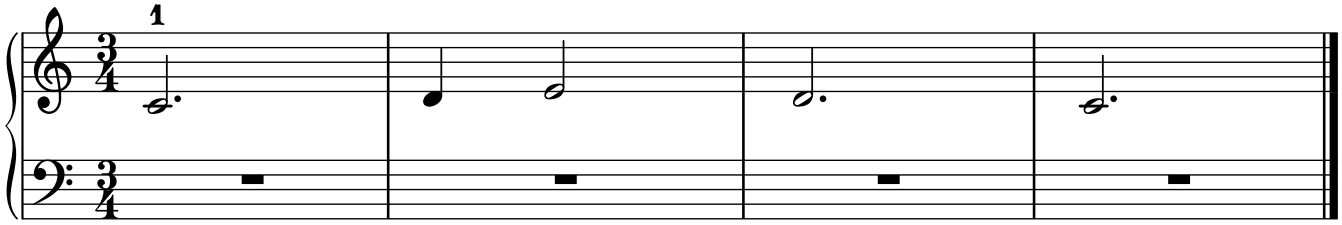
☐ **3.14**



☐ **3.15**



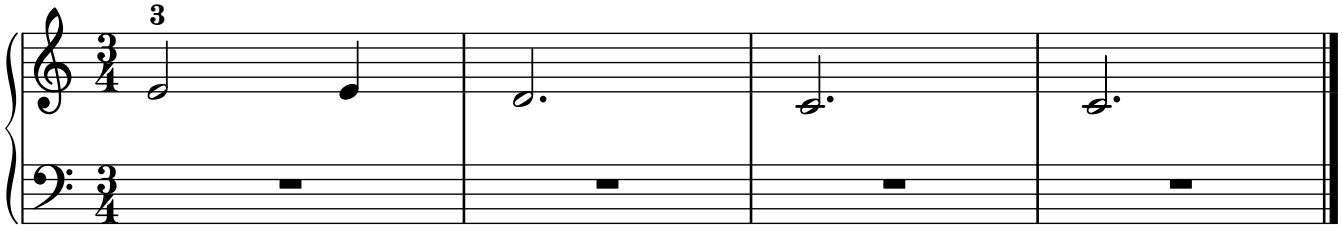
☐ **3.16**



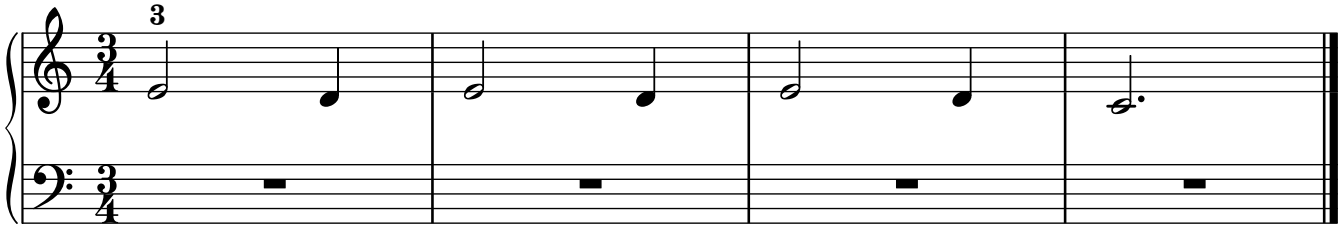
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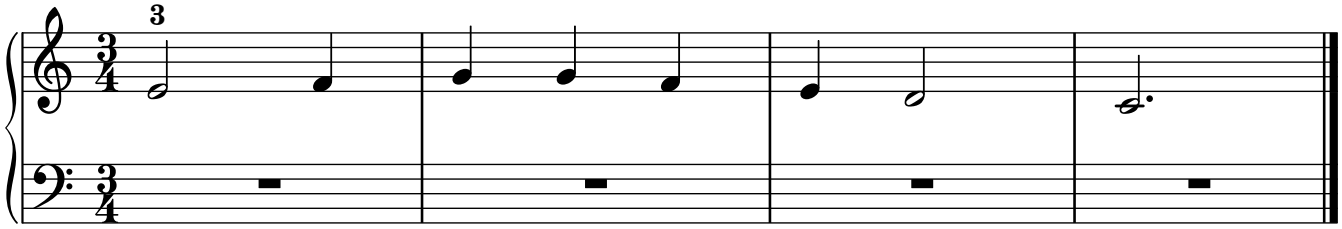
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3.19



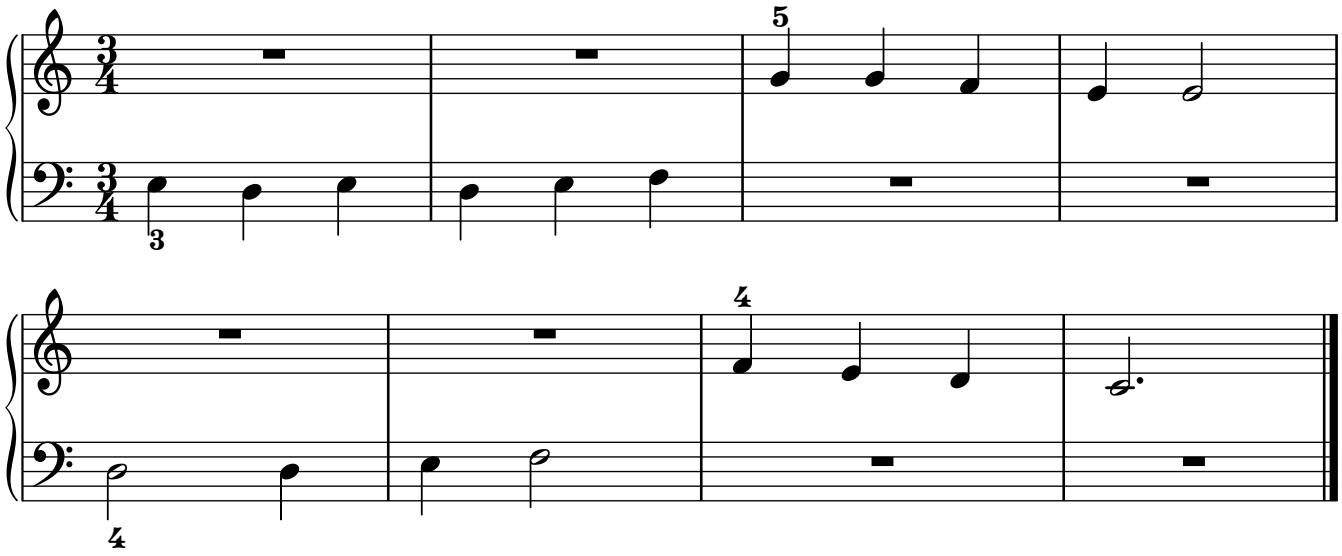
3.20



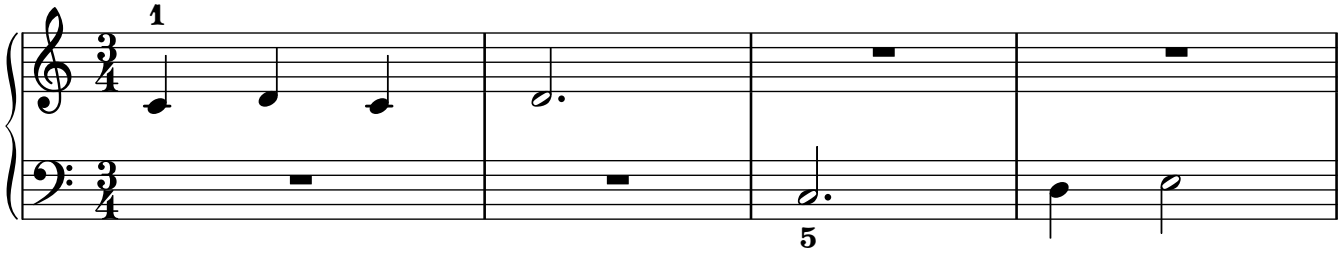
Part C: Turns in 3/4 ♩ = 72

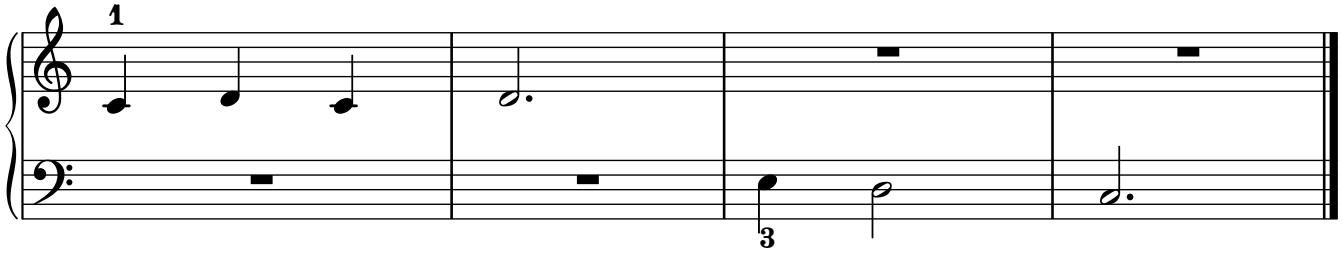
Eight-bar phrases in 3/4, with the hands taking turns.

☐ **3.21**

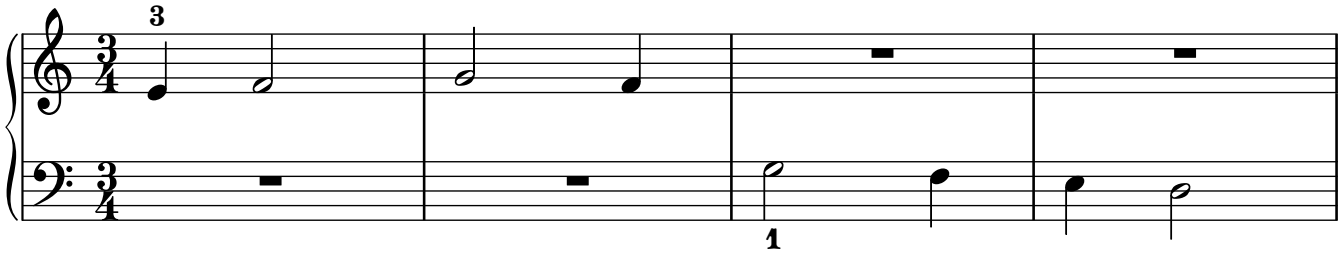


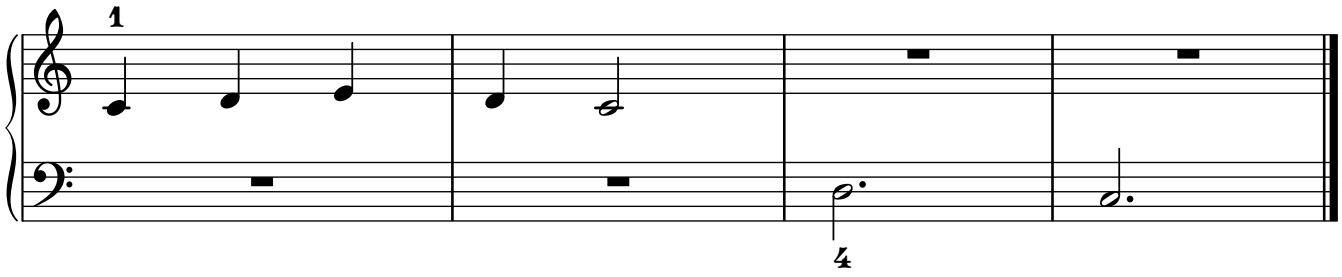
☐ **3.22**





☐ **3.23**





3.24



3.25



3.26



3.27



3.28



3.29



3.30



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Echo ♩ = 72

Original

The left hand echoes the right hand an octave lower. Play the echo a little softer.



Waltz for Two Hands ♩ = 84

Original

One, two, three. The tune passes from hand to hand every two bars. Hold each dotted half note for all three beats.



The Swing ♩ = 80

Original

The right hand swings down from G, then the left hand answers from its own G.



Ode to Joy (shared) ♩ = 80

Ludwig van Beethoven (1824), simplified

The right hand plays the first half and the left hand finishes the tune. Be ready to start the left hand in bar 5.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 4?

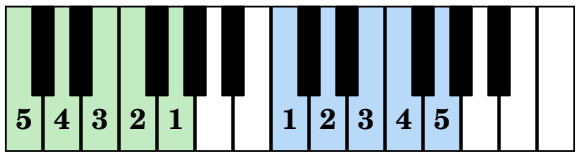
- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 72 beats per minute.
- Pass if the beat never stops when the melody changes hands.
- Pass if every dotted half note gets its full three beats, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 4. If not, read more Part A and C exercises in a week.

Unit 4

Skips

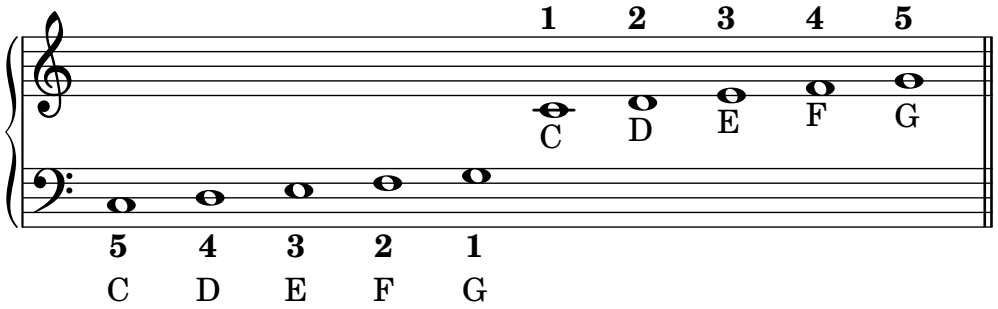
New: Thirds: line-to-line and space-to-space

Until now every melody moved by step or stayed on the same note. Now notes can skip: jump over one key, and over one finger. Both hands are still in C position, so a skip never needs a hand move.



Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

The skip (a third)

A skip jumps over one white key and one finger: C to E, D to F, E to G, and back down.

Skips on the staff

A step always goes from a line to a space or from a space to a line. A skip goes from a line to the next line, or from a space to the next space.

Fingers for skips

Skips use every other finger: 1 to 3, 2 to 4, or 3 to 5.

Chains of skips

C, E and G can follow each other. In the treble clef they sit on the ledger line, line 1 and line 2; in the bass clef they sit in three spaces in a row.

Reading tips

1. In your 10-second scan, look for pairs of notes that are both on lines or both in spaces. Those are skips.

2. Think of a skip as a finger jump (1-3, 2-4, 3-5) rather than naming the new note.

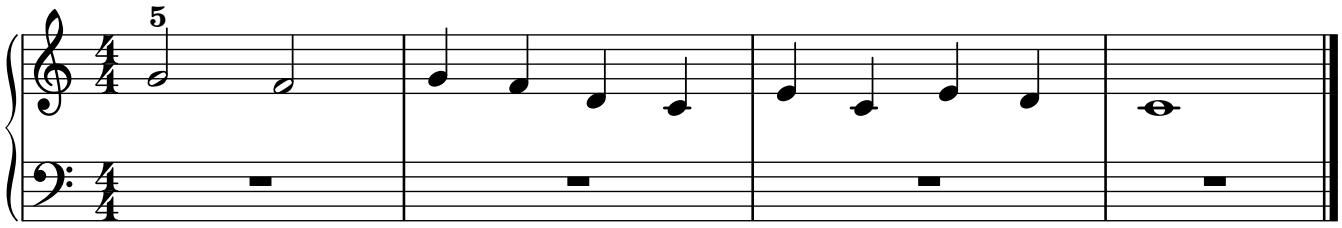
3. Spot chains: line-line-line, or space-space-space, is C-E-G. Read it as one shape.

4. If a skip catches you out, keep the beat and carry on. Accuracy improves with more reading, not with stopping.

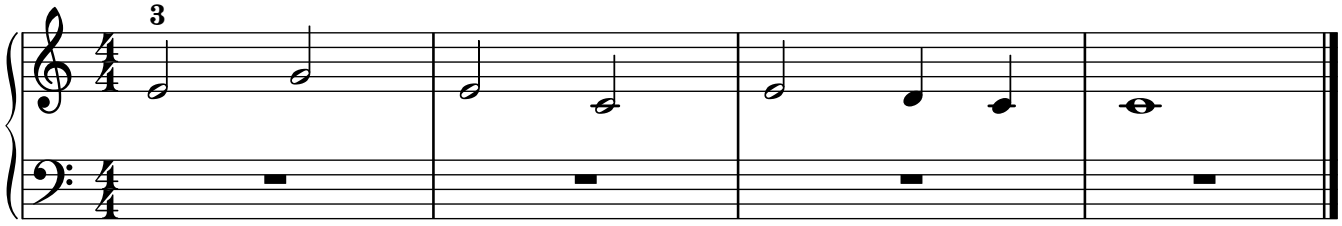
Part A: Right-hand skips ♩ = 60

Skips in the right hand, mixed with steps. Metronome 60.

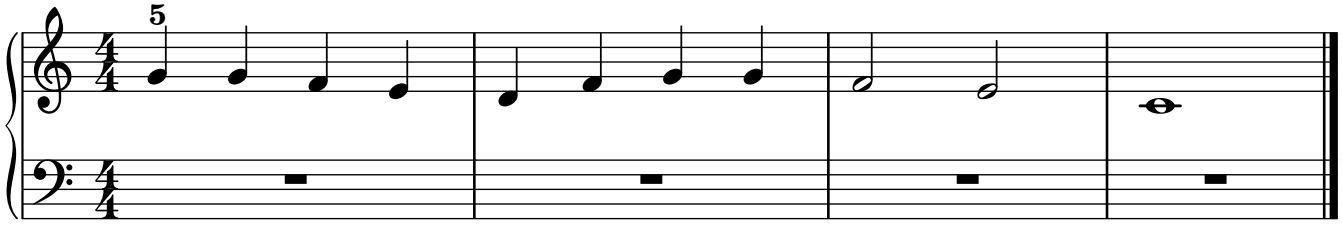
☐ **4.1**



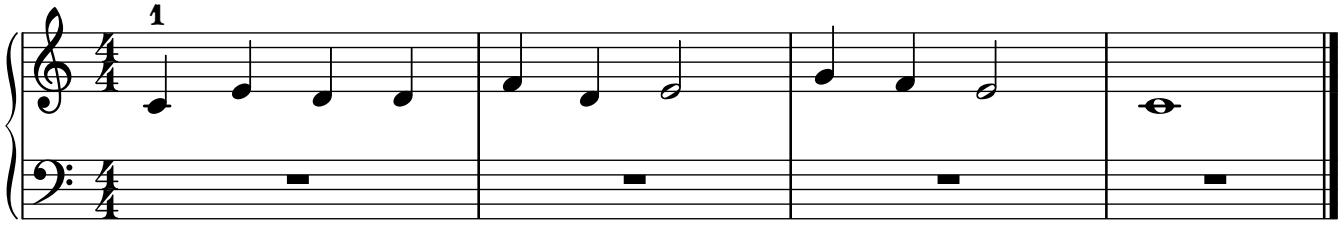
☐ **4.2**



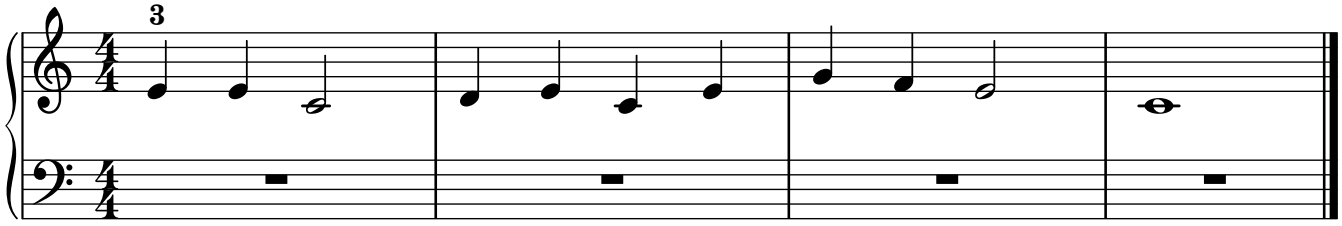
☐ **4.3**



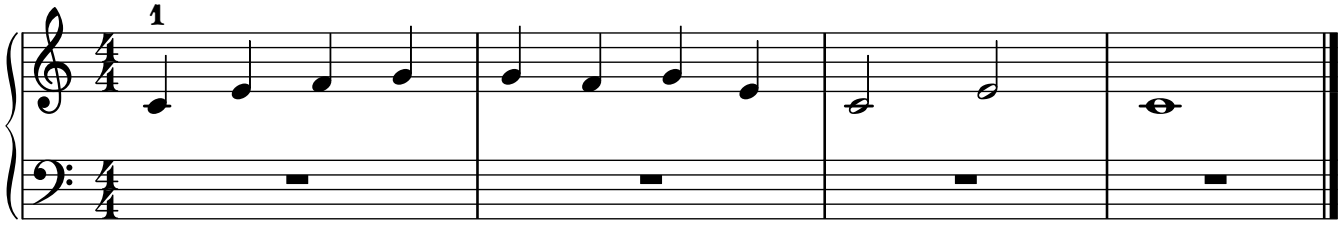
☐ **4.4**



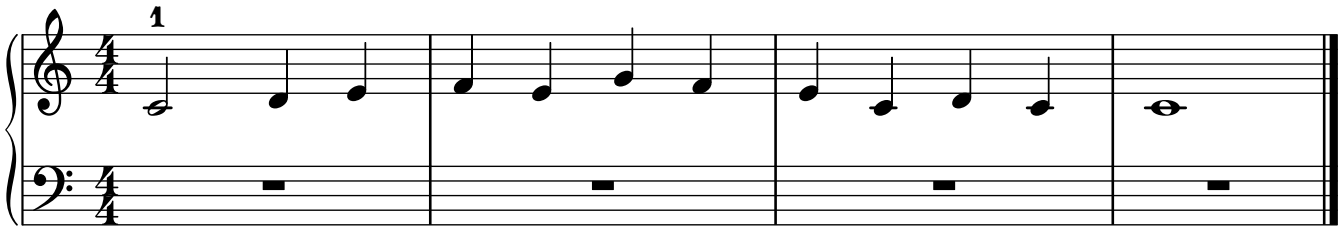
☐ **4.5**



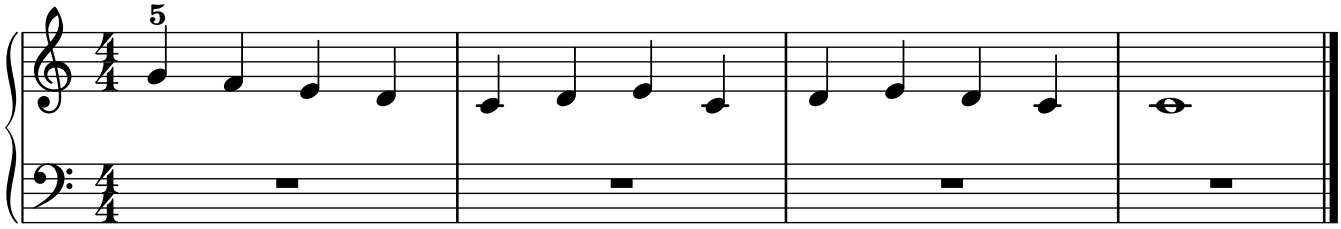
☐ **4.6**



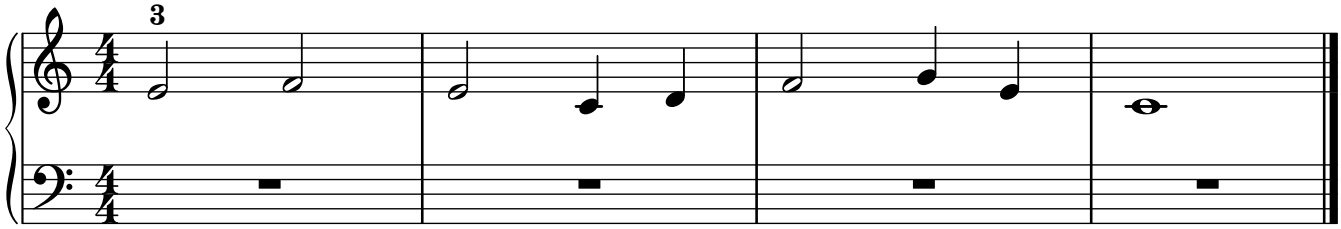
☐ **4.7**



☐ **4.8**



☐ **4.9**



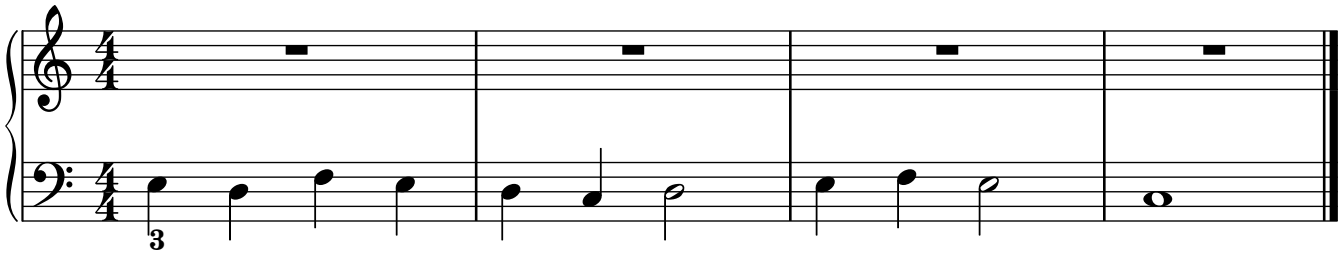
☐ **4.10**



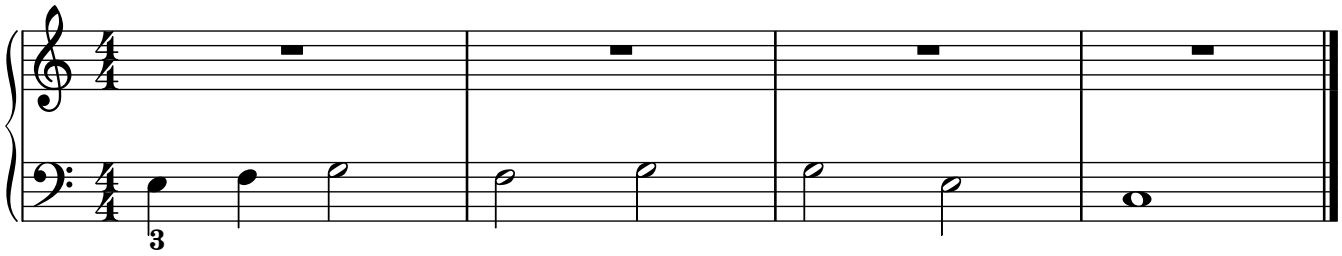
Part B: Left-hand skips ♩= 60

Skips in the left hand. In the bass clef, C, E and G sit in the second, third and top spaces.

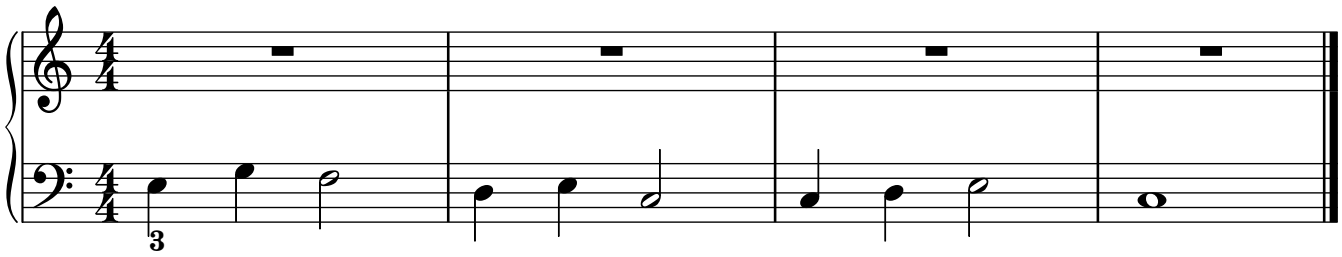
☐ **4.11**



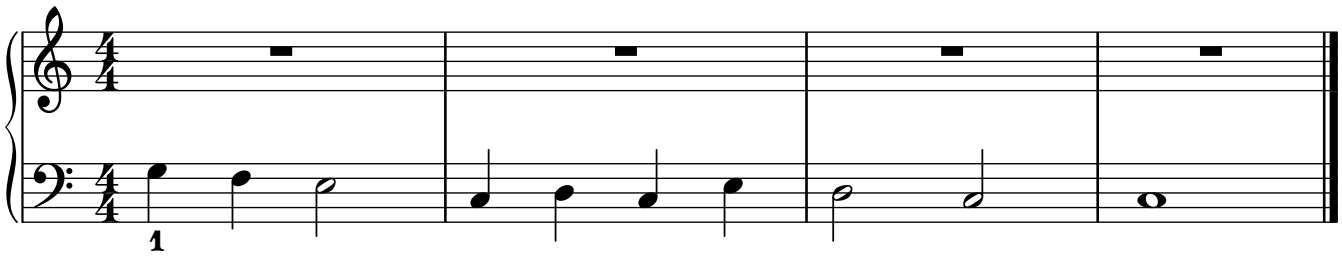
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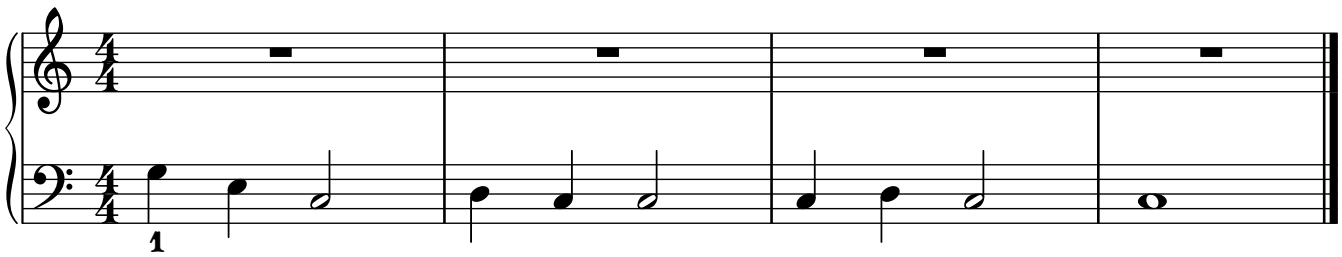
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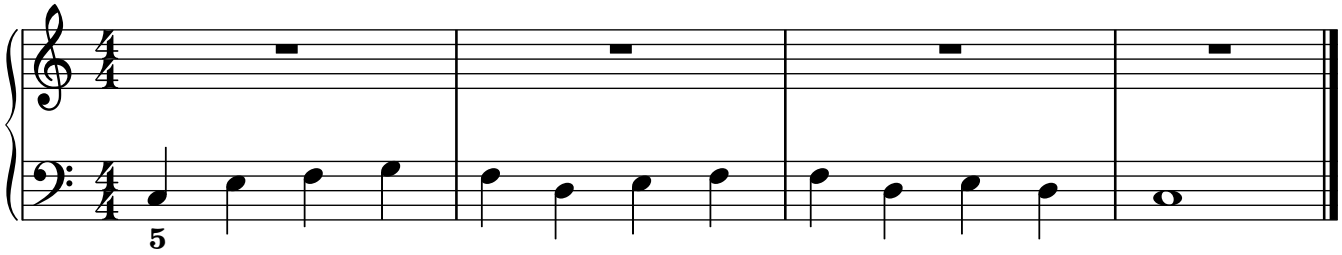
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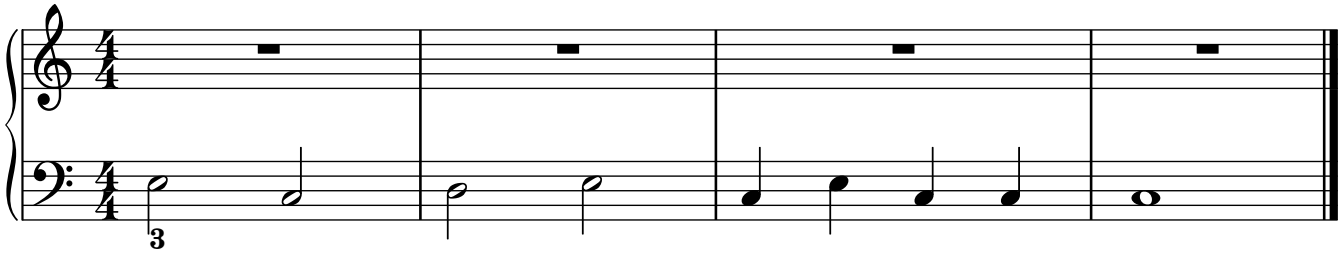
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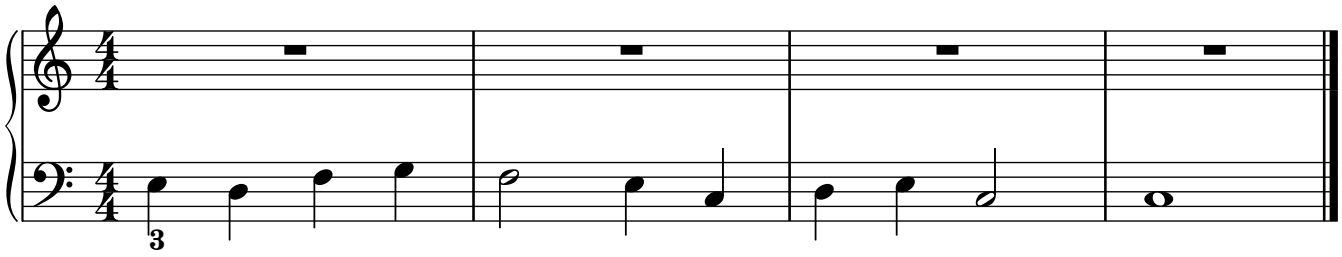
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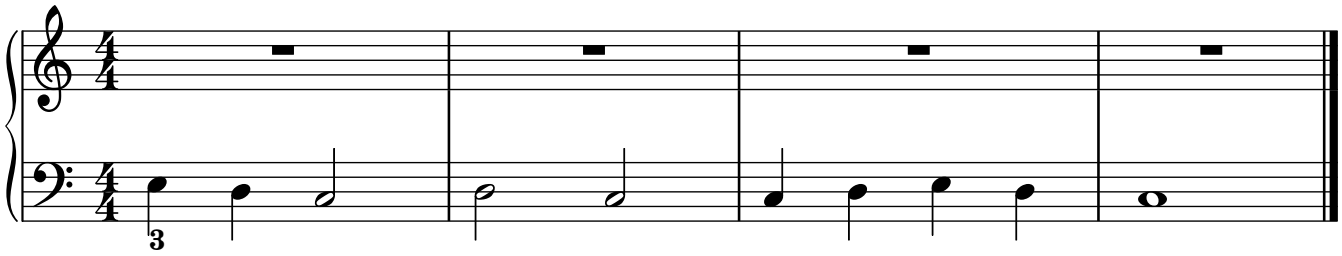
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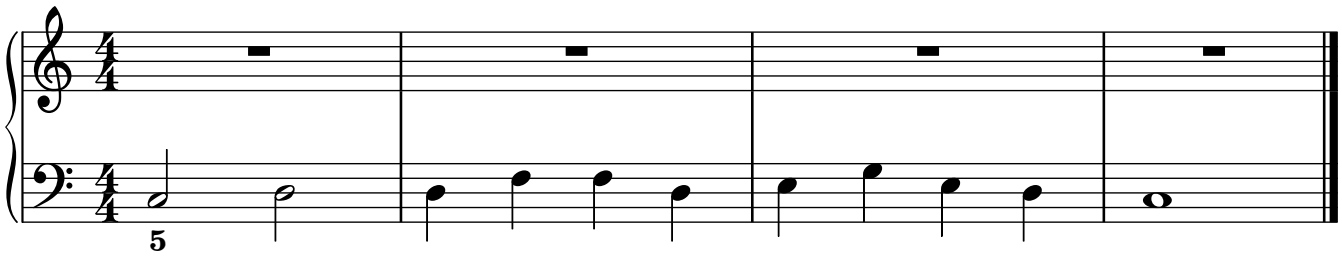
☐ **4.18**



☐ **4.19**



☐ **4.20**



Part C: Skips, hands taking turns

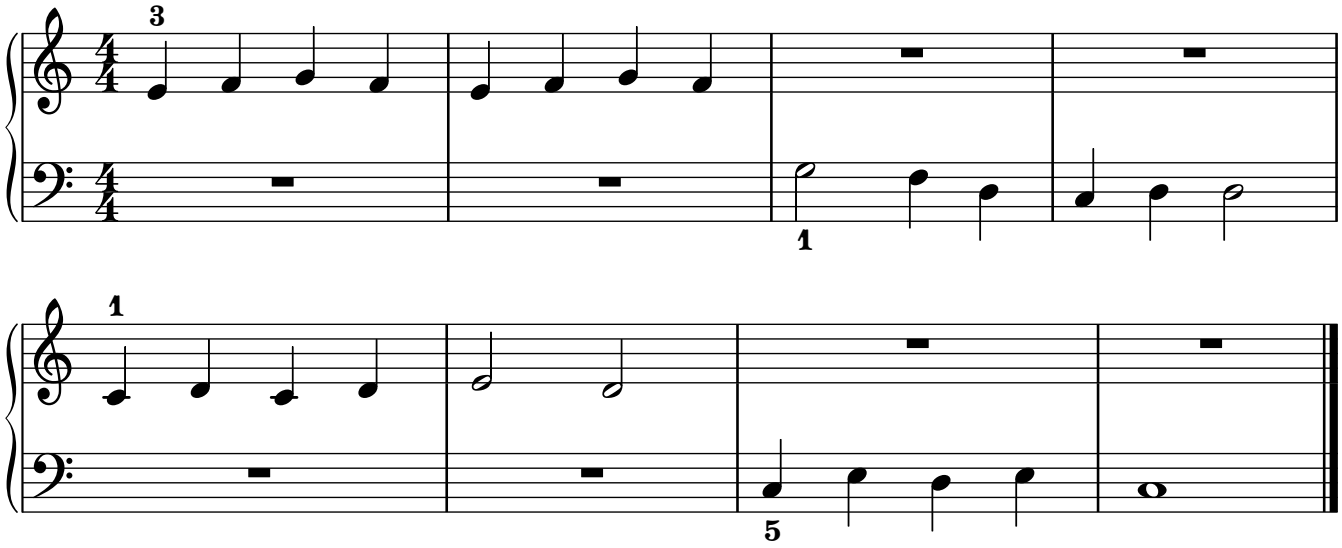
♩ = 66

Skips with the hands taking turns, in eight-bar phrases.

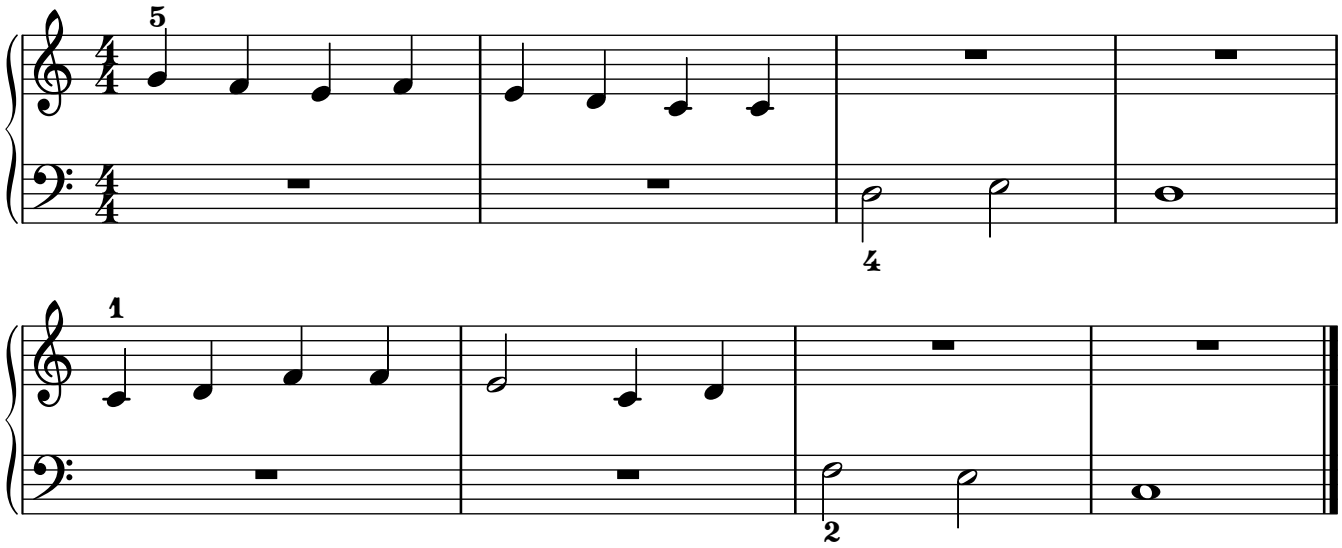
4.21



4.22



4.23



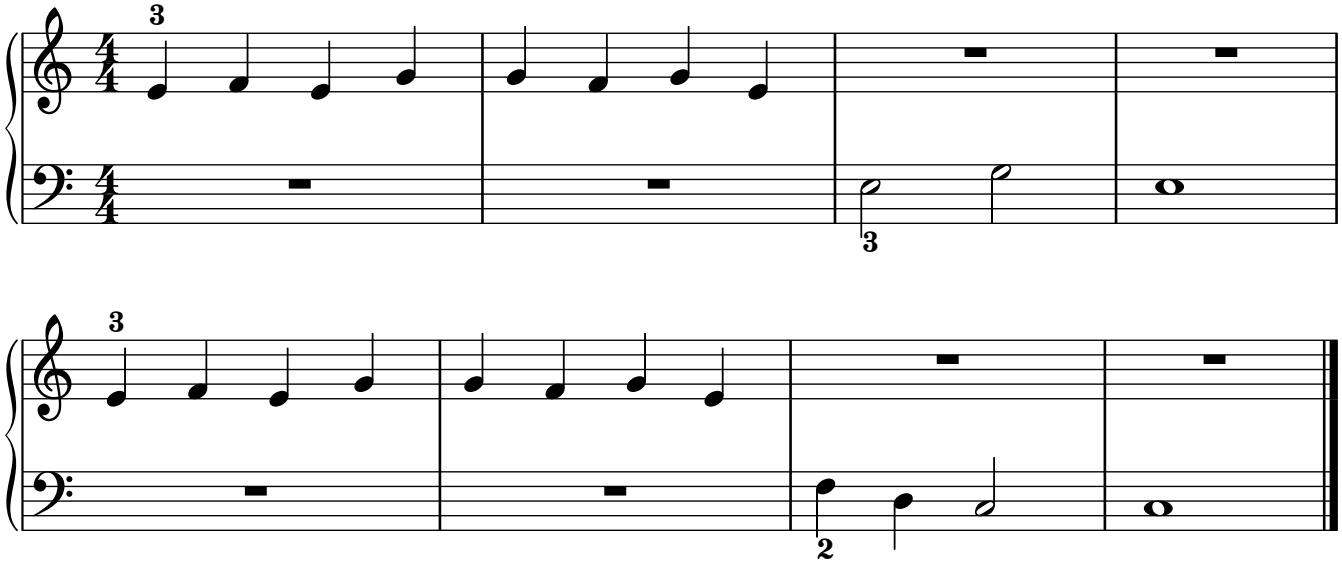
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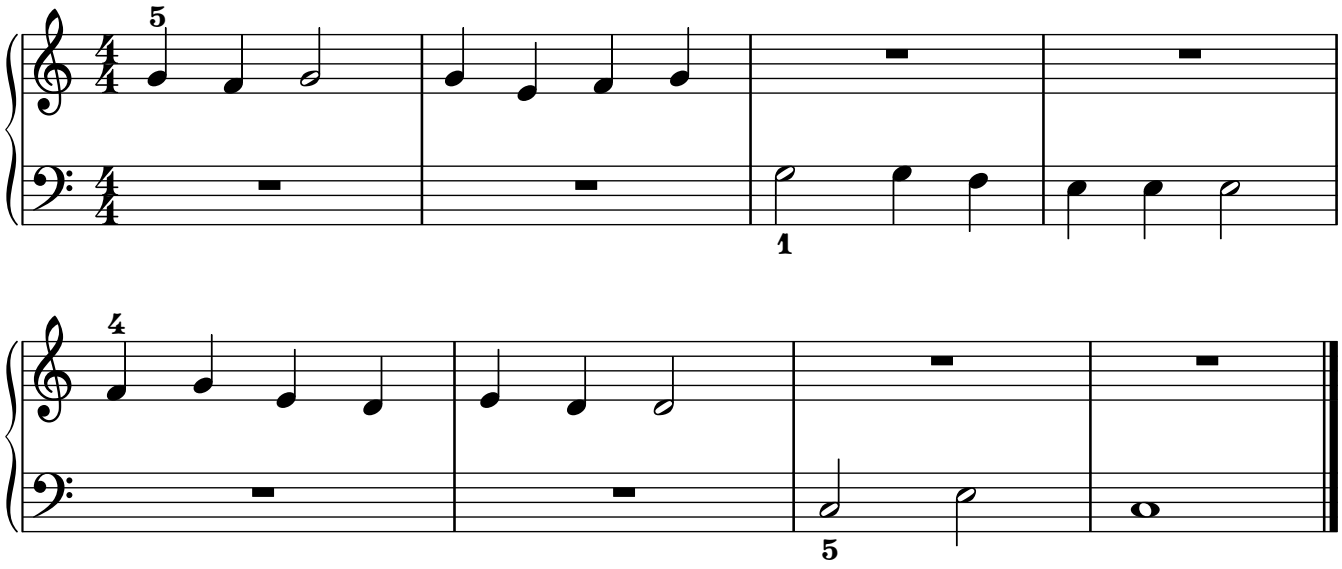
4.25



4.26



4.27



4.28



4.29



4.30



4.31



4.32



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Mary Had a Little Lamb ♩ = 84

Traditional

One skip only: E up to G in bar 4. Everything else moves by step or repeats.



Au clair de la lune ♩ = 76

Traditional French song (opening)

The right hand sings the phrase, then the left hand repeats it. Find the skip in bar 3 before you start.



Leapfrog ♩ = 72

Original

Skip, step, skip, step: the right hand hops up, then the left hand hops down from G.



Stepping Stones ♩ = 88

Original

Each bar steps down and then skips up, like crossing a stream on stones. Lean on beat 1.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 5?

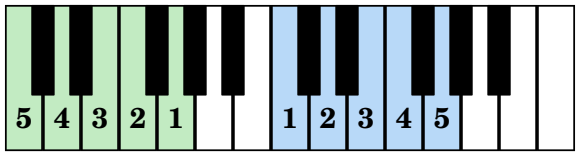
- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 66 beats per minute.
- Pass if you keep the beat going, with no more than one stop per exercise.
- Pass if you play the skips without looking down, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 5, where both hands play at the same time.

Unit 5

Hands Together

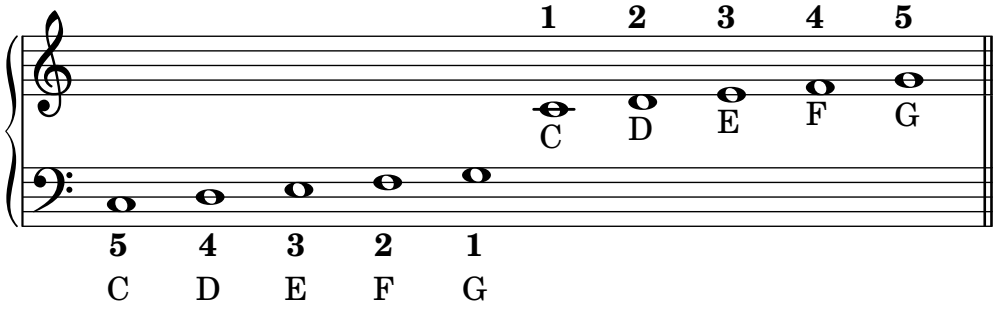
New: Left hand holds C or G while the right hand moves

Both hands now play at the same time. To make this manageable, the left hand keeps it simple: it holds long notes, only C (finger 5) or G (finger 1), while the right hand plays the tune. These two bass notes are the roots of the two most important chords in C major.



Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

Reading two staves at once

Notes that line up vertically are played together. Read the beat as a column: the right-hand note on top, the left-hand note below.

C and G in the bass

C sits in the second space (finger 5) and G in the top space (finger 1). In this unit those are the only two left-hand notes.

Where the bass changes

The left hand changes only on beat 1 (whole notes) or on beats 1 and 3 (half notes). Between those moments, spend all your attention on the right hand.

Reading tips

1. Before you start, find the first note in each hand and put both hands in place.

2. Read the top line. Glance down only when a new bass note is due, on beat 1 or beat 3.

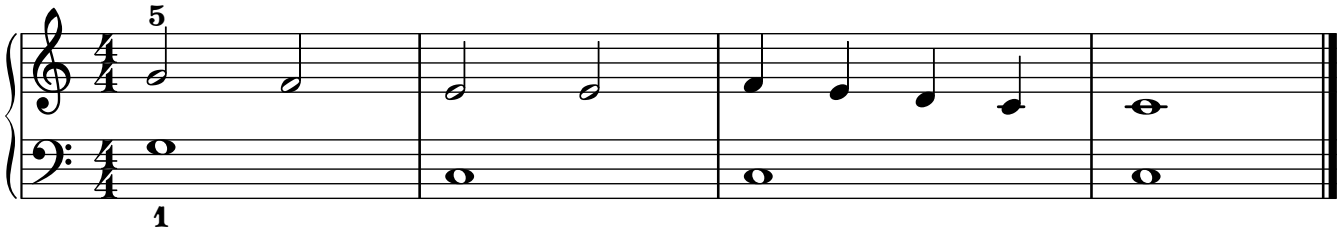
3. If playing hands together falls apart, keep the right hand going and let the left hand drop out for a bar. Never stop the beat.

4. Count aloud. Hands together is mostly a counting skill.

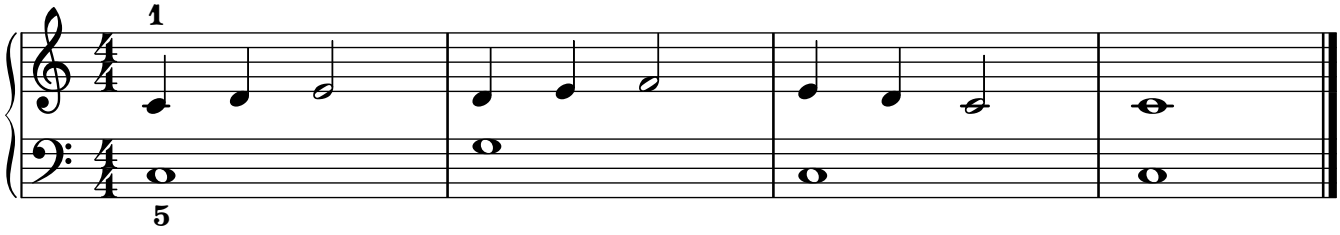
Part A: Whole-note bass ♩ = 56

The left hand holds one whole note per bar: C or G. The right hand moves by step. Metronome 56.

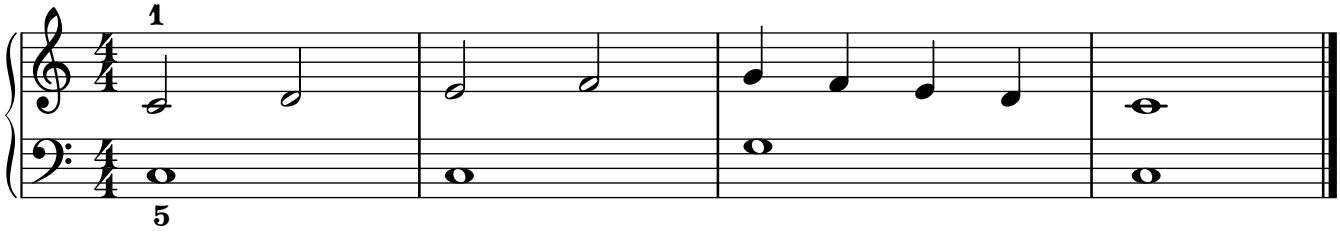
☐ **5.1**



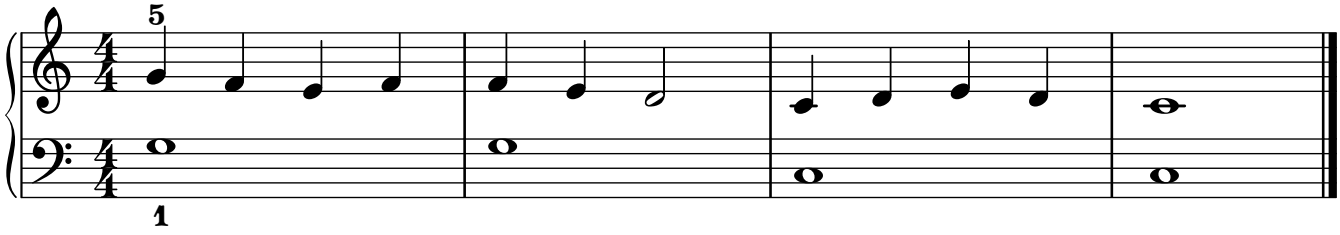
☐ **5.2**



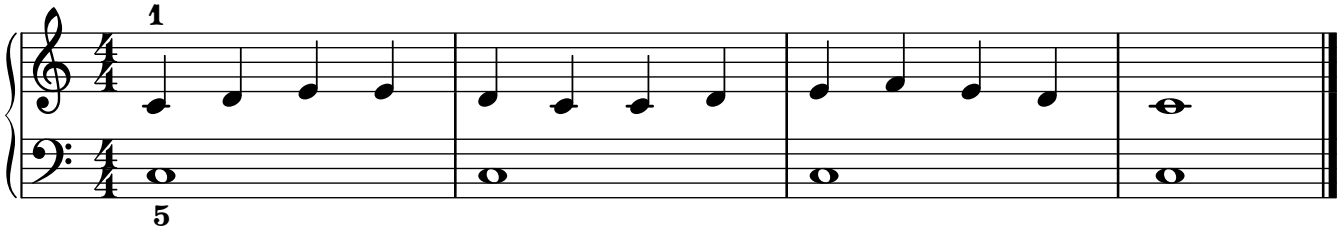
☐ **5.3**



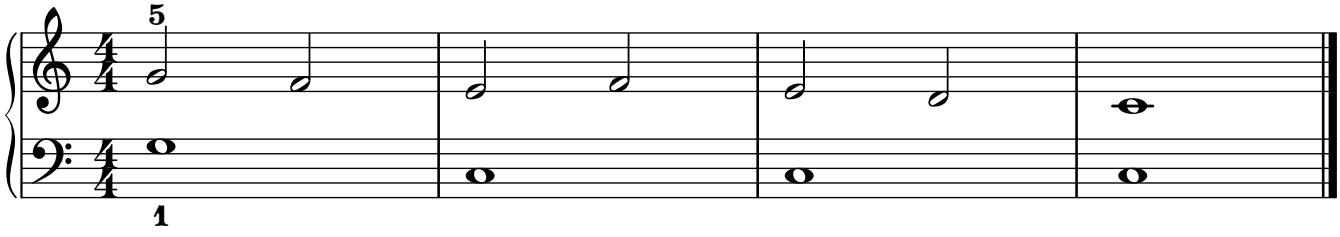
☐ **5.4**



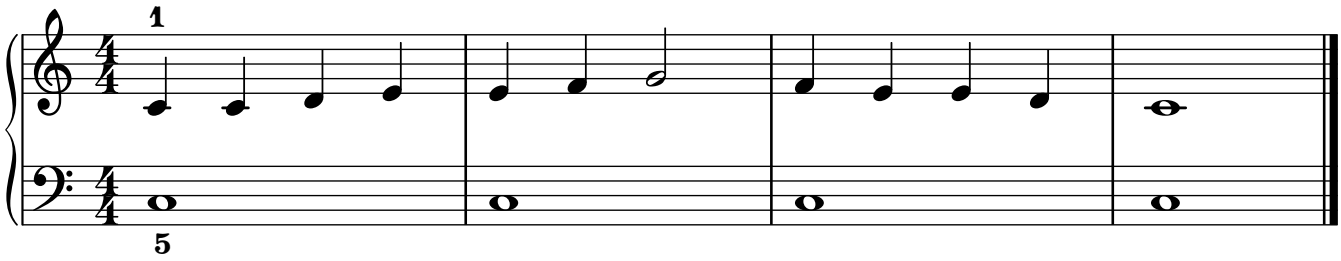
☐ **5.5**



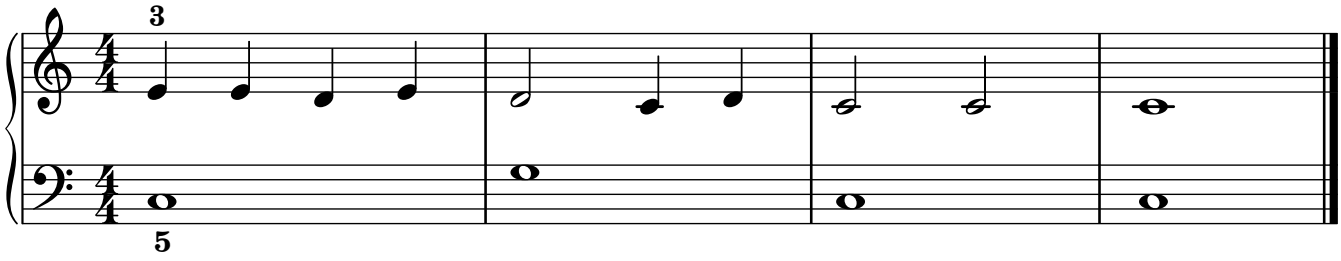
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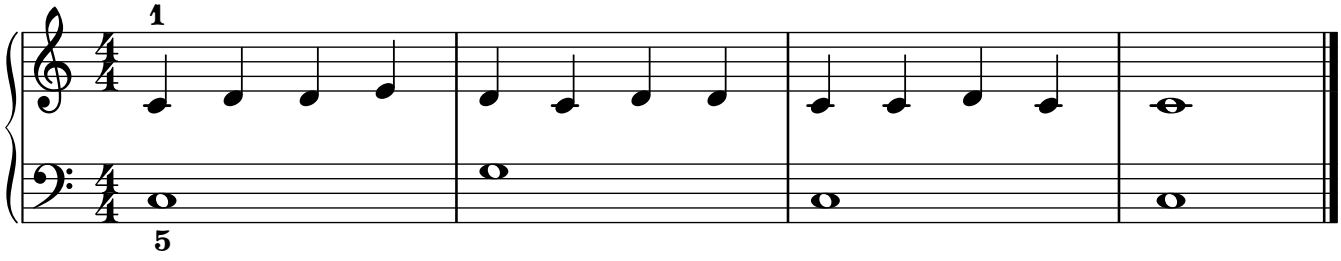
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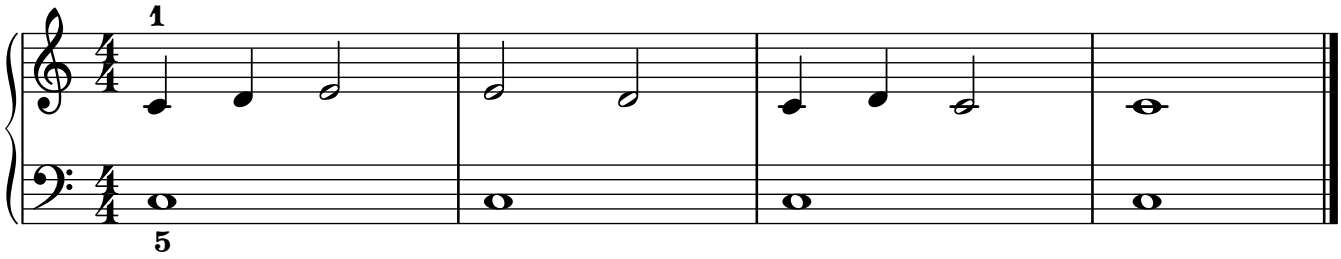
☐ **5.8**



☐ **5.9**



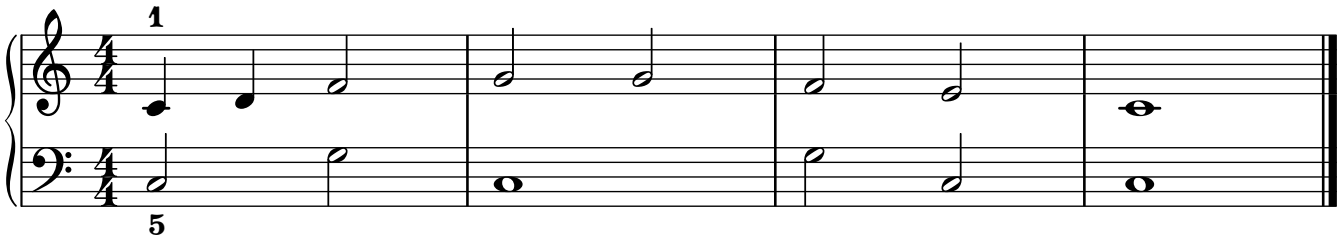
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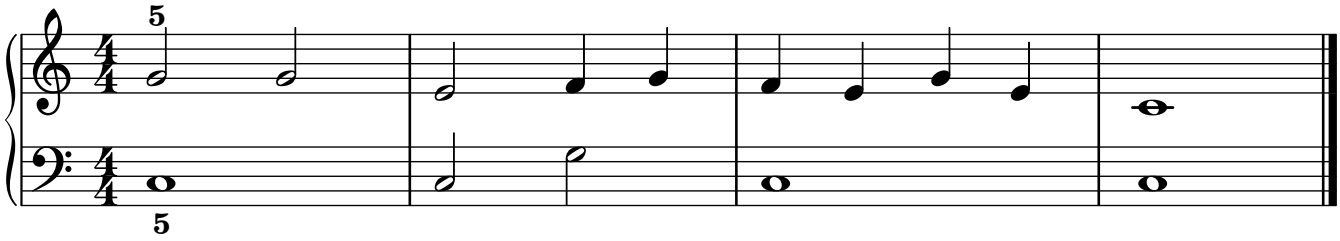
Part B: Half-note bass ♩ = 56

The left hand may change on beat 3 (half notes), and the right hand uses skips too.

☐ **5.11**



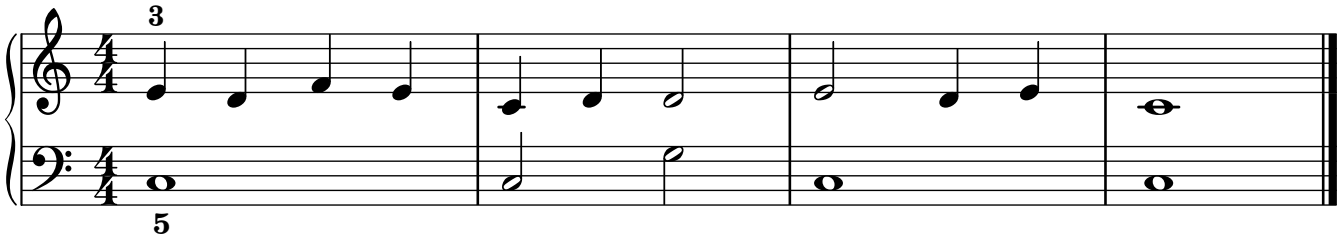
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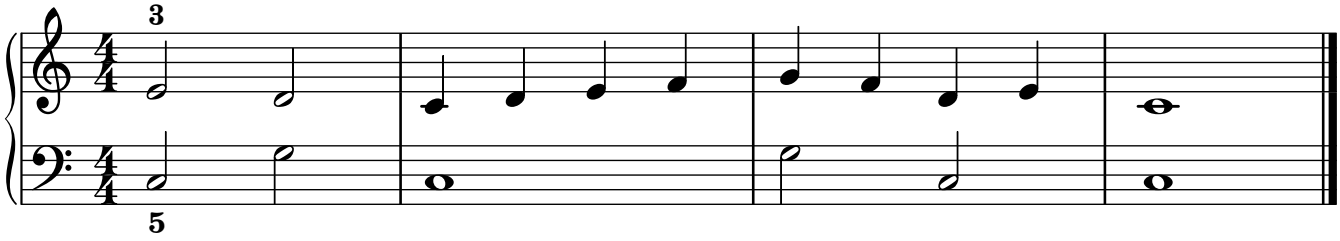
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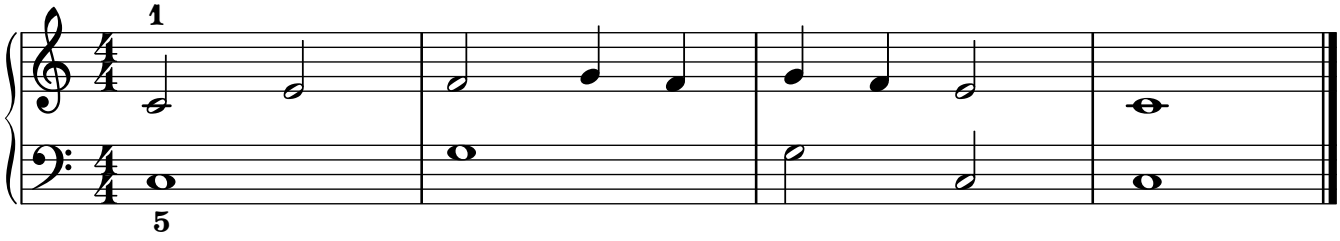
☐ **5.14**



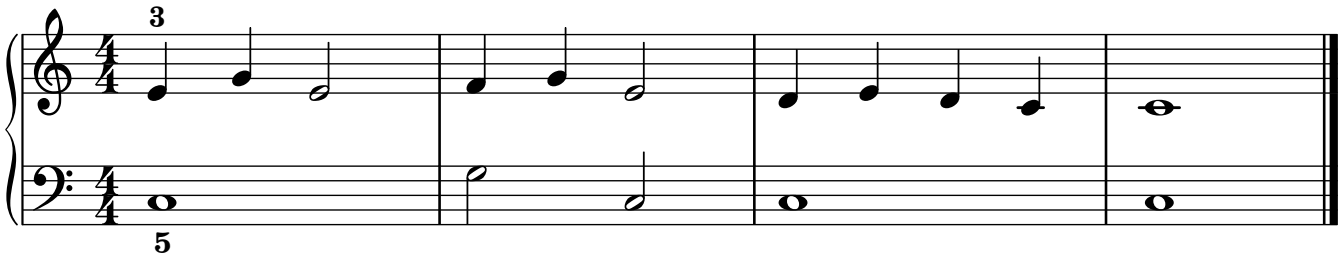
☐ **5.15**



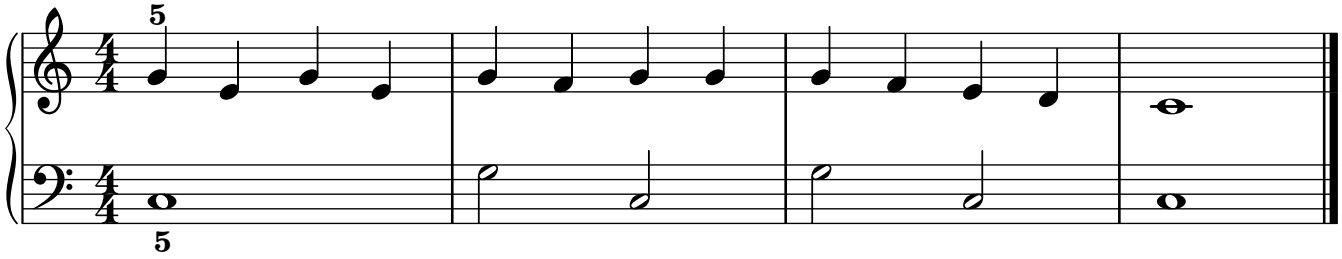
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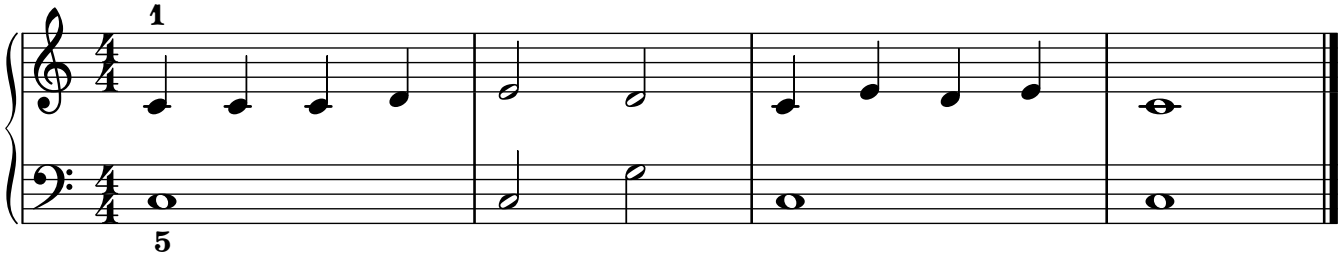
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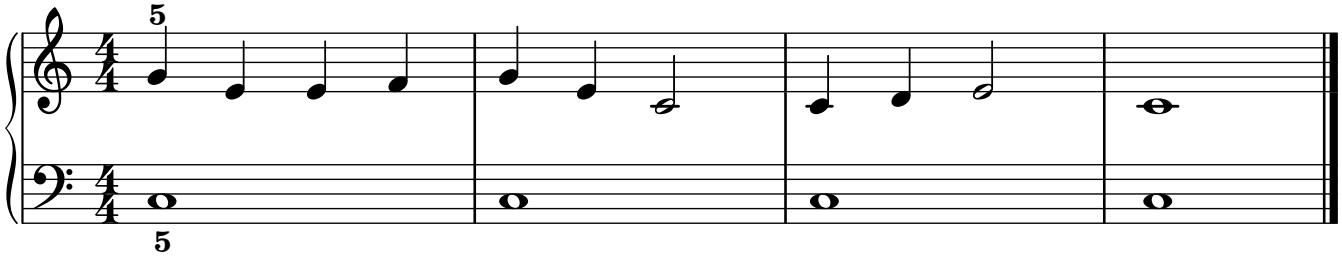
5.18



5.19



5.20



Part C: Eight-bar duets for two hands ♩ = 60

Eight-bar duets for your two hands.

☐ **5.21**



☐ **5.22**



☐ **5.23**



5.24



5.25



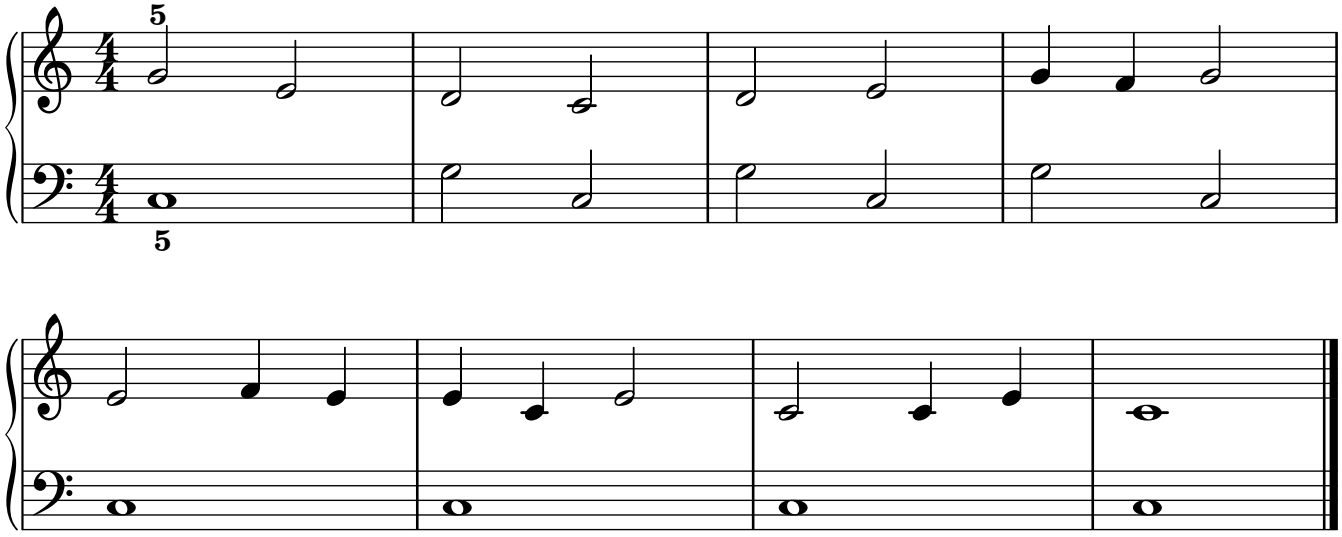
5.26



5.27



5.28



5.29



5.30



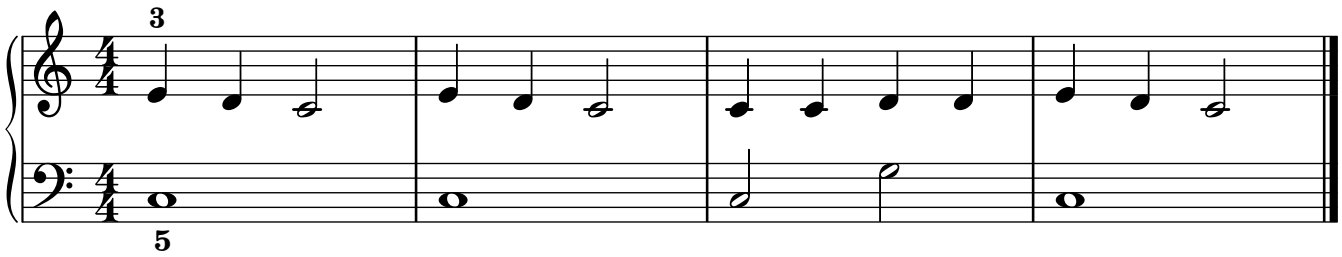
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Hot Cross Buns (hands together) ♩ = 72

Traditional (bar 3 simplified to quarter notes)

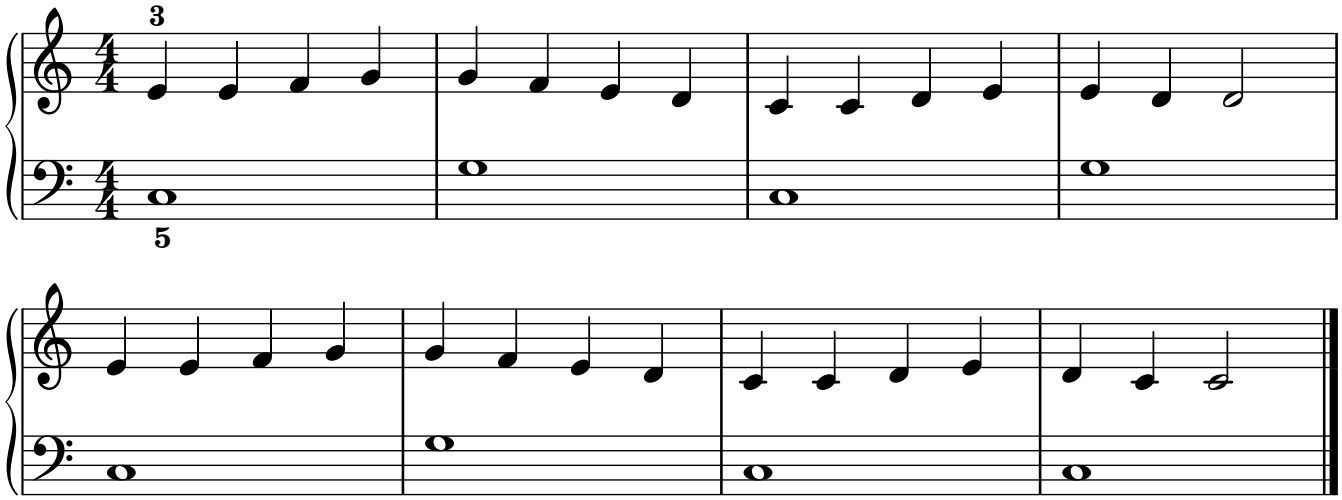
The left hand holds C, and changes to G only once, in bar 3.



Ode to Joy (hands together) ♩ = 76

Ludwig van Beethoven (1824), simplified

The bass alternates C and G every bar, then stays on C at the end. Bars 1-3 and 5-7 are the same.



Morning Song ♩ = 72

Original

The tune climbs the chain C-E-G in the first bar. The bass changes on beat 3 only in bar 7.



Bells in C ♩ = 84

Original

A waltz: the left hand rings one long bass note in every bar while the right hand sways.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 6?

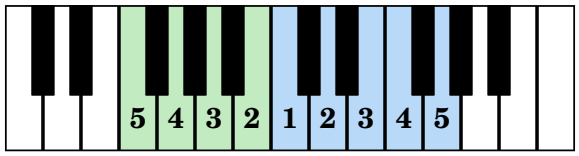
- Play five Part C exercises you have not played before, at 60 beats per minute.
- Pass if both hands keep going together, with no more than one stop per exercise.
- Pass if every left-hand change lands exactly on its beat.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 6. If not, play Part A again, then try Part C a week later.

Unit 6

Middle C Position

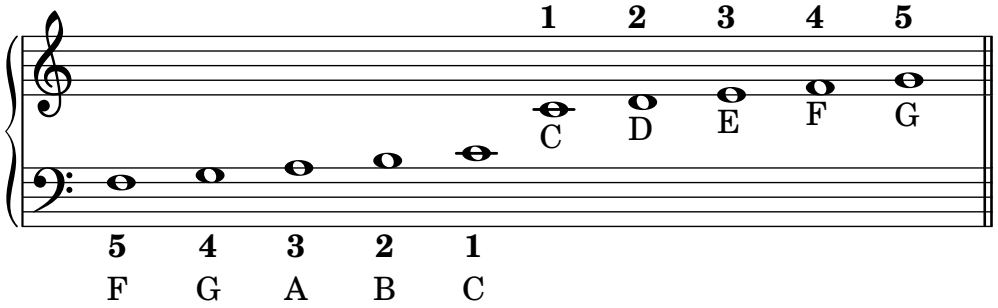
New: Both thumbs on middle C; notes near the middle of the grand staff

In the middle C position both thumbs share middle C. The right hand plays C D E F G as before. The left hand moves up so that fingers 5-4-3-2-1 sit on F G A B C, finishing on middle C. The hands are now right next to each other, and you read notes near the middle of the grand staff.



Middle C position (LH) and Middle C position (RH) (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

One key, two ways to write it

Middle C can sit on a ledger line below the treble staff, or on a ledger line above the bass staff. It is the same key either way. The staff tells you which hand plays it.

New left-hand notes

F is the fourth line (between the clef's dots), G the top space, A the top line, B the space just above the staff, and C the ledger line above that.

Ledger lines

Short extra lines for notes beyond the staff. One ledger line above the bass staff, or below the treble staff, is middle C.

Reading tips

1. Don't confuse the top line of the bass staff (A) with the top space (G). Find the F line first and count up from it.

2. When the melody passes between the hands around middle C, the hands are next to each other. There is no jump.

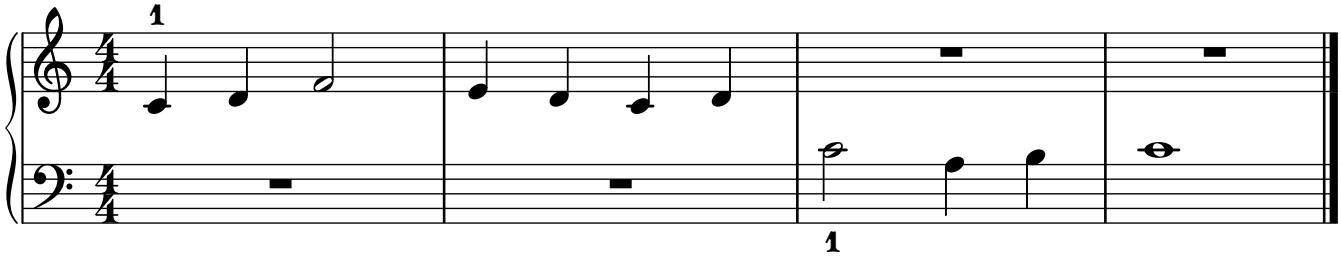
3. Middle C written on the bass staff means left thumb; written on the treble staff, right thumb.

4. Keep the beat going, and keep your eyes on the page.

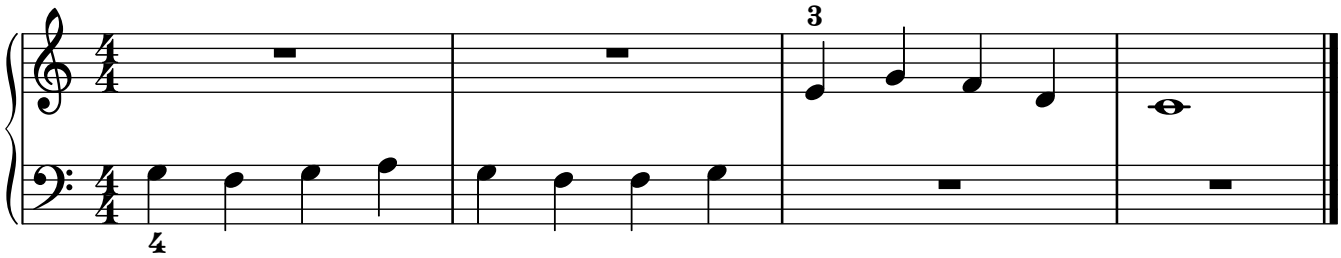
Part A: Reading across the middle ♩ = 60

Hands take turns across middle C. Metronome 60.

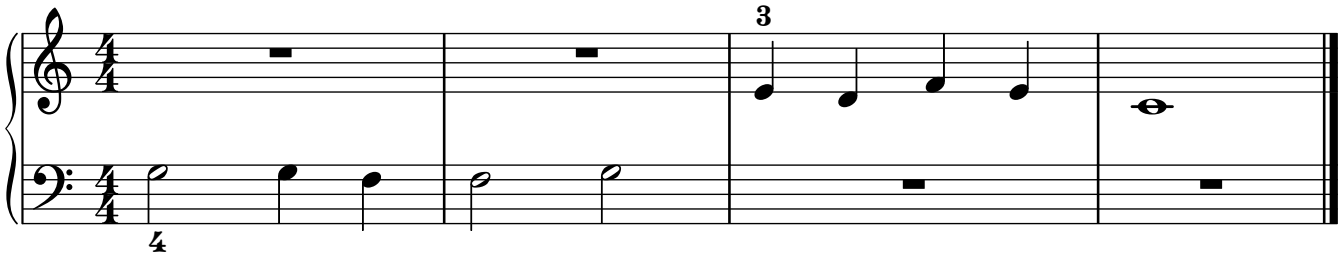
☐ **6.1**



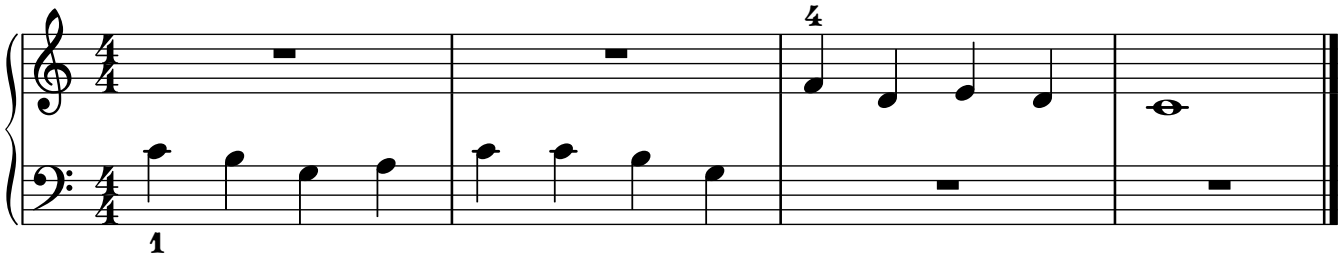
☐ **6.2**



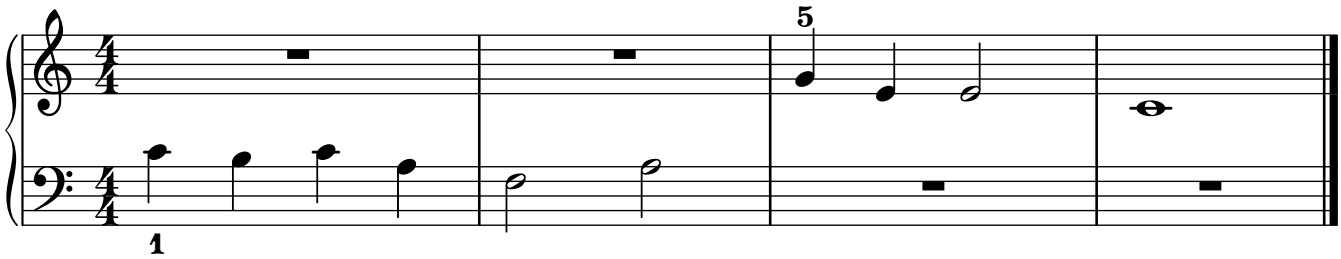
☐ **6.3**



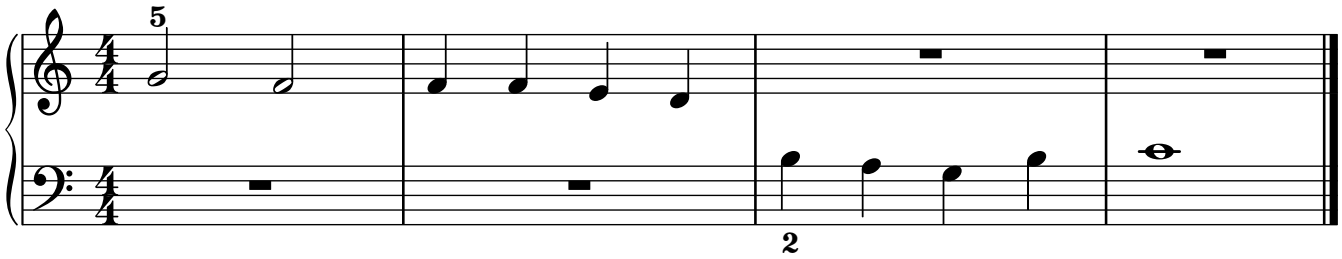
☐ **6.4**



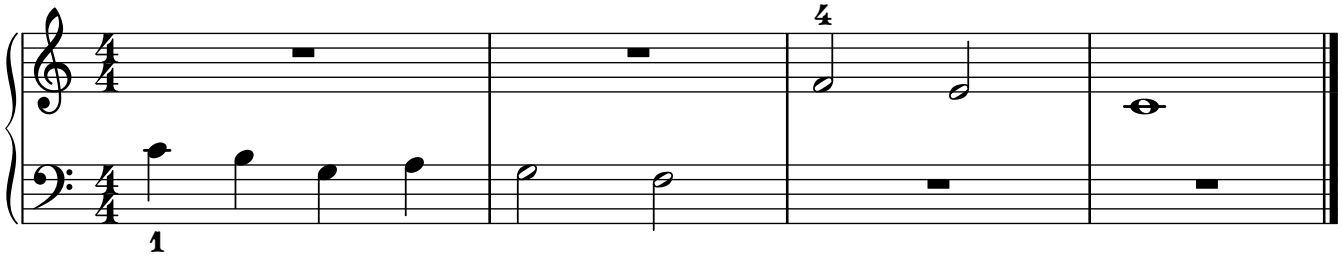
☐ **6.5**



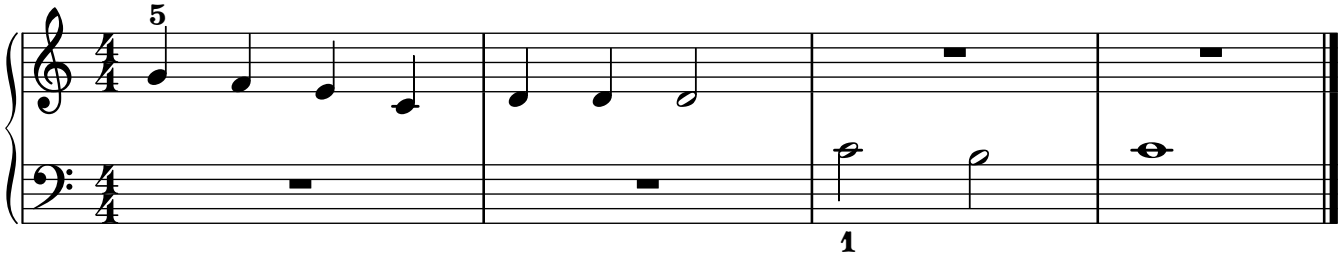
☐ **6.6**



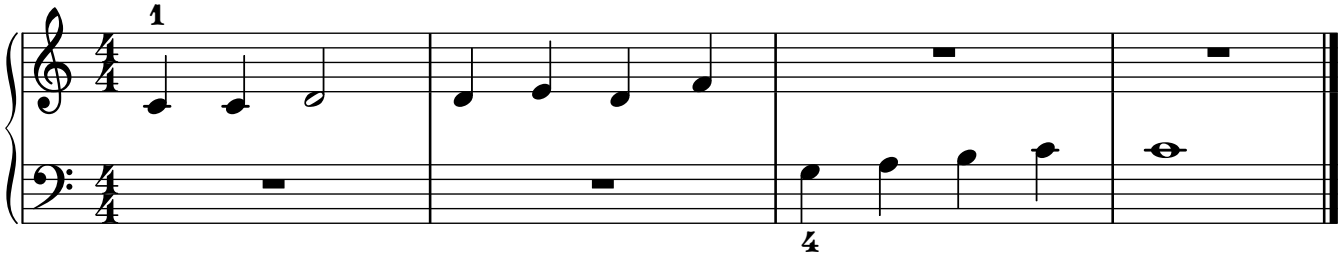
☐ **6.7**



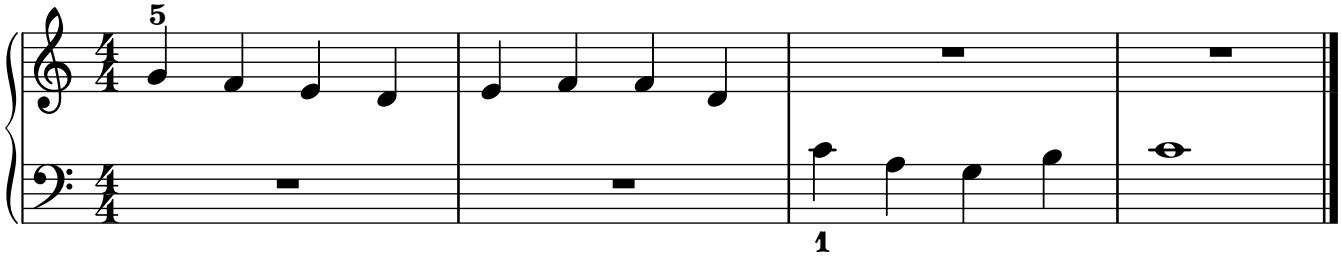
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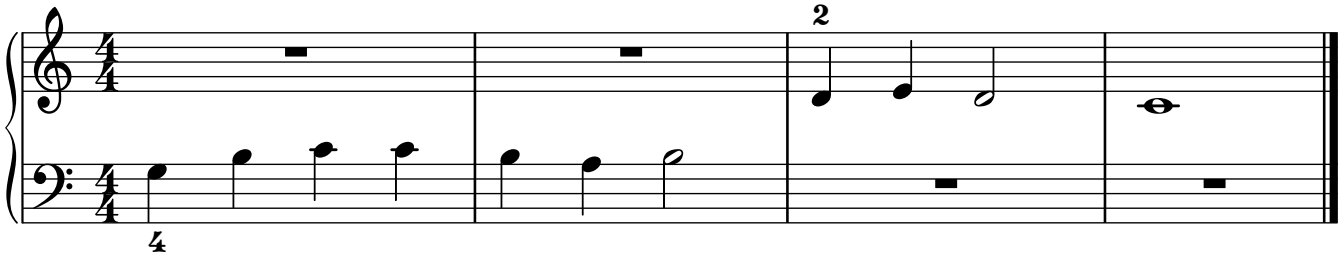
☐ **6.9**



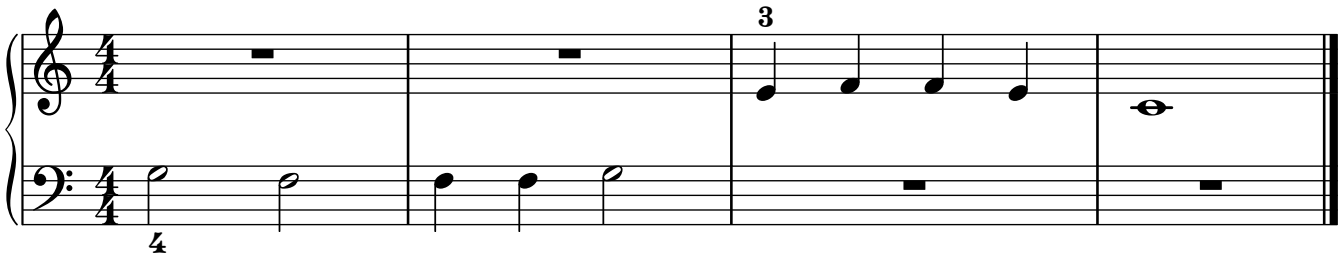
☐ **6.10**



☐ **6.11**



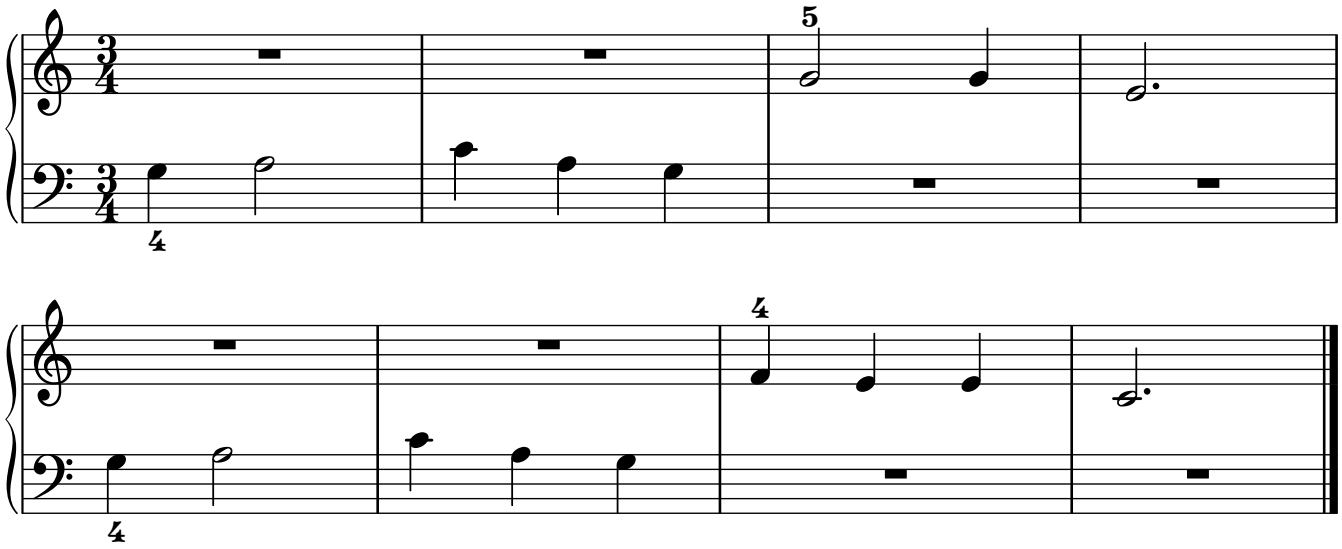
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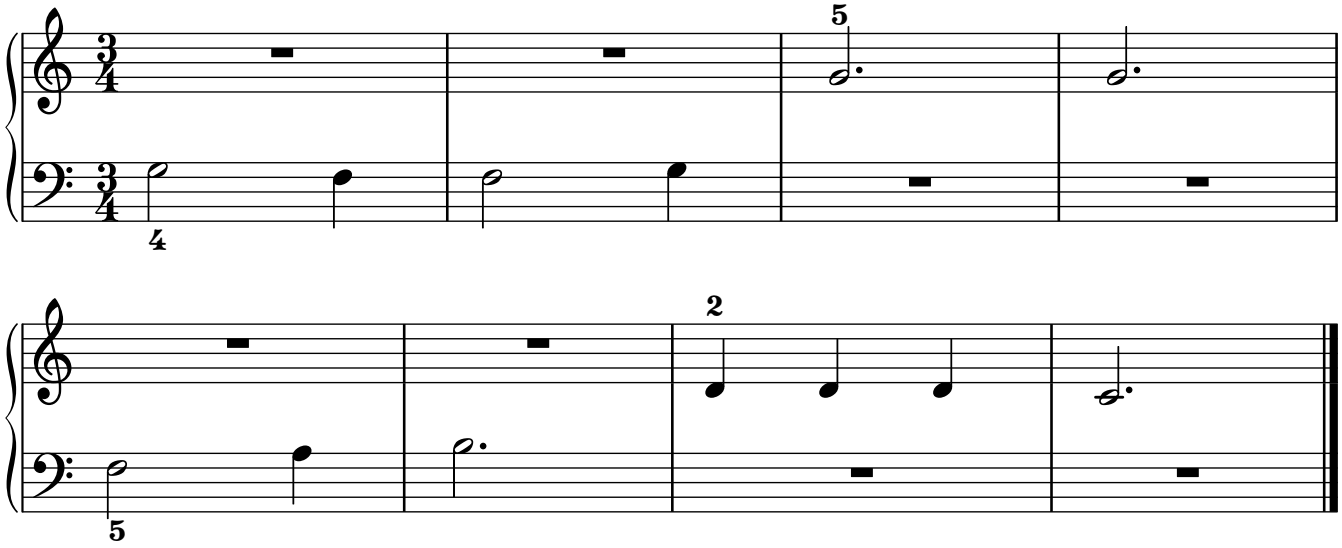
Part B: Longer phrases ♩ = 72

Eight-bar phrases in 3/4.

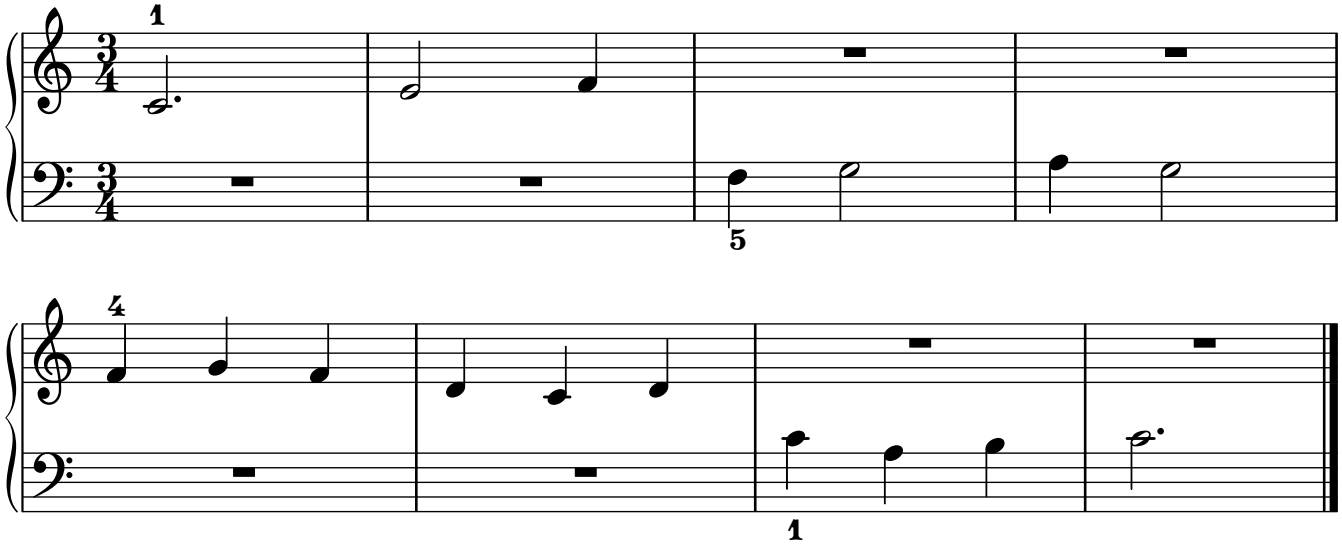
☐ **6.13**



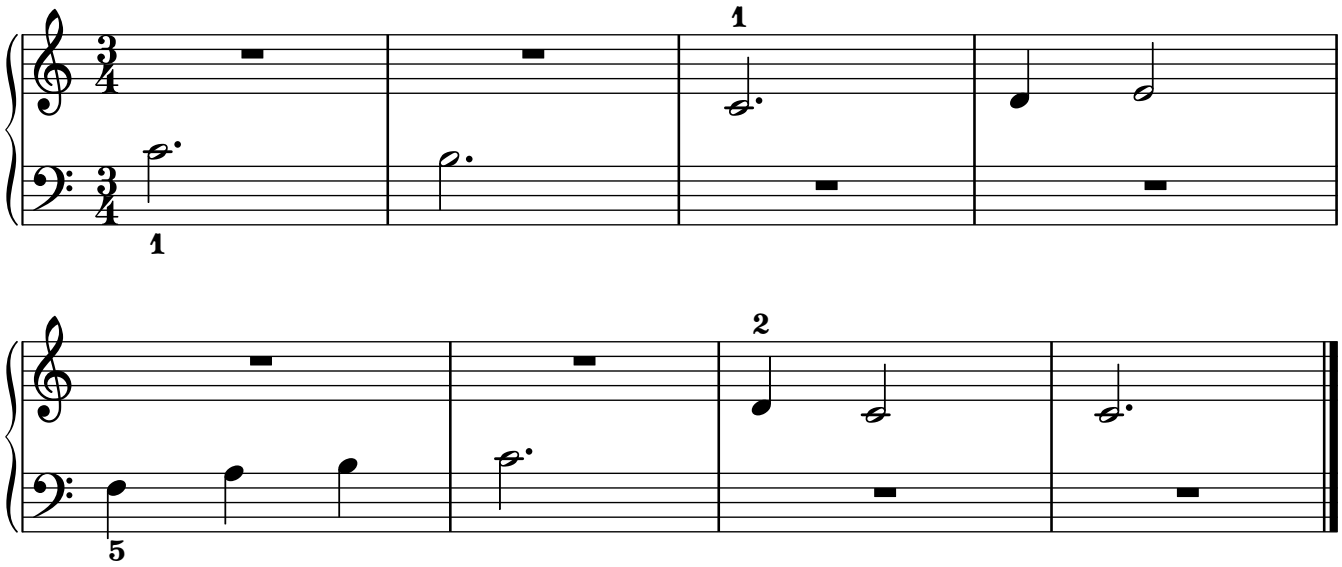
☐ **6.14**



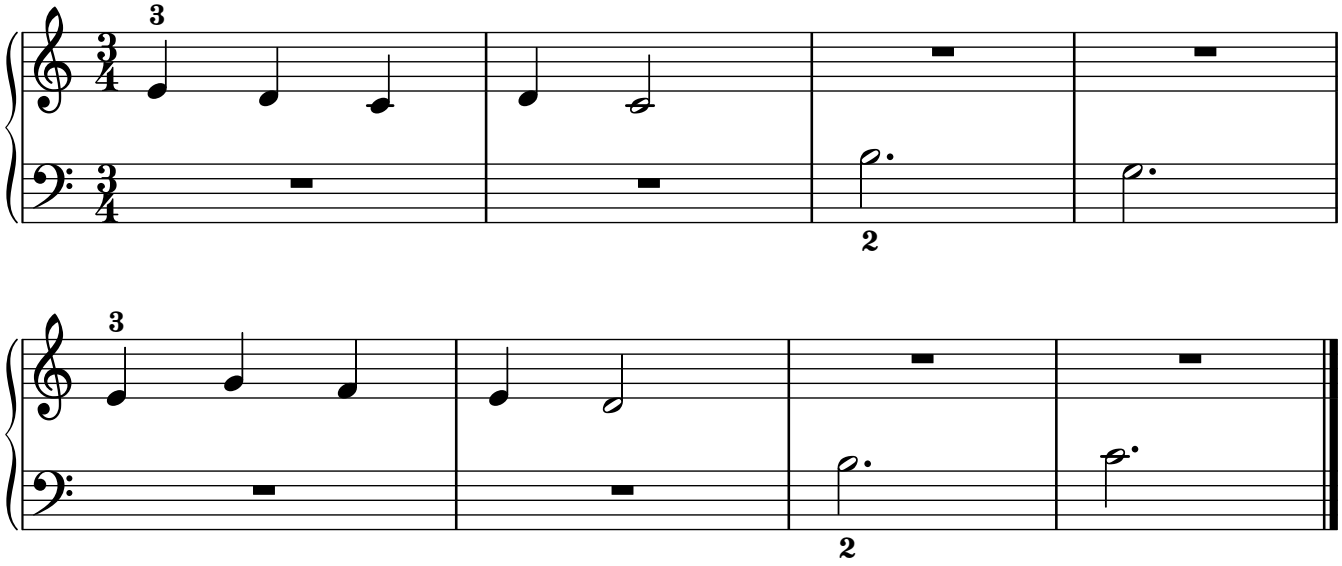
☐ **6.15**



6.16



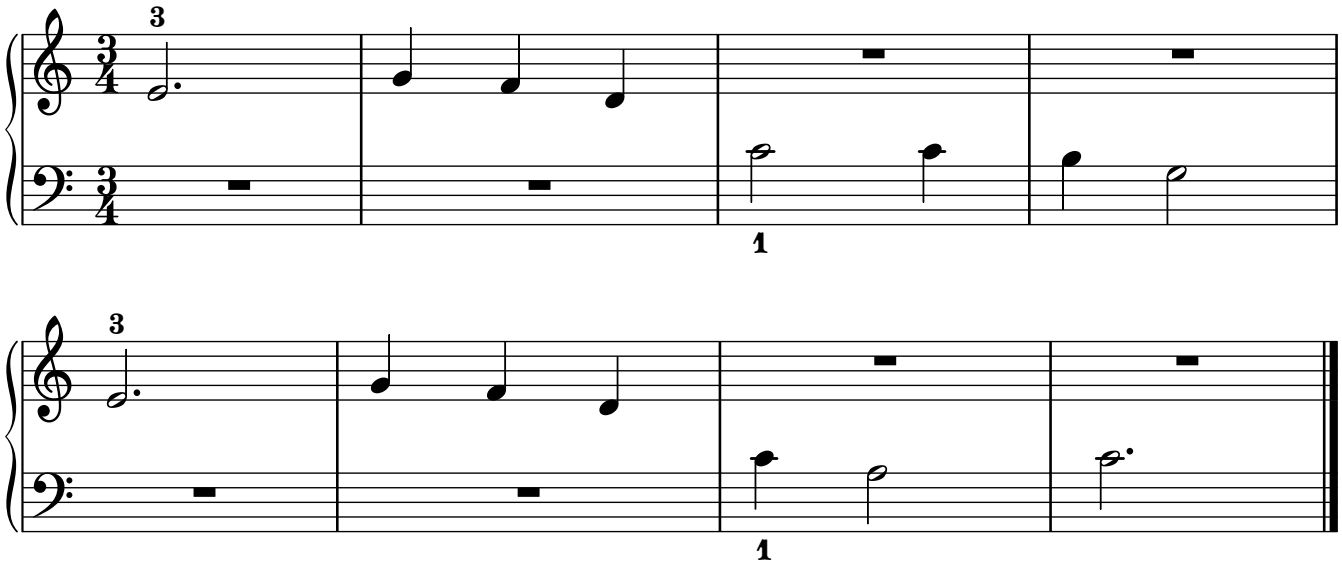
6.17



6.18



6.19



6.20



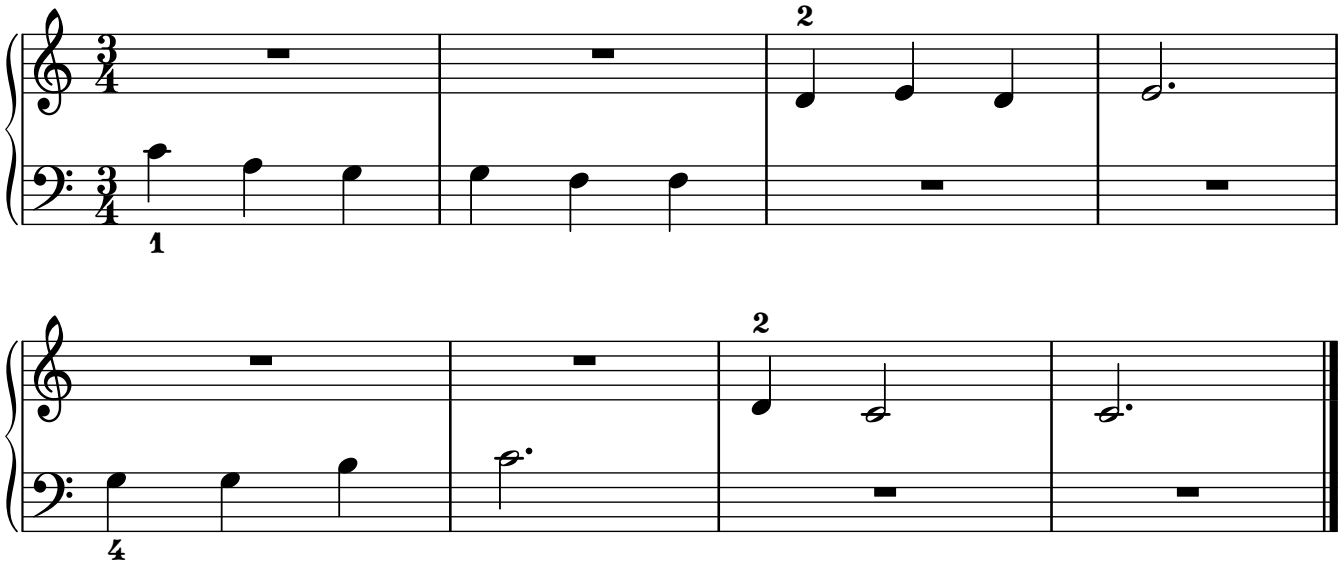
6.21



6.22



6.23



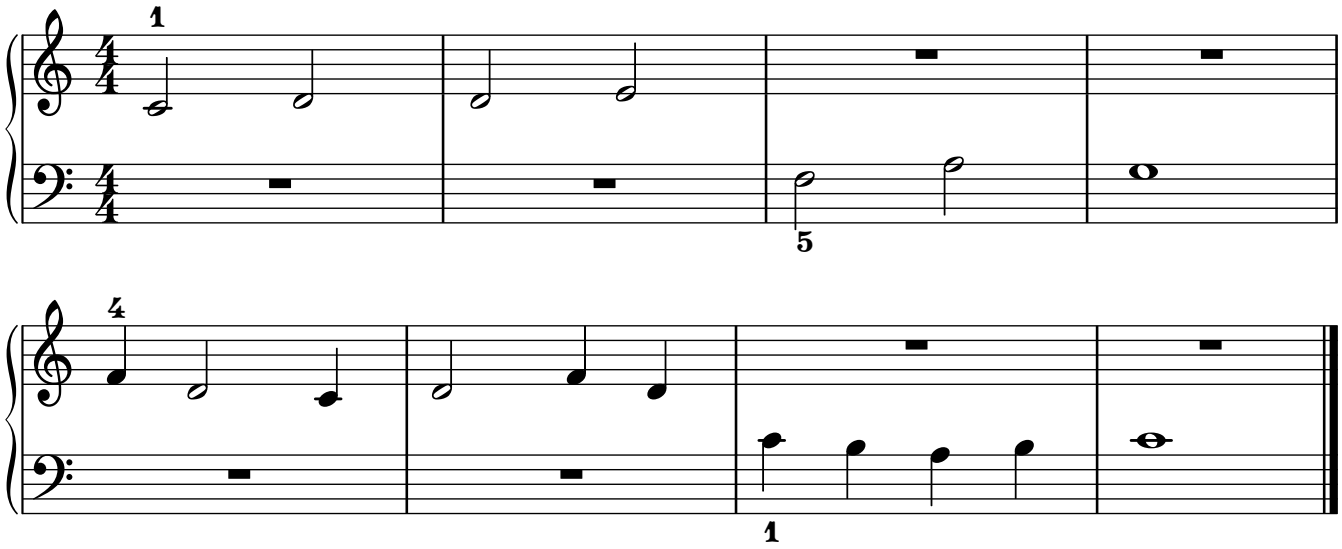
6.24



Part C: Eight bars in 4/4 ♩ = 66

Eight-bar phrases in 4/4, including whole notes and quarter-half-quarter rhythms.

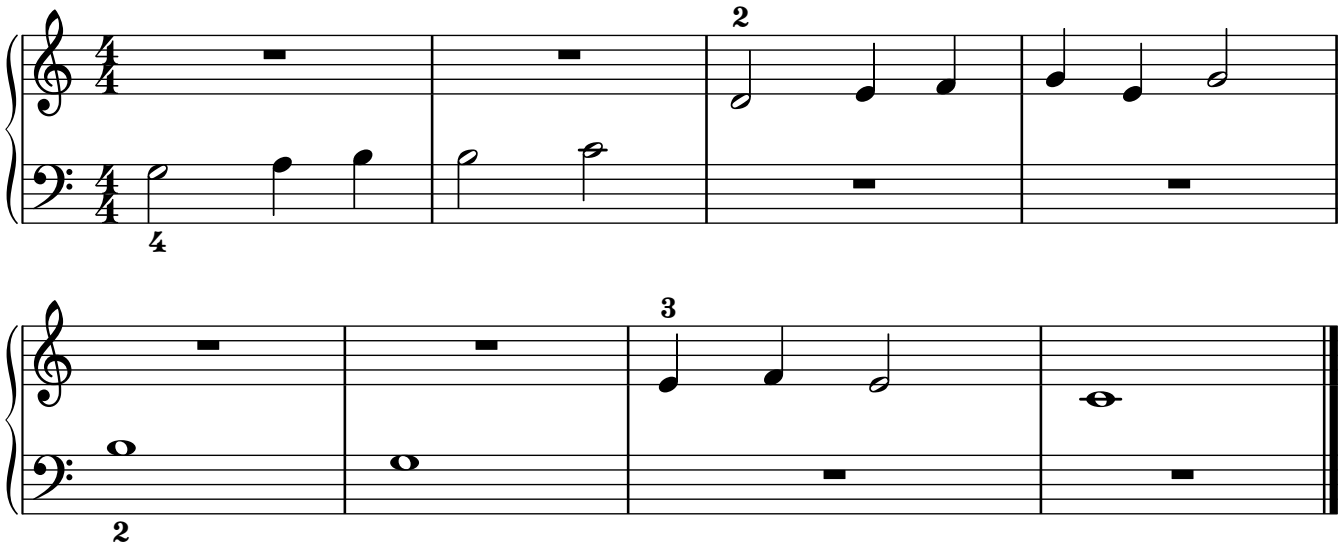
☐ **6.25**



☐ **6.26**



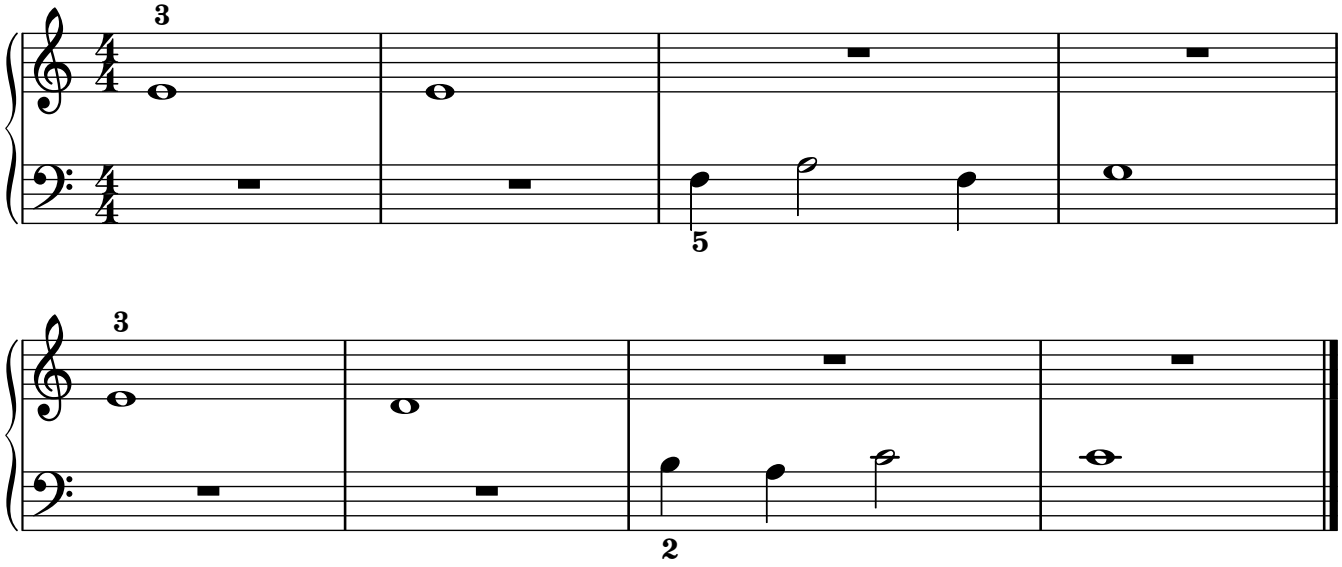
☐ **6.27**



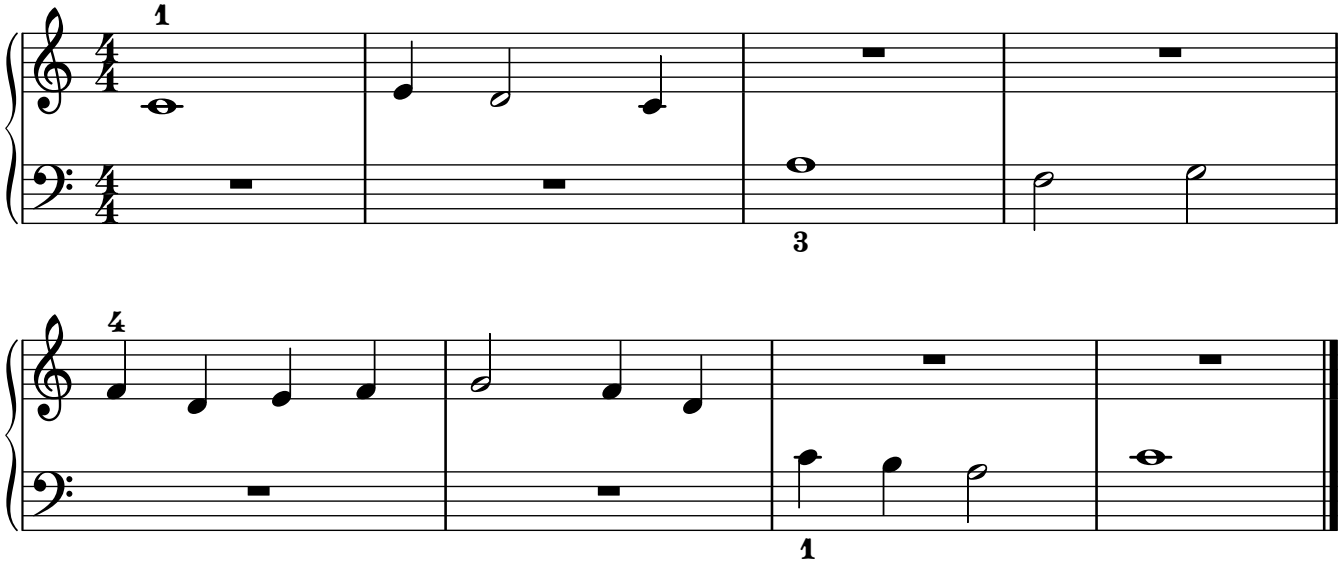
6.28



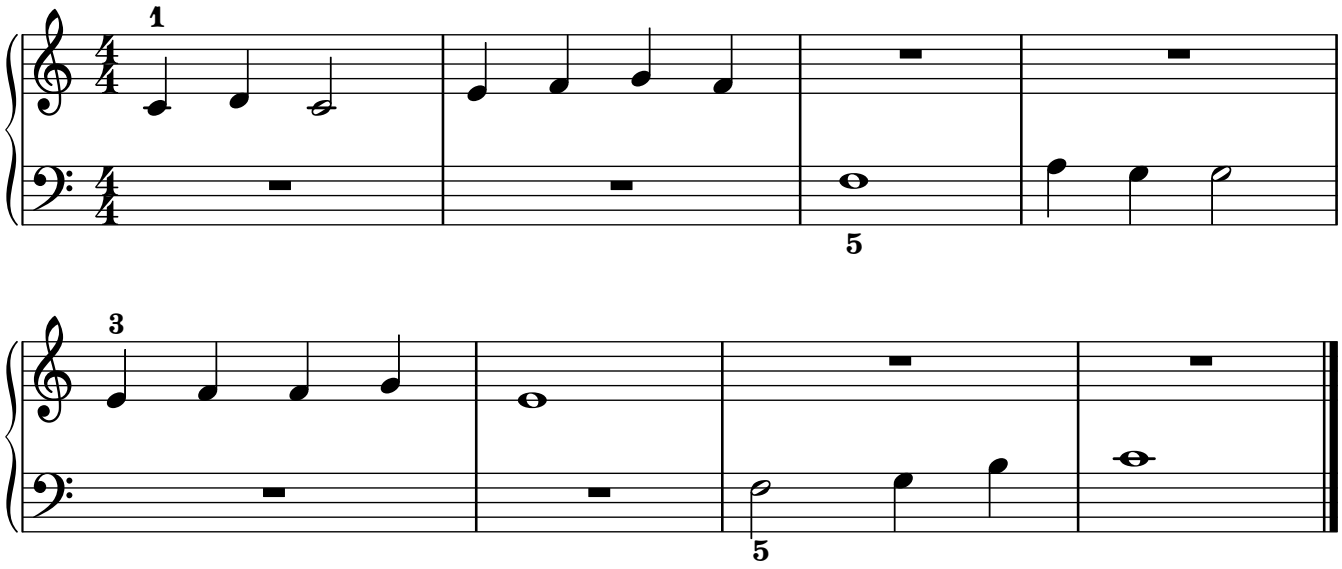
6.29



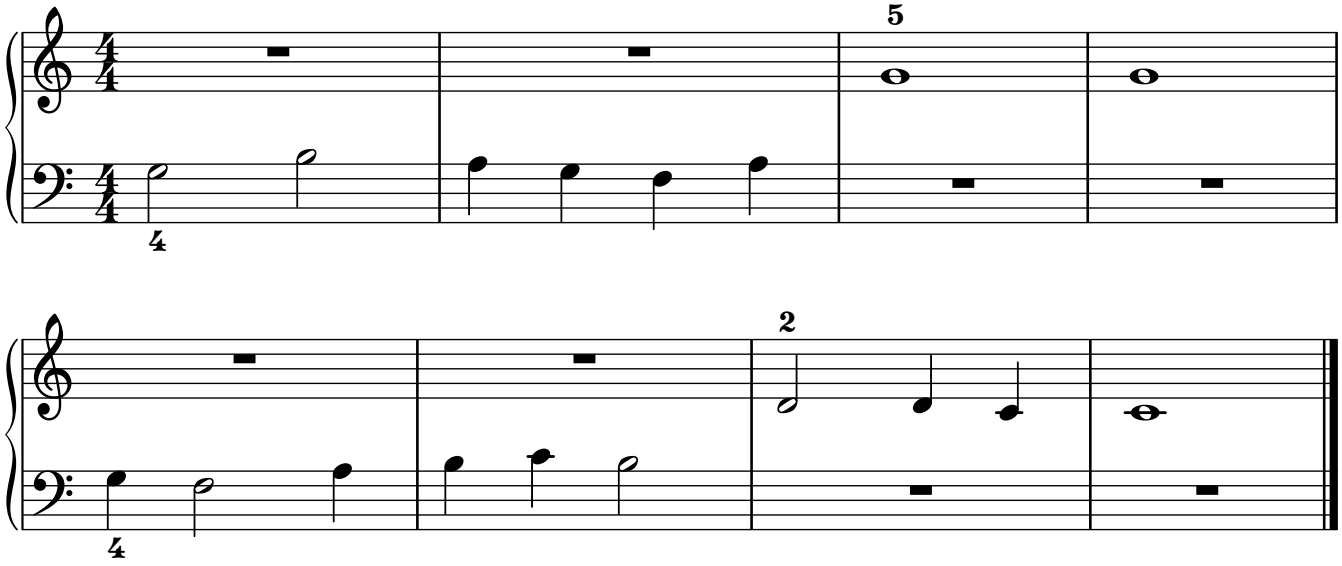
6.30



6.31



6.32



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Over the Bridge ♩ = 72

Original

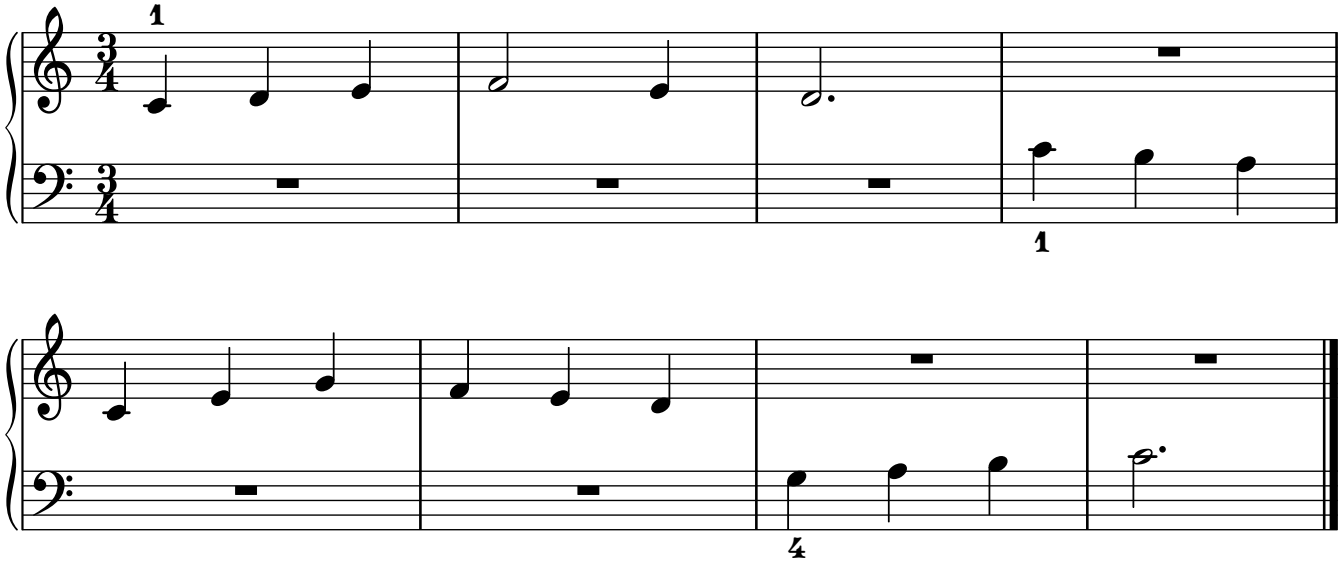
The tune walks down from the right hand, crosses middle C into the left hand, and comes back up again.



Sharing Middle C ♩ = 84

Original

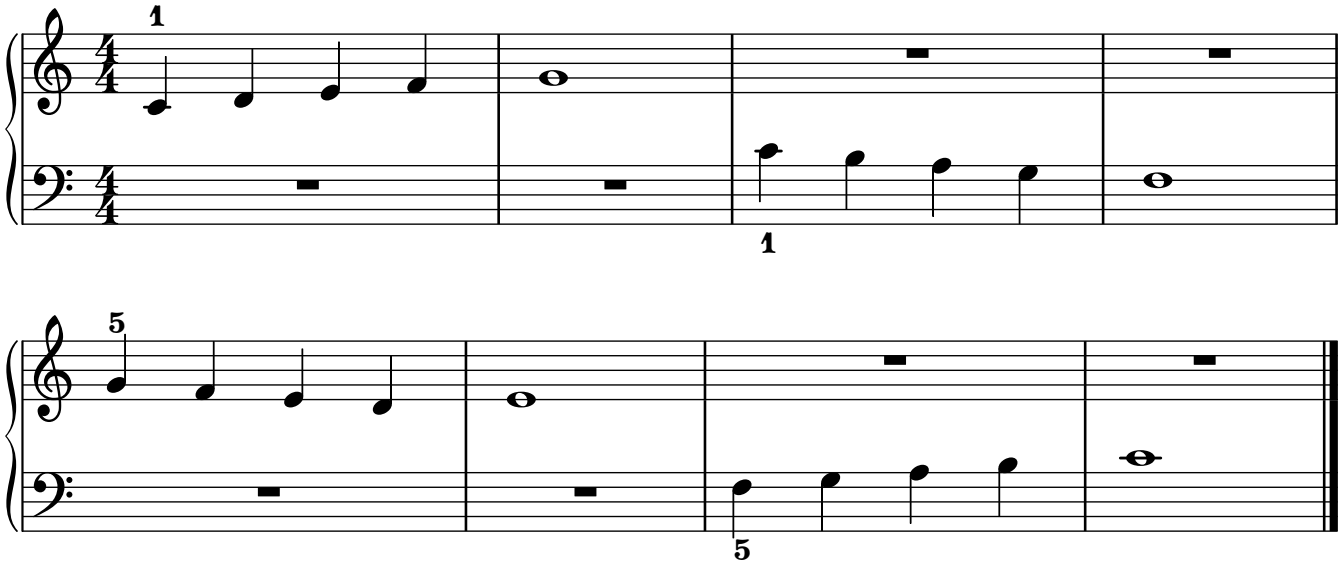
Both hands start on middle C. Watch which staff it is written on.



Echo Across Middle C ♩= 76

Original

The right hand climbs, the left hand answers by stepping down from middle C, and the two hands meet on middle C at the end.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 7?

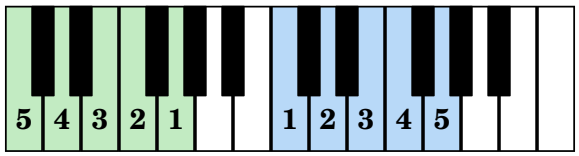
- Play five Part B or C exercises you have not played before, at the speed shown.
- Pass if you never hesitate over A, B or C at the top of the bass staff.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 7.

Unit 7

Rests and Ties

New: Quarter, half and whole rests; ties across the bar line

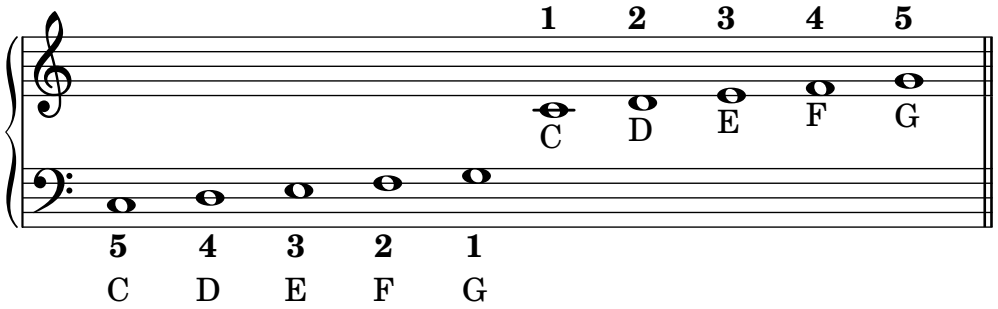
Music is made of sound and silence. A rest tells you to be silent for a number of beats, and you count those beats just as carefully as notes. A tie does the opposite: it makes one note last longer, even across a bar line.



Middle C

Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

Quarter rest

One beat of silence: the zig-zag sign.

Half rest

Two beats of silence: a small block sitting on top of the middle line, like a hat.

Whole rest

A small block hanging under the fourth line. It means a whole bar of silence, in any time signature.

The tie

A curved line joining two notes of the same pitch. Play the first note and hold it through the second; don't play the second again. It lasts as long as both values added together.

Tie or not?

A curve joining two different notes is not a tie (that is a slur, which comes later). In this unit every curve joins equal notes.

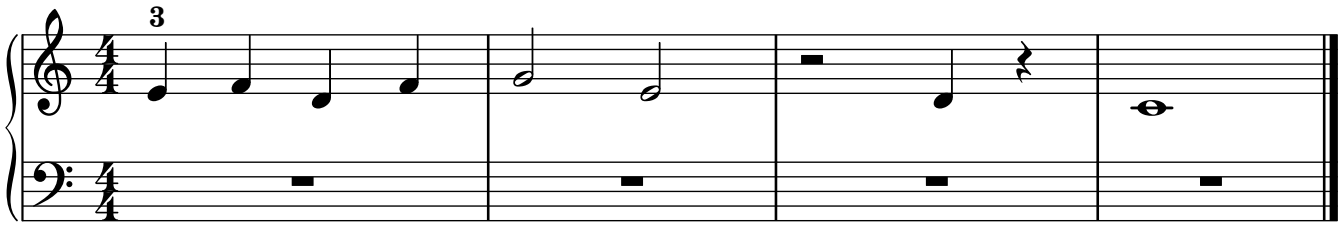
Reading tips

1. Count rests aloud just like notes. Saying 'rest' quietly on the silent beat helps.
2. Lift the finger during a rest so the sound really stops, but keep the hand on its keys.
3. When you see a tie crossing a bar line, start counting the new bar while you are still holding the note.
4. Rests are where most people lose the beat. Keep the metronome on.

Part A: Rests in the right hand ♩ = 60

Quarter and half rests in the right hand. Silence counts too. Metronome 60.

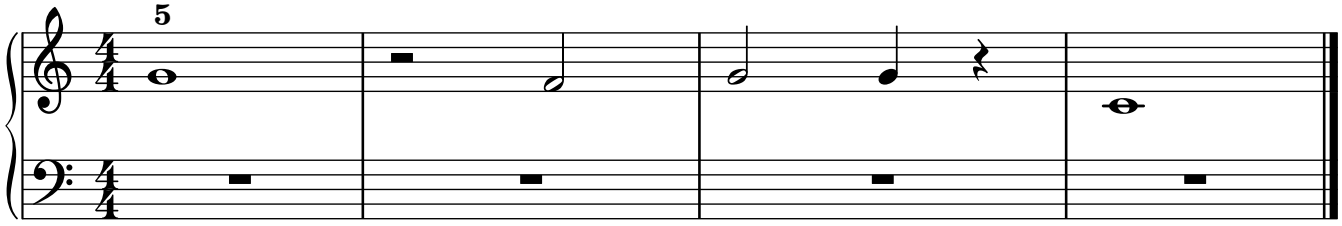
☐ **7.1**



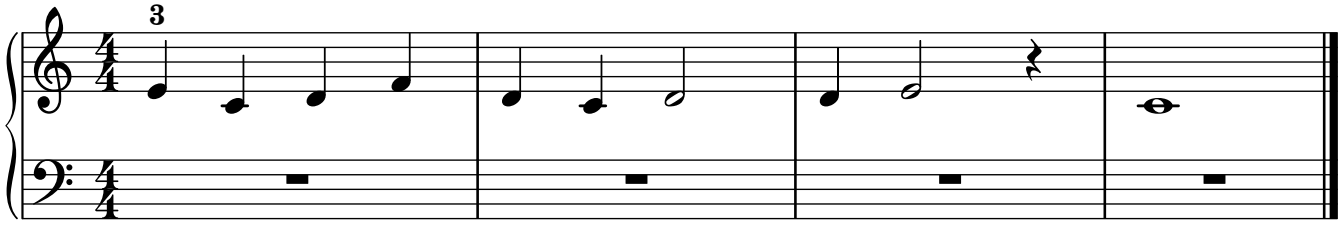
☐ **7.2**



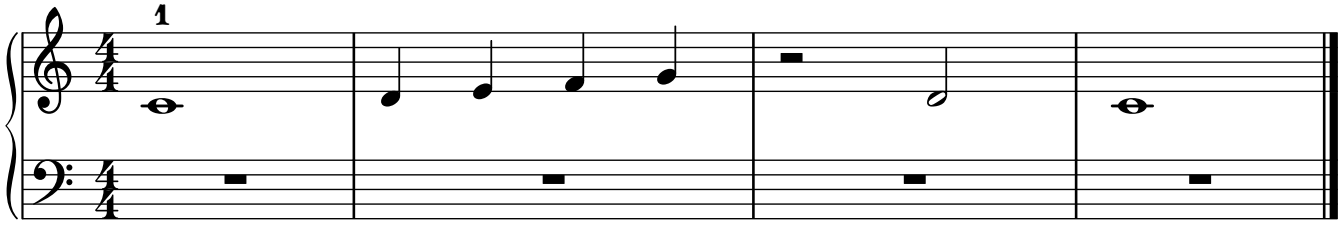
☐ **7.3**



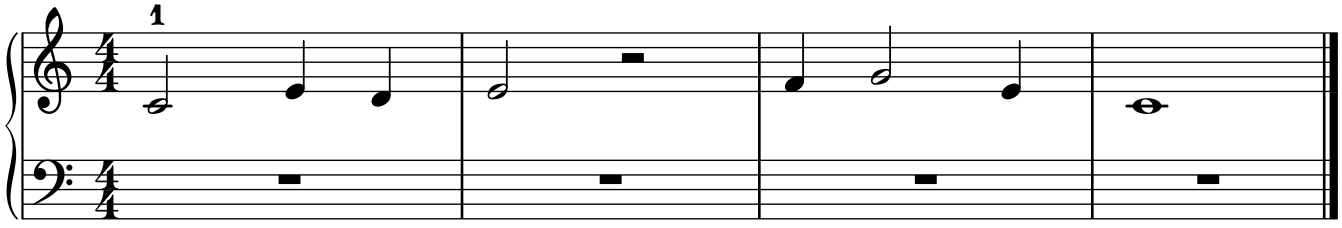
☐ **7.4**



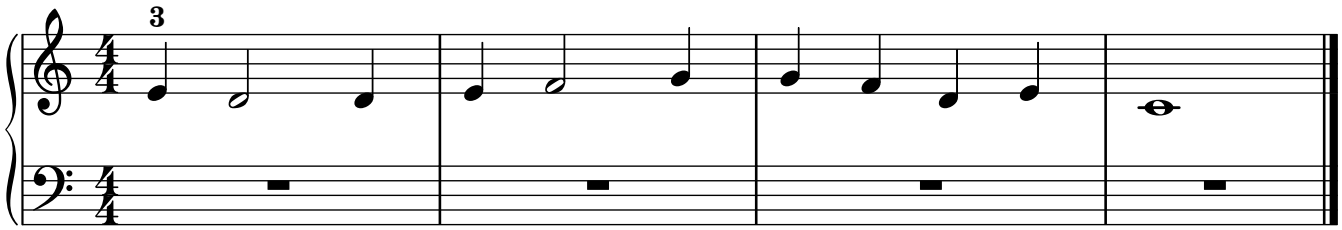
☐ **7.5**



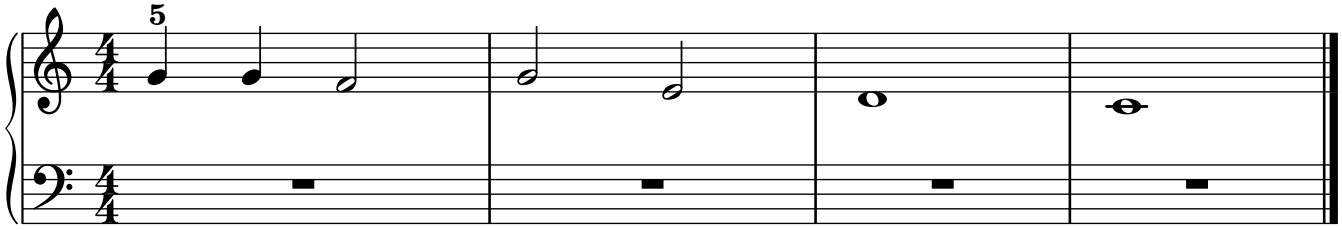
☐ **7.6**



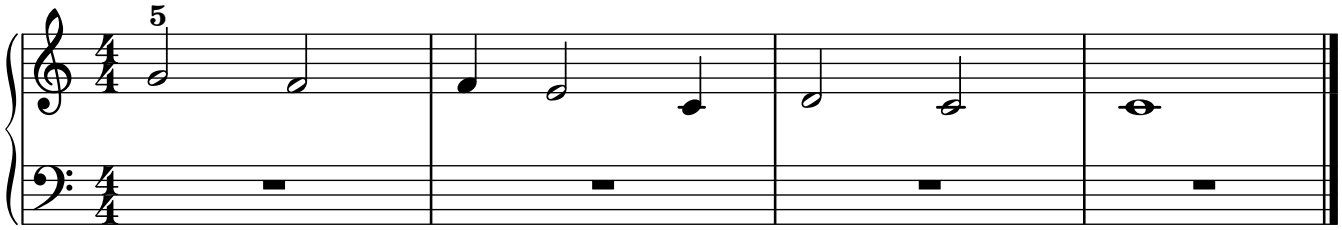
☐ **7.7**



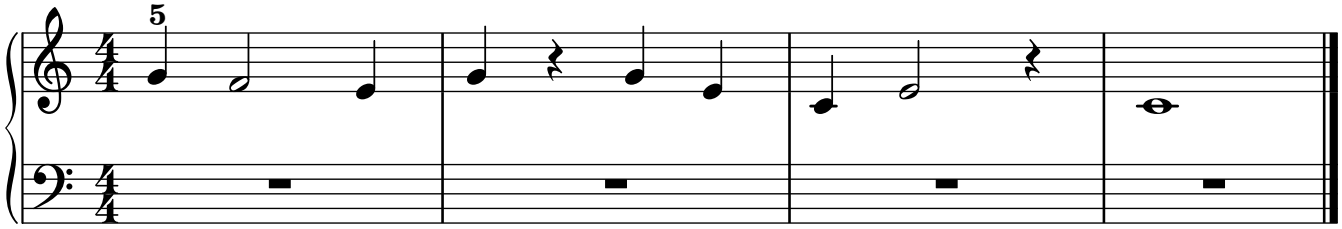
☐ **7.8**



☐ **7.9**



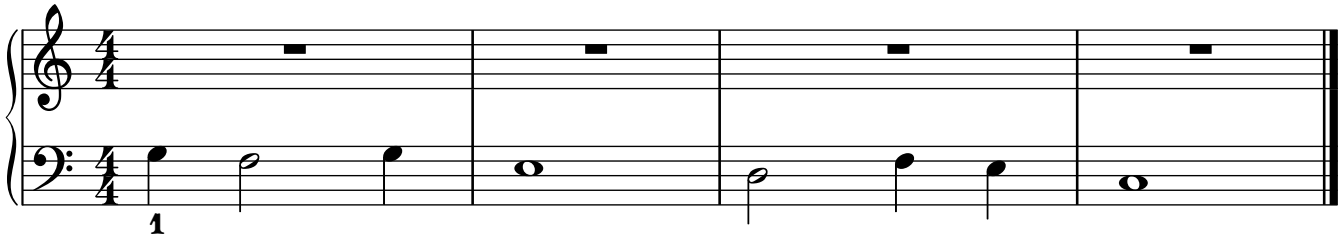
☐ **7.10**



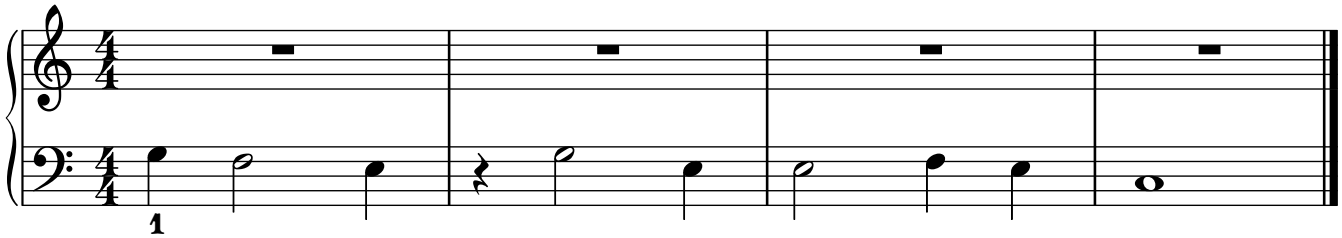
Part B: Rests in the left hand ♩ = 60

Rests in the left hand.

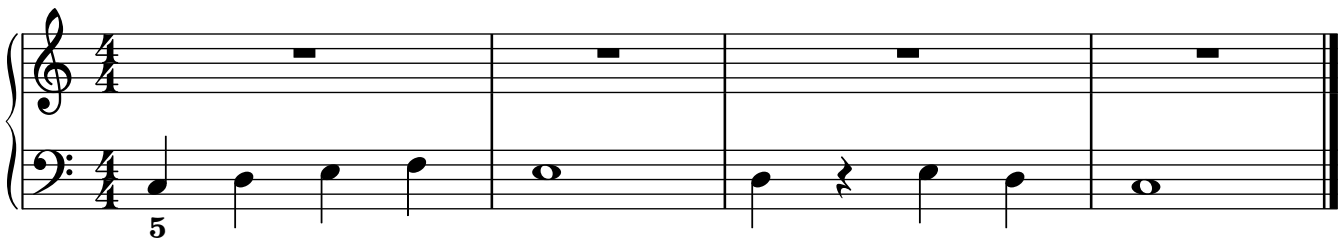
☐ **7.11**



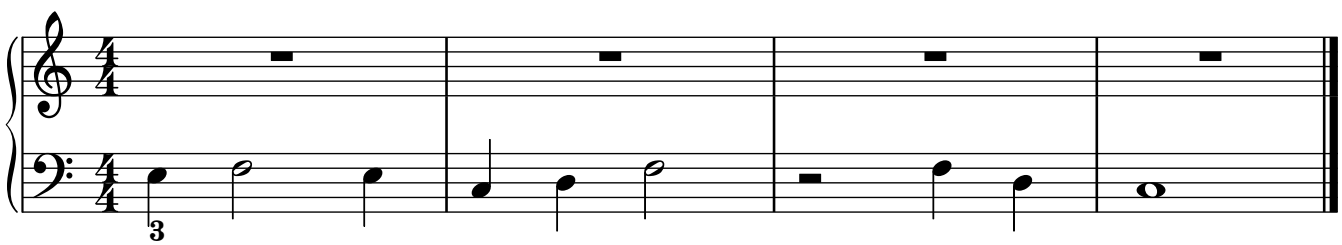
☐ **7.12**



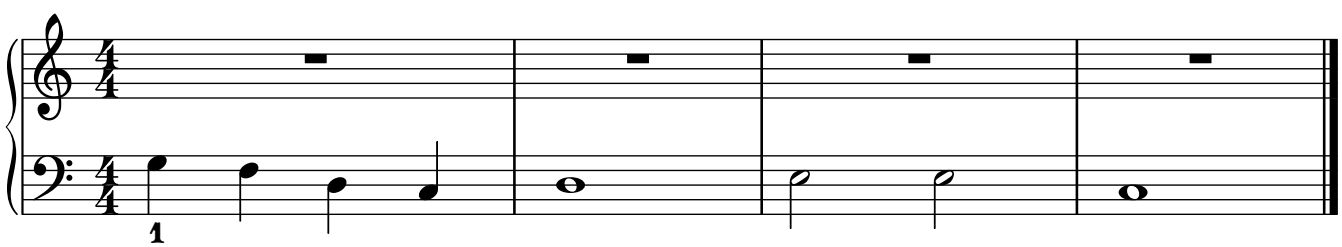
☐ **7.13**



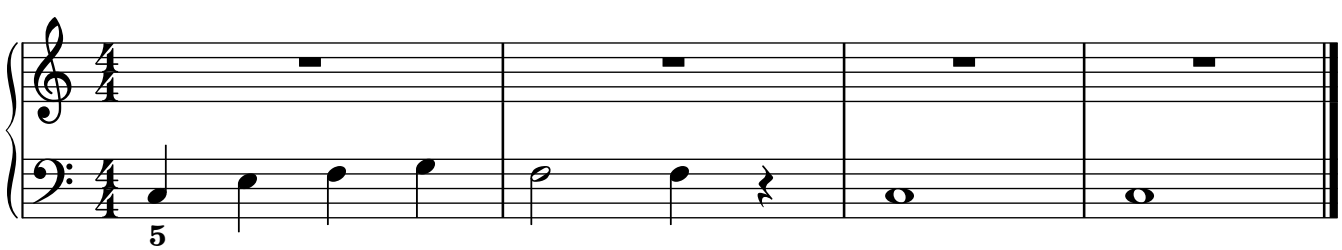
☐ **7.14**



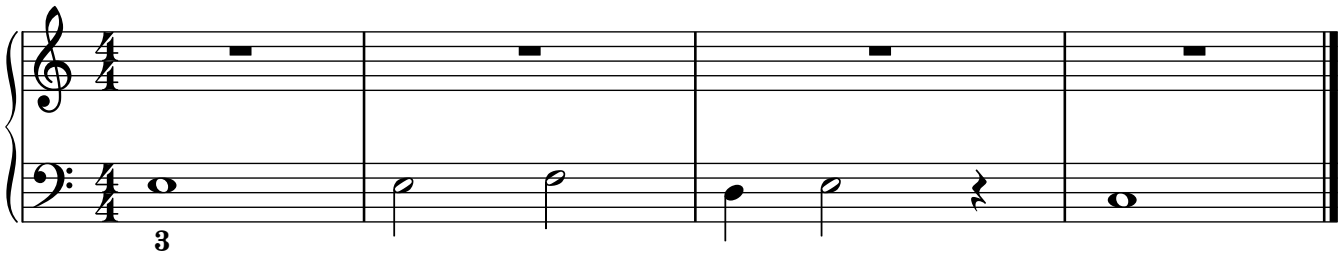
☐ **7.15**



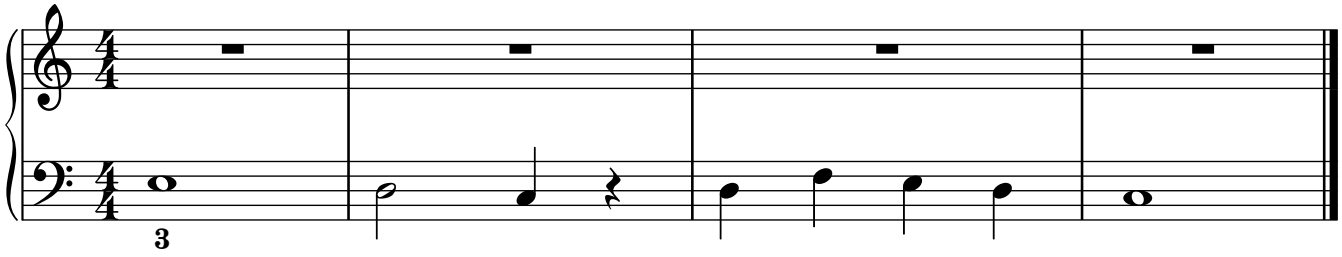
☐ **7.16**



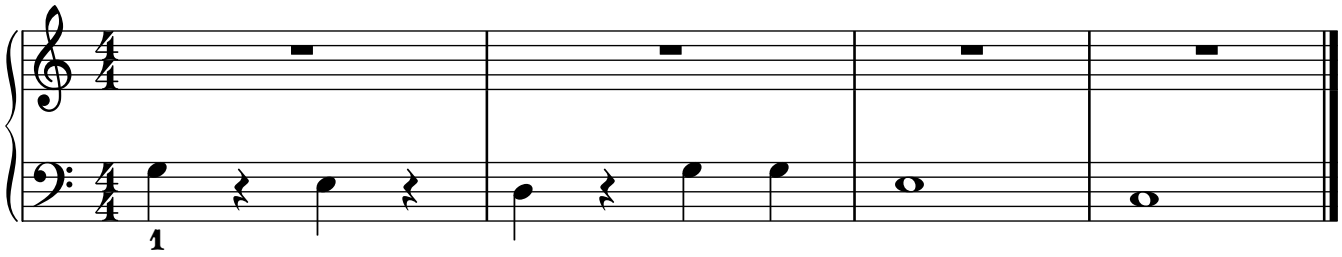
☐ **7.17**



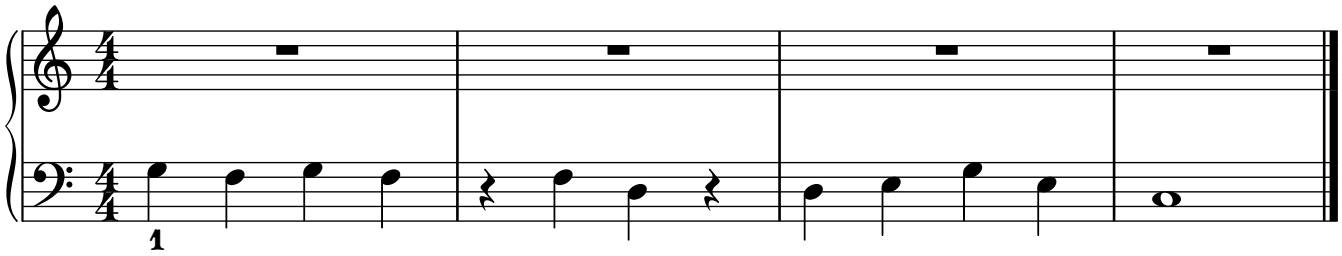
☐ **7.18**



☐ **7.19**



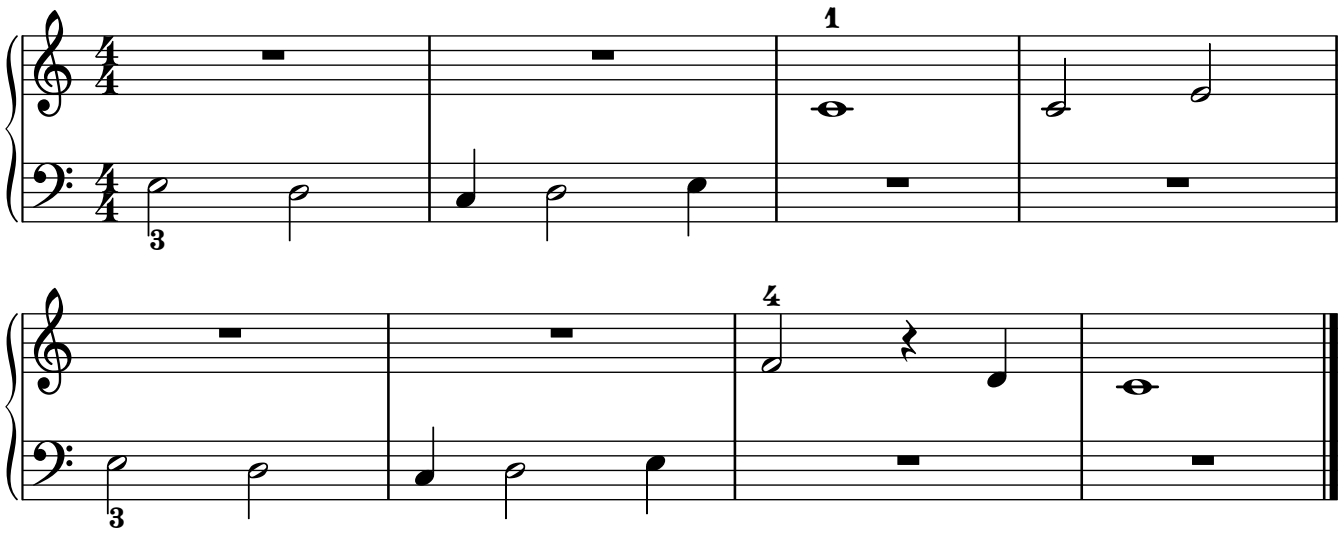
☐ **7.20**



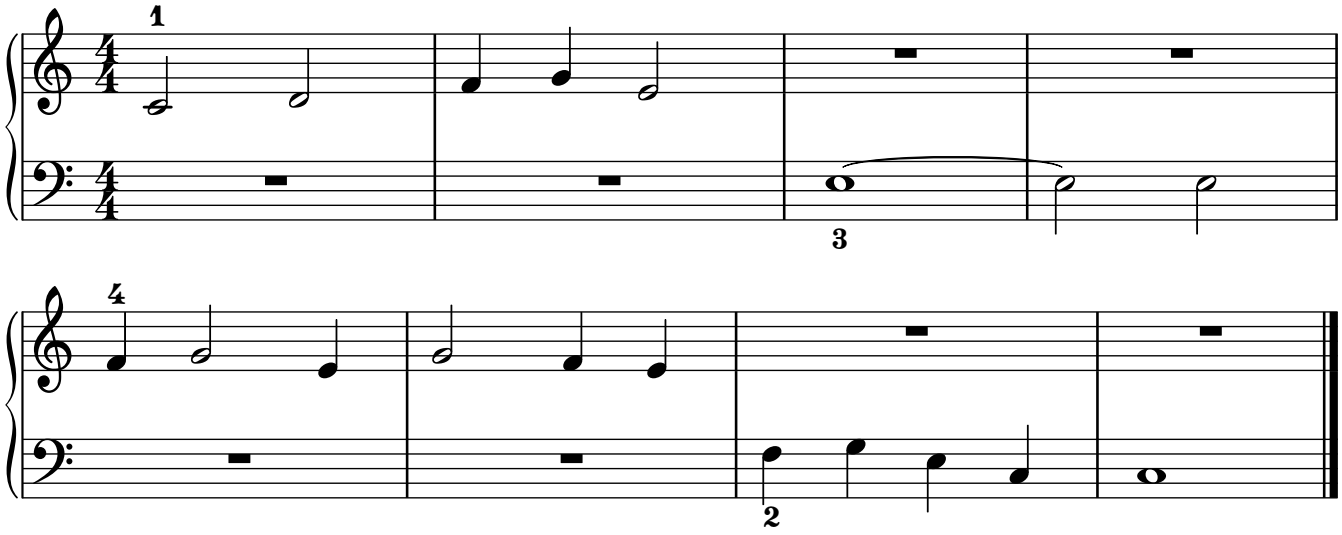
Part C: Ties across the bar line ♩= 66

Ties across the bar line, with the hands taking turns. Hold the tied note; don't play it again.

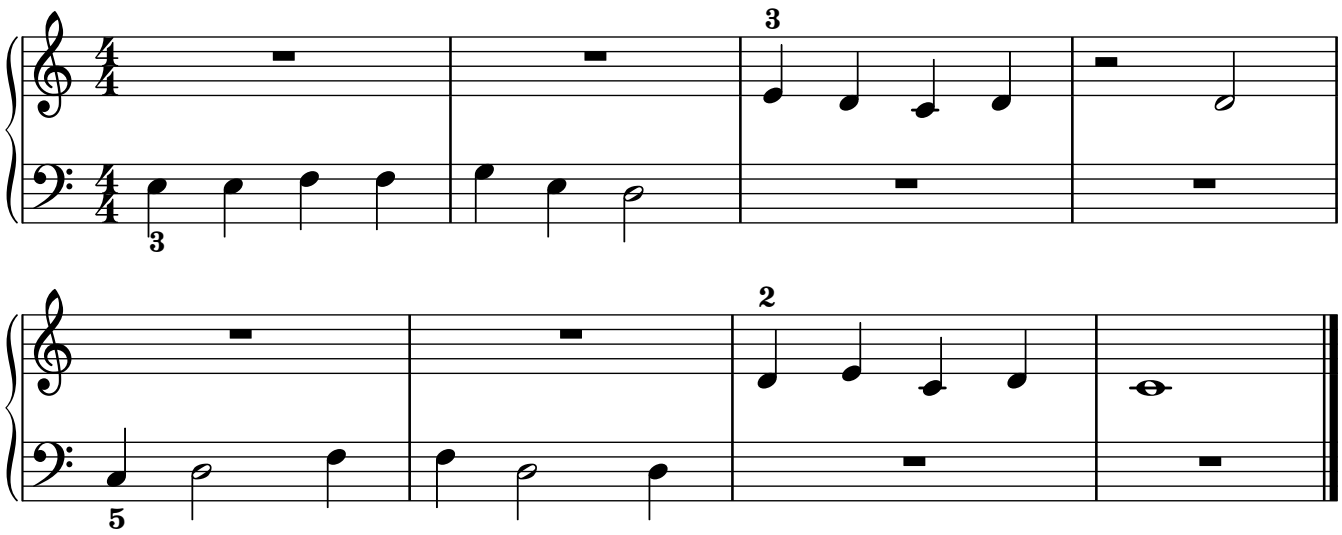
☐ **7.21**



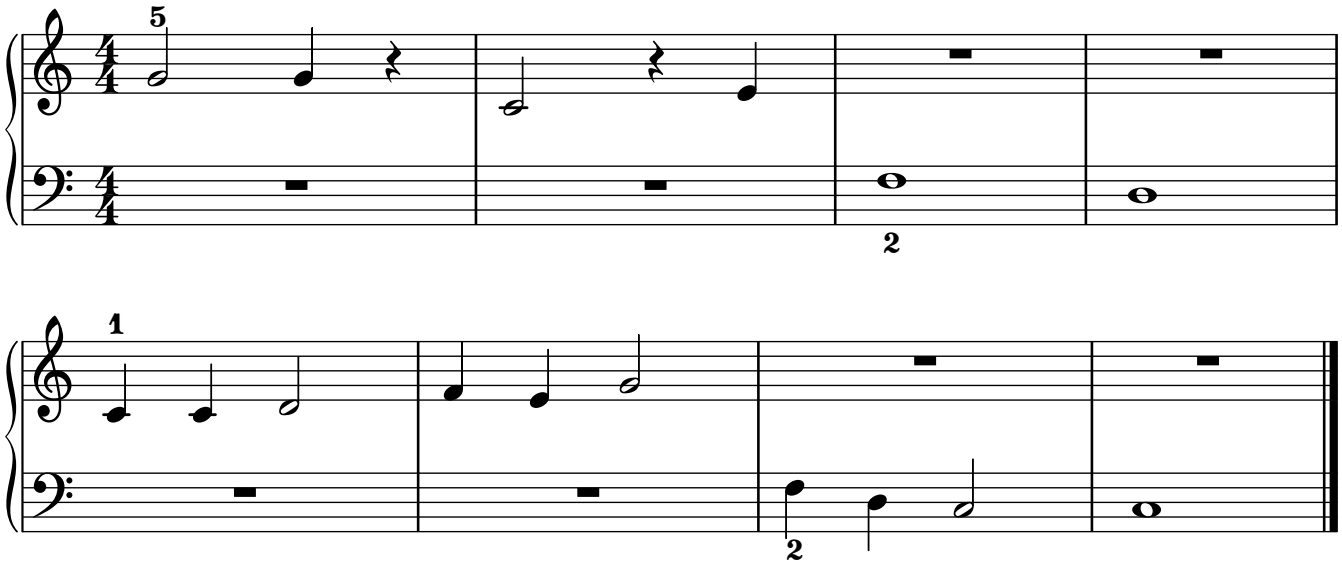
☐ **7.22**



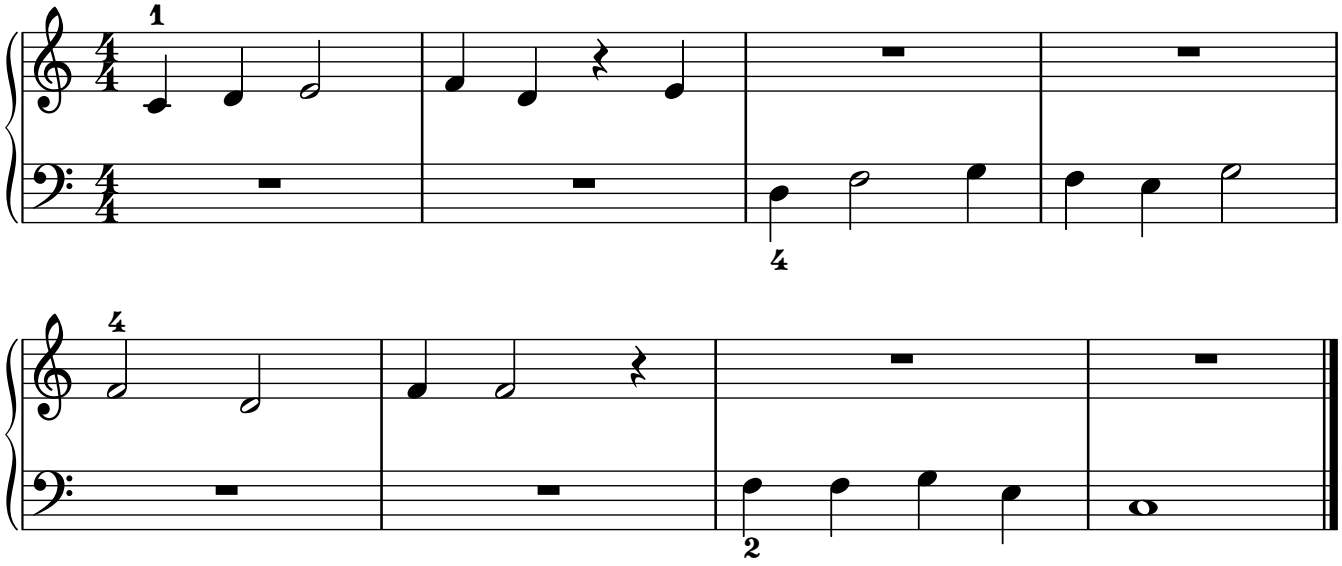
☐ **7.23**



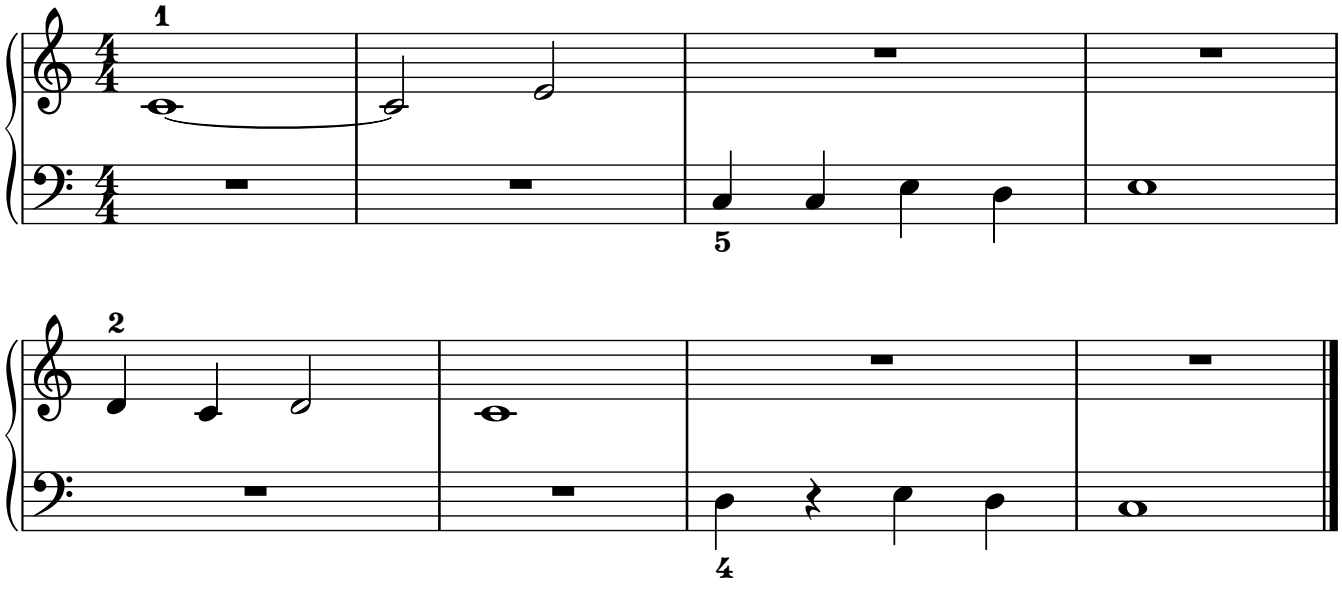
7.24



7.25



7.26



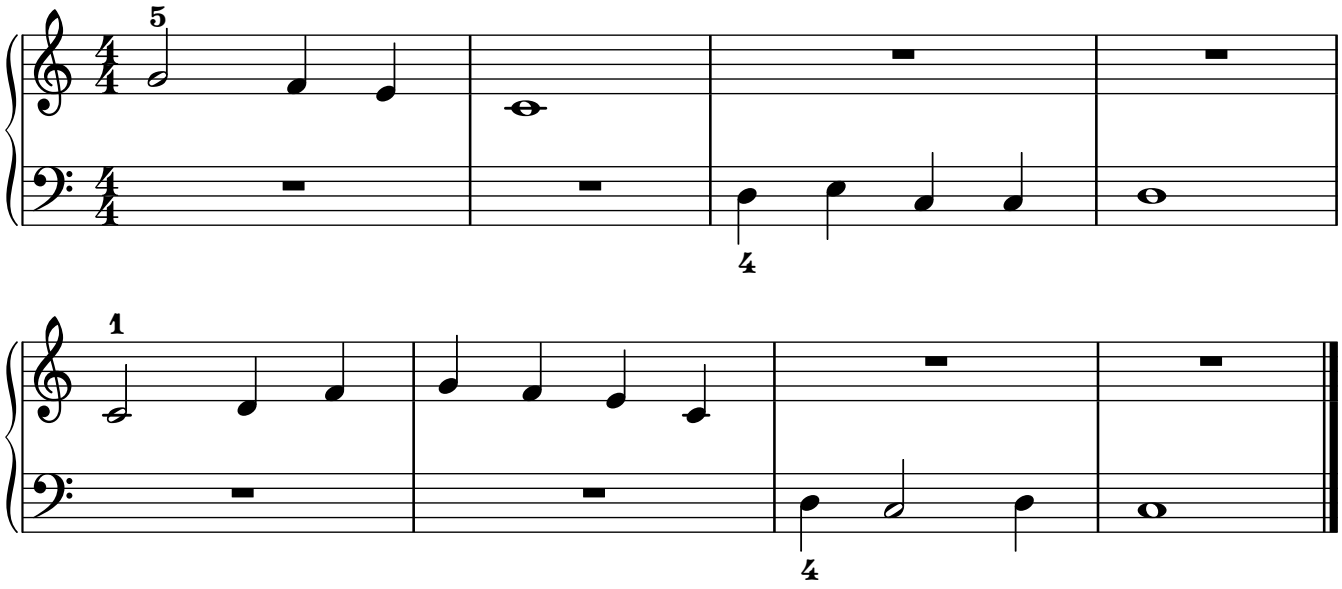
7.27



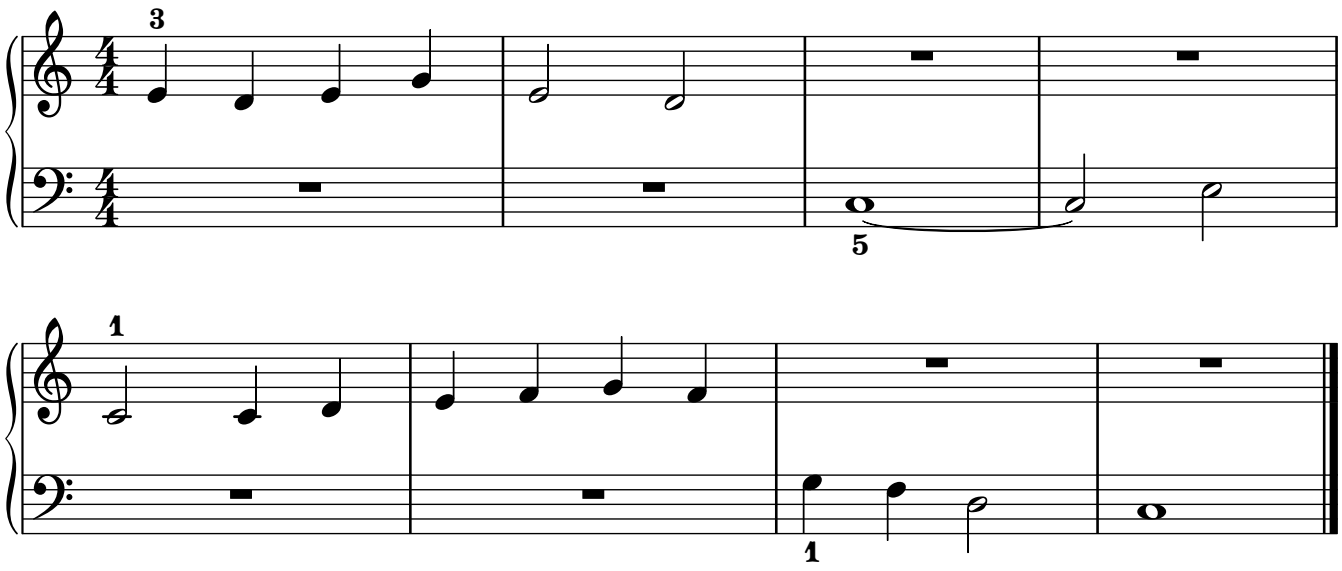
7.28



7.29



7.30



Part D: Rests and ties, hands together

♩ = 72

Hands together in 3/4, with rests and ties in the right hand.

☐ **7.31**



☐ **7.32**



☐ **7.33**



7.34



7.35



7.36



7.37



7.38



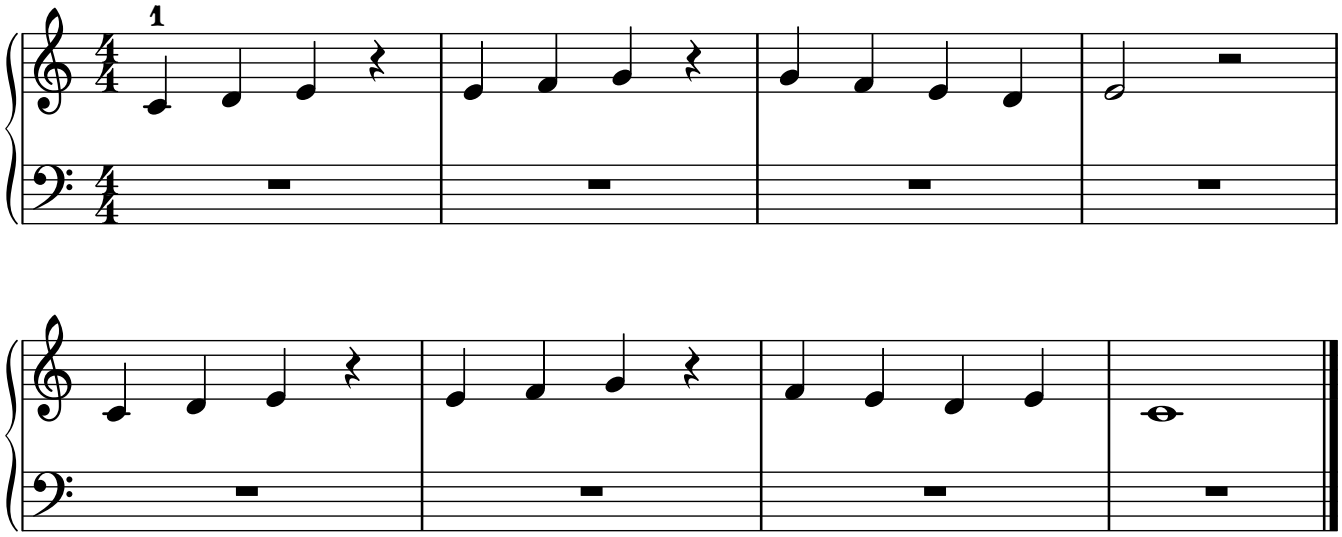
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Stop and Go ♩ = 80

Original

Three notes, then a one-beat stop, like traffic lights. Lift the finger on every rest.



Long Notes ♩ = 72

Original

The ties in bars 2 and 6 make notes six beats long. Count all six beats.



Hide and Seek ♩ = 76

Original

Notes and rests alternate, and the hands take turns. Keep counting through every silent beat.



Clock Tower ♩ = 84

Original

Big, ringing bell notes. Tied notes hold across the bar line; the left hand rings once in every bar.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 8?

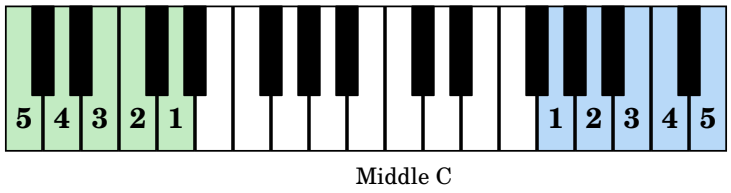
- Play five Part C or D exercises you have not played before, at the speed shown.
- Pass if every rest gets its full length, with no rushing to the next note.
- Pass if no tied note is played twice, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 8, where your hands move to a new position.

Unit 8

G Position

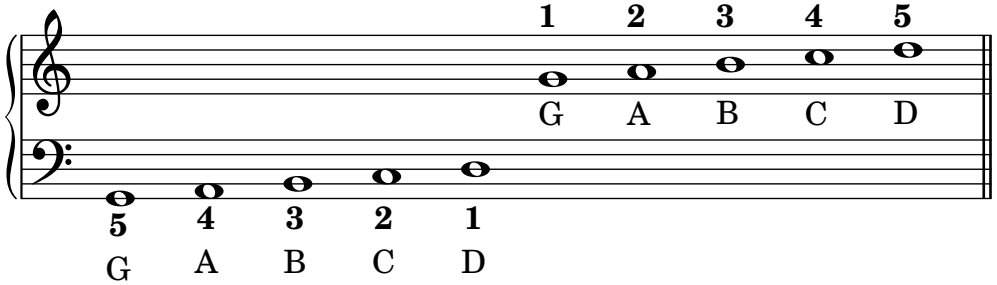
New: Moving the hands to G; fourths and fifths

Both hands now move to a new home: G position. Right thumb on the G above middle C, fingers on G A B C D. Left little finger on the G that sits on the bottom line of the bass staff, fingers on G A B C D. You will also read bigger leaps: fourths and fifths.



Left hand G position and Right hand G position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

New treble notes

G on the second line (where the clef curls), A in the second space, B on the middle line, C in the third space, D on the fourth line.

New bass notes

G on the bottom line, A in the bottom space, B on the second line, C in the second space, D on the middle line.

Naming intervals

Count the letter names, including both ends: C to D is a 2nd (a step), C to E a 3rd (a skip), C to F a 4th, C to G a 5th.

4ths and 5ths on the staff

A 4th goes from a line to a space (or a space to a line), jumping over two notes. A 5th goes from a line to the line after next, or a space to the space after next.

5ths in the hand

In a five-finger position a 5th is always thumb to little finger, so you can play it without naming the second note.

Reading tips

1. Your hands have moved. Before each exercise, use the finger number on the first note to check which key you start on.

2. Use the G landmarks: the treble clef curls around G, and the bass staff's bottom line is G.

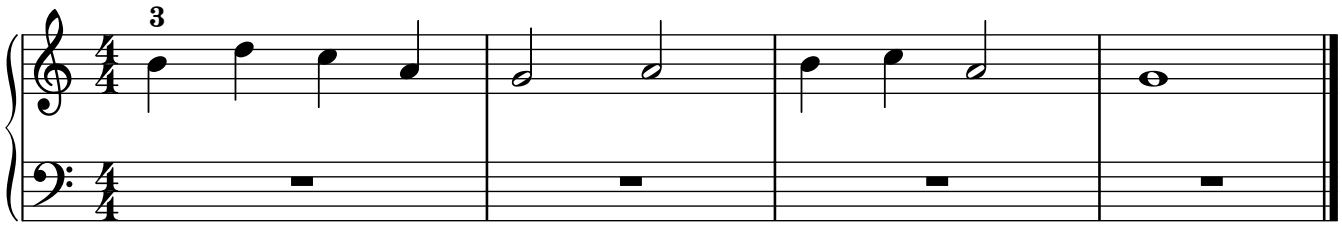
3. Read 4ths and 5ths as shapes: line-to-space jumps, and line-to-line or space-to-space jumps with one line or space in between.

4. Bigger leaps tempt you to look down. Trust the position: every note is still under a finger.

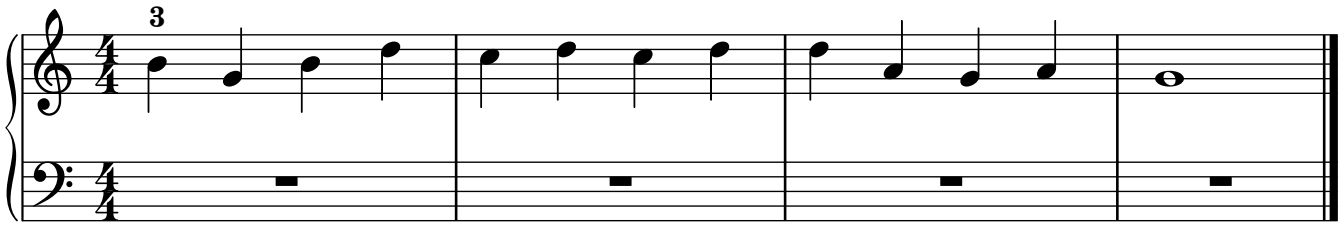
Part A: Right hand in G ♩= 60

Right hand in G position, with intervals up to a 5th. Metronome 60.

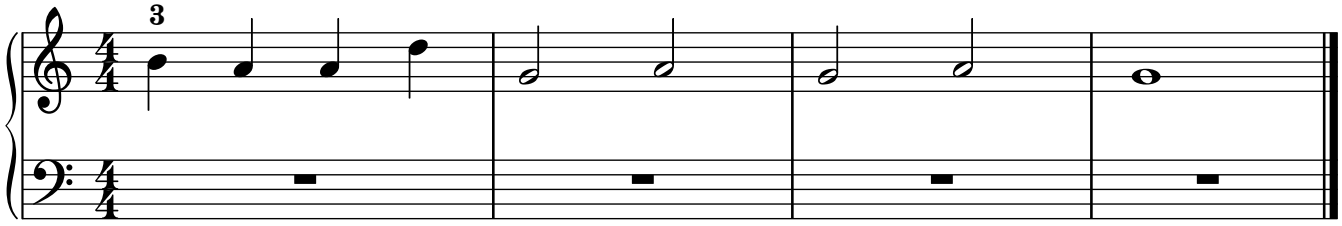
☐ **8.1**



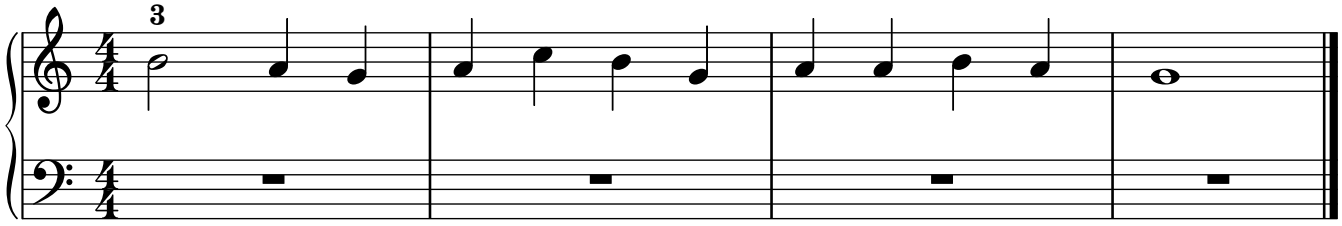
☐ **8.2**



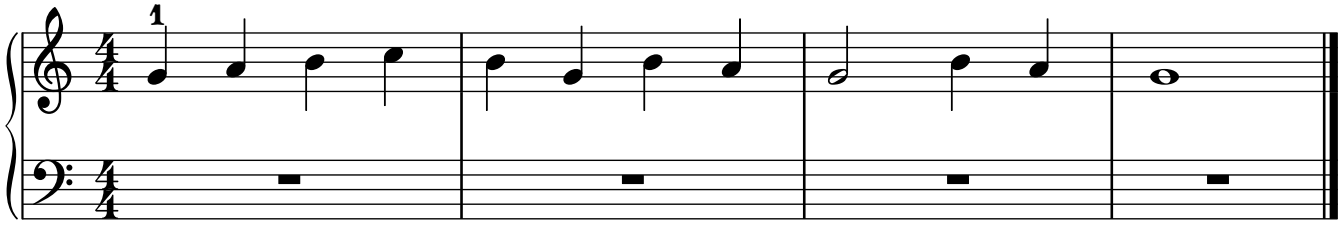
☐ **8.3**



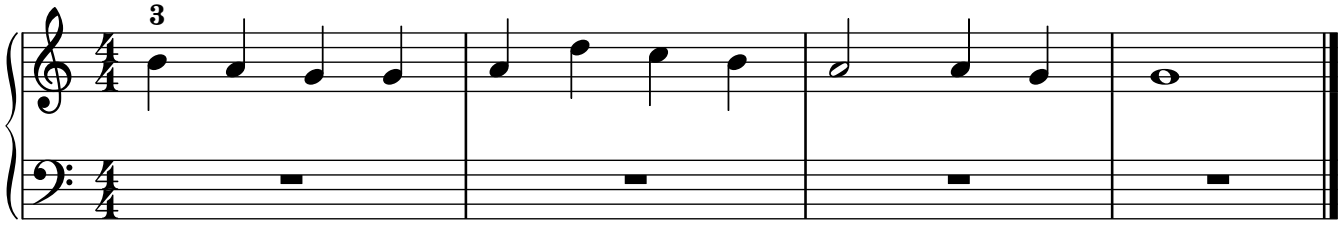
☐ **8.4**



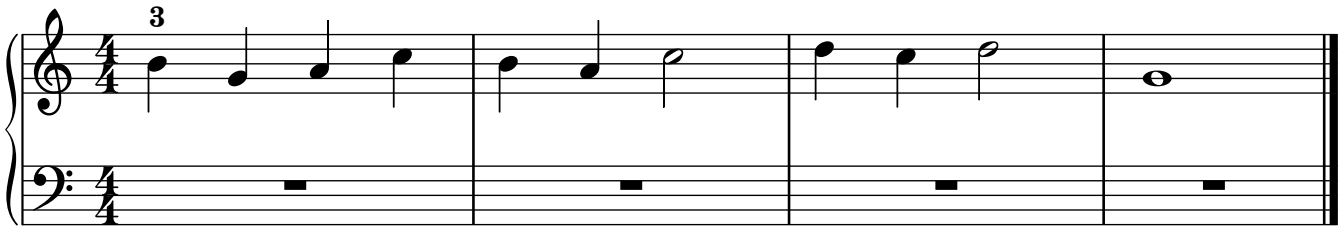
☐ **8.5**



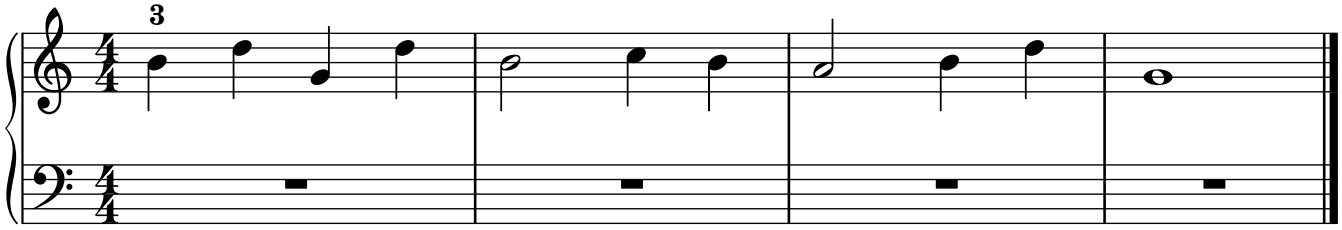
☐ **8.6**



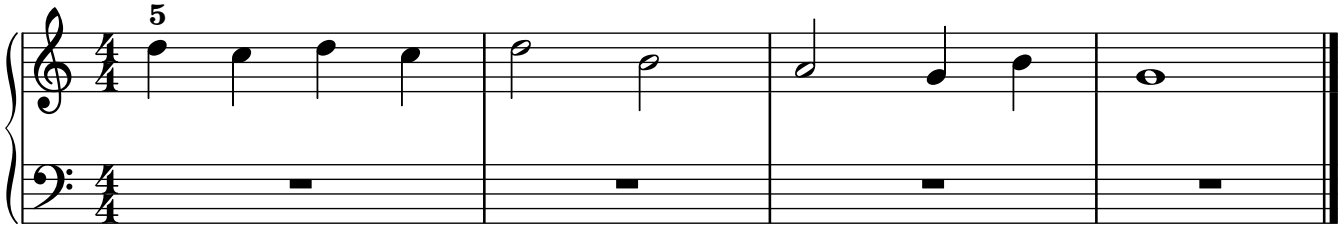
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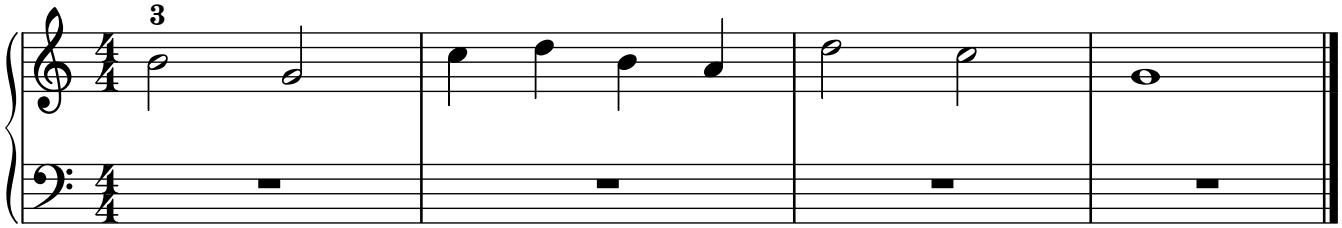
☐ **8.8**



☐ **8.9**



☐ **8.10**



Part B: Hands together in G ♩= 60

Hands together in G position: the left hand holds G (finger 5) or D (finger 1).

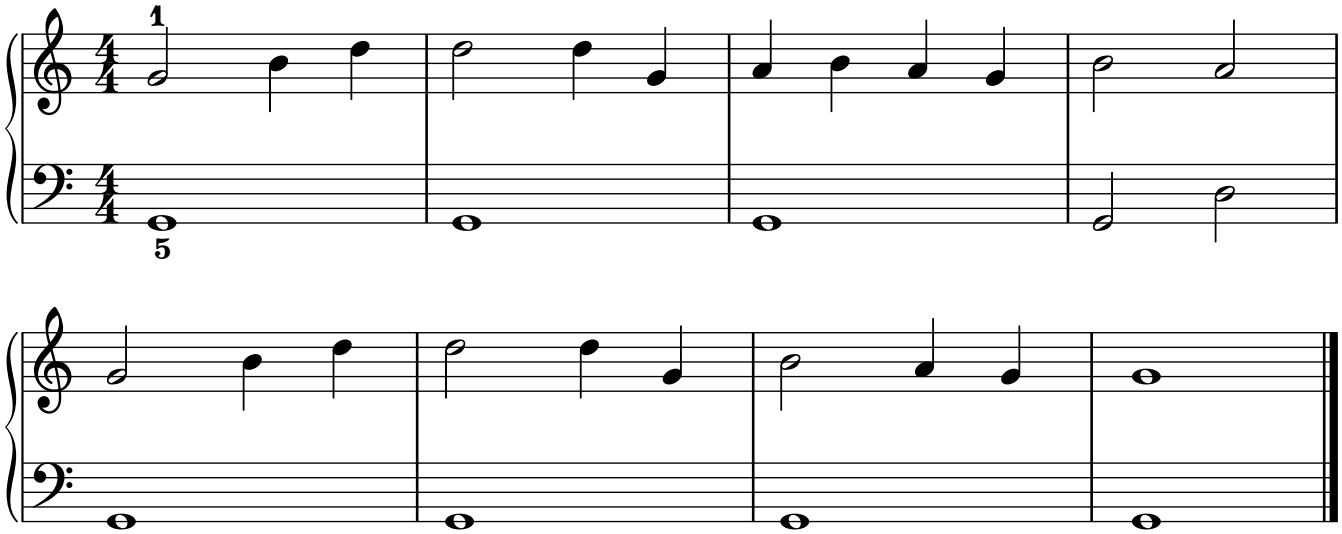
☐ **8.11**



☐ **8.12**



☐ **8.13**



8.14



8.15



8.16



8.17



8.18



8.19



8.20



8.21



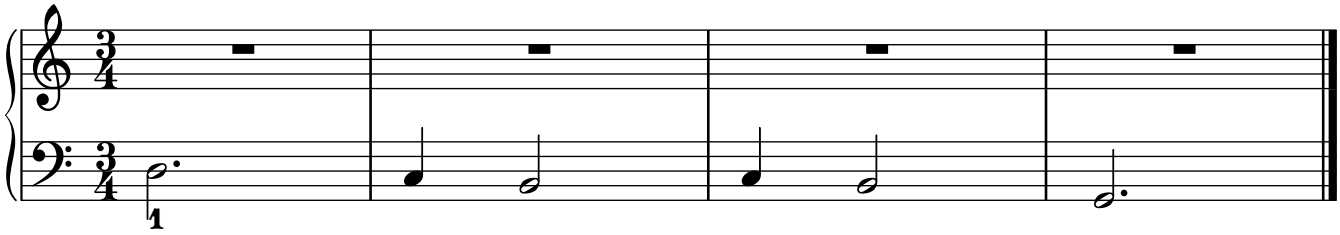
8.22



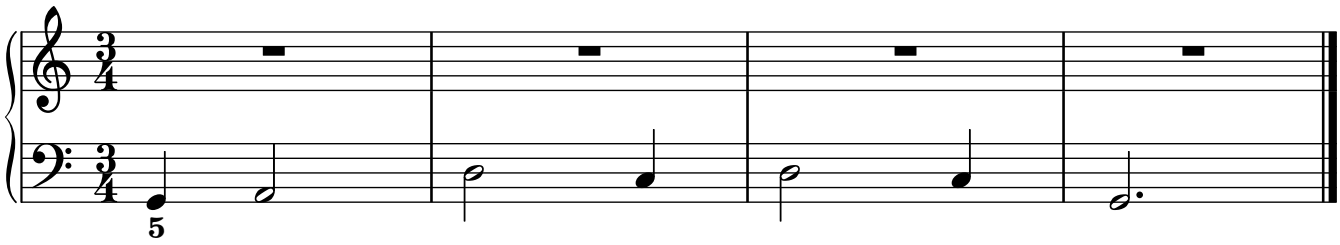
Part C: Left hand in G ♩ = 72

Left hand in G position, in 3/4.

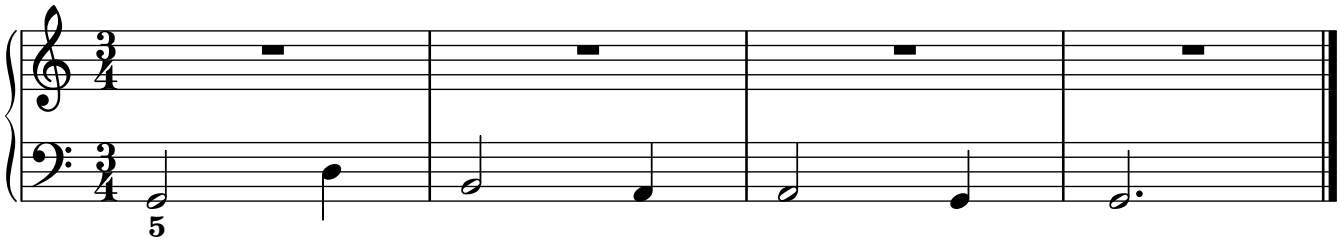
☐ **8.23**



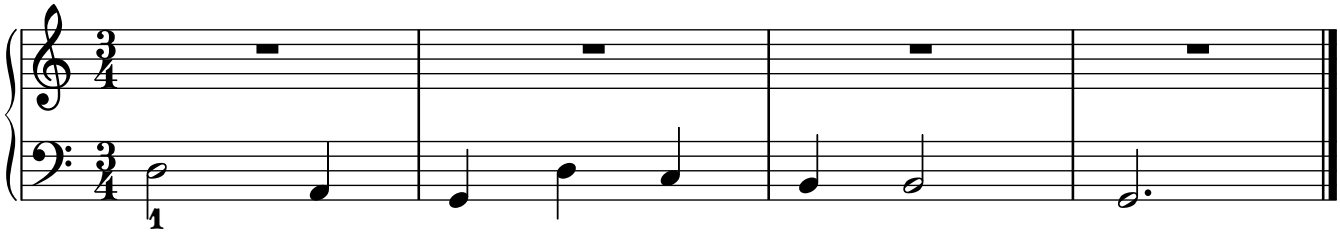
☐ **8.24**



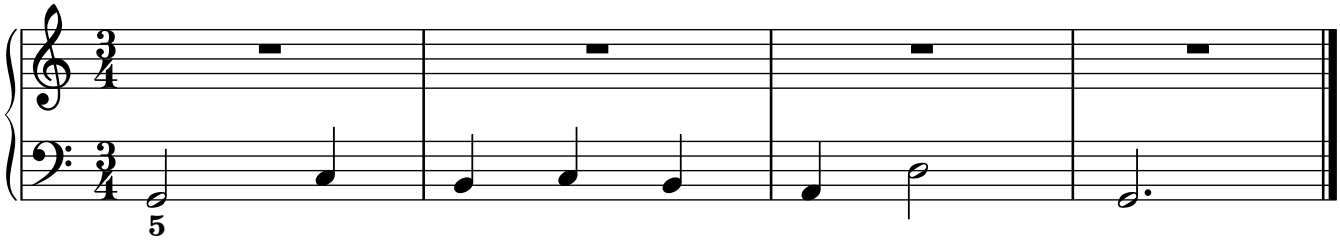
☐ **8.25**



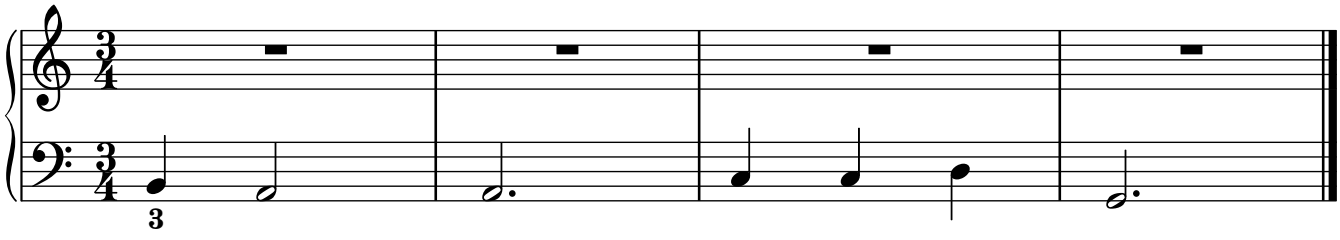
☐ **8.26**



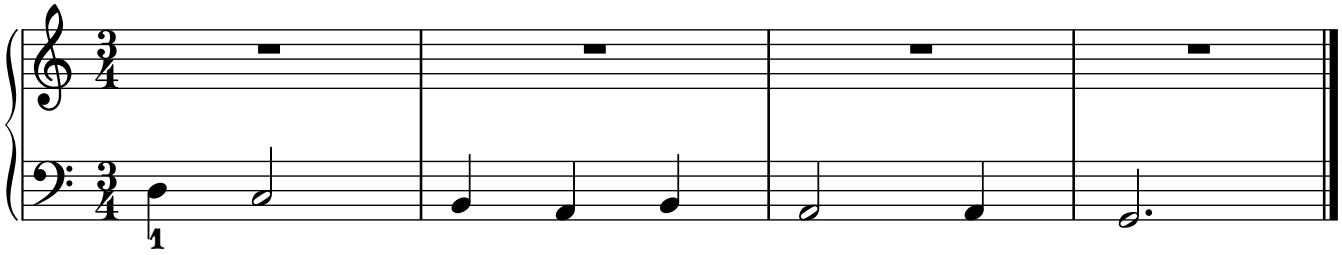
☐ **8.27**



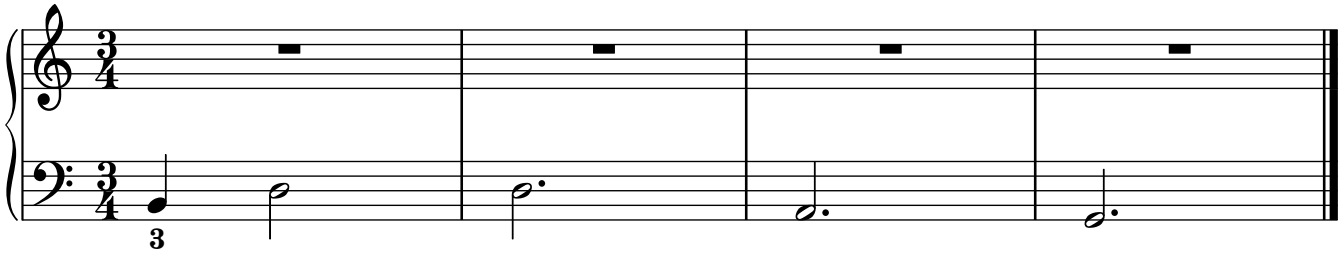
☐ **8.28**



8.29



8.30



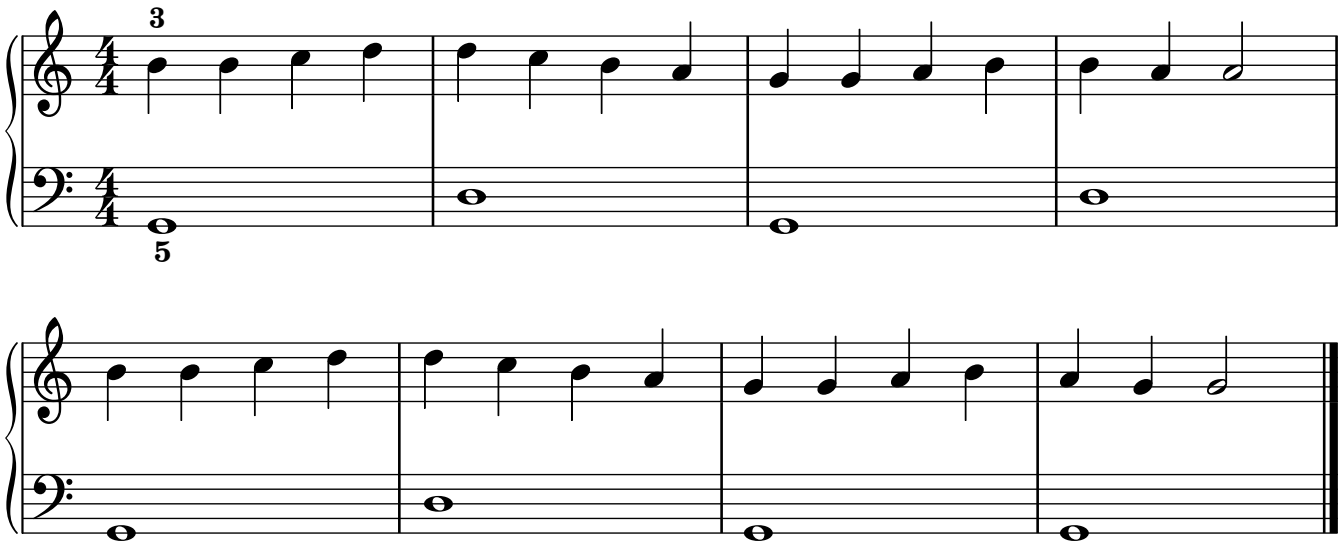
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Ode to Joy in G ♩ = 76

Ludwig van Beethoven (1824), simplified

The tune you know, starting a new position: right thumb on G, so the melody starts with finger 3 on B.



Fanfare ♩ = 80

Original

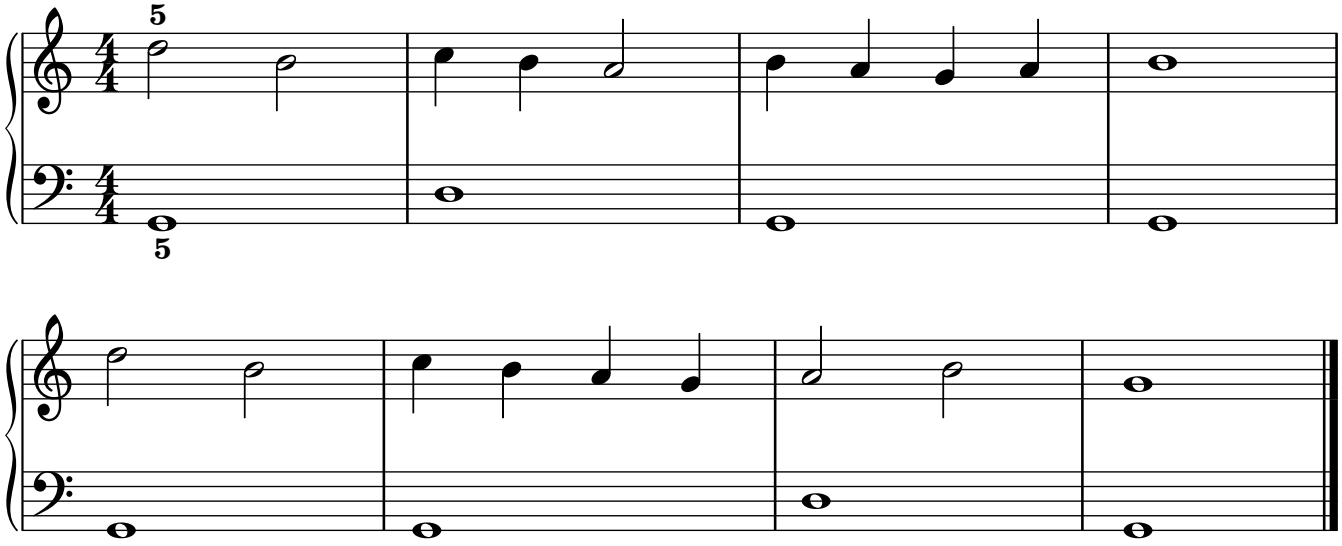
A trumpet call built from 5ths and skips. The left hand plays the same call two octaves lower.



Evening Song in G ♩ = 72

Original

A calm tune that starts with the little finger on D. The bass holds G nearly all the time.



Horn Call ♩ = 84

Original

For the left hand alone: a hunting horn echoing in the low register. The first leap is a 5th, from finger 5 to finger 1.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 9?

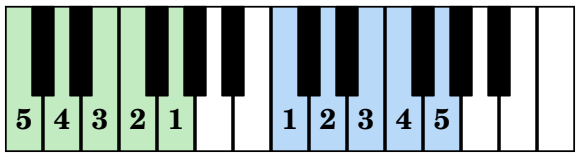
- Play five Part B exercises you have not played before, at 60 beats per minute.
- Pass if you find G position without looking at the keyboard for more than a moment.
- Pass if you play 4ths and 5ths without stopping, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 9.

Unit 9

Eighth Notes

New: Two eighths per beat; counting 1-and-2-and

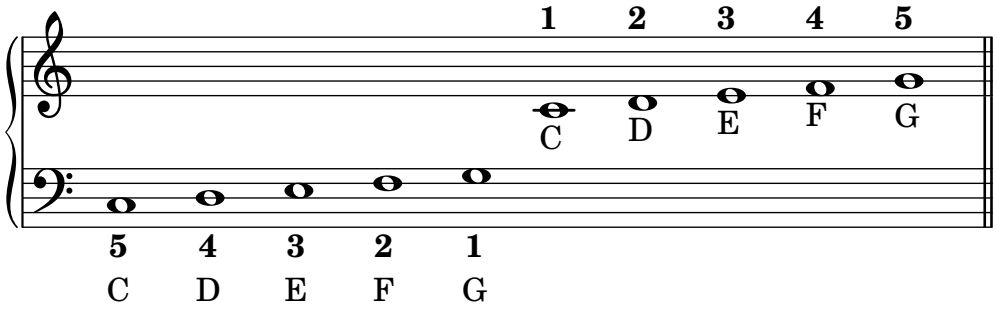
Eighth notes are twice as fast as quarter notes: two of them share one beat. They look like quarter notes with a flag, or joined in pairs by a beam. Back in C position for this unit, so all your attention can go to the new rhythm.



Middle C

Left hand C position and Right hand C position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

The eighth note

Half a beat. A single eighth note has a flag; two or more are usually joined by a beam.

Counting eighths

Say '1 and 2 and 3 and 4 and'. The number falls on the beat and 'and' falls halfway between beats. A pair of eighths is '1-and'.

Even eighths

Both eighths in a pair are the same length. Don't rush the second one.

Beams show the beat

Each beamed pair fills one beat, so beams help you see where the beats fall in the bar.

Reading tips

1. In your 10-second scan, find the eighth-note pairs and count them '1-and' in your head.

2. Keep the metronome slow. Eighths double the number of notes in a beat, not the speed of the beat.

3. Beamed pairs usually step up or down: read the pair as one shape.

4. If you stumble, keep the beat and pick up again on the next click.

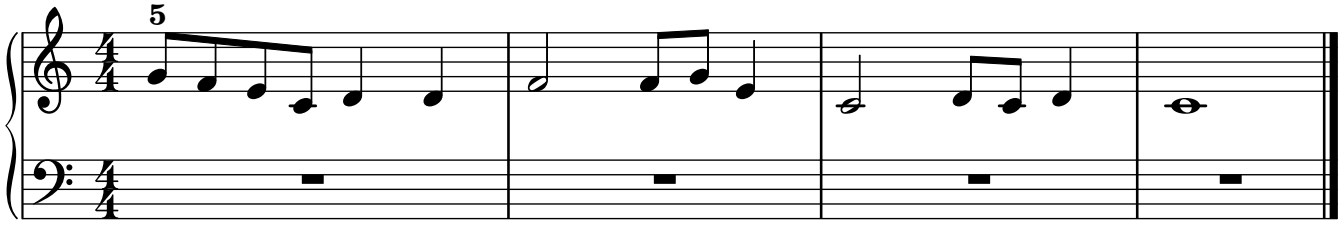
Part A: Eighths in the right hand ♩ = 60

Eighth notes in the right hand. Metronome 60: two eighths for each click.

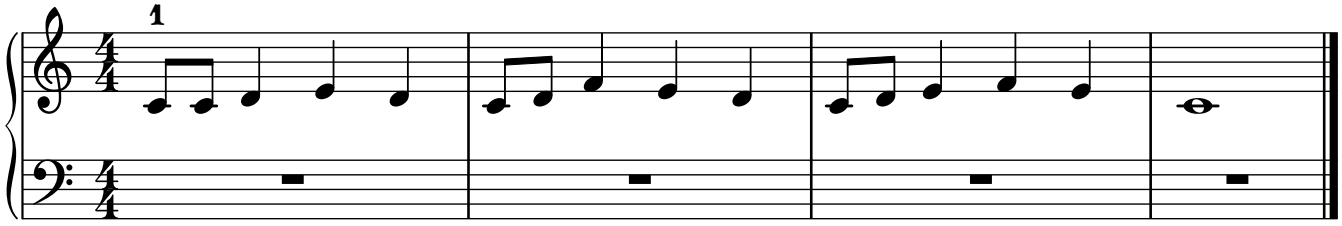
☐ **9.1**



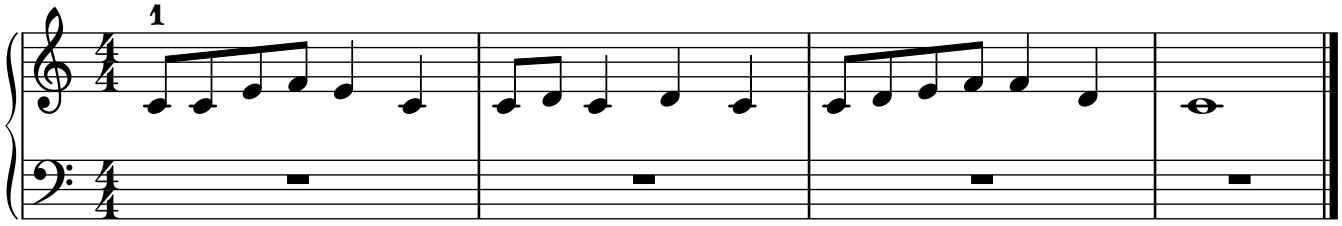
☐ **9.2**



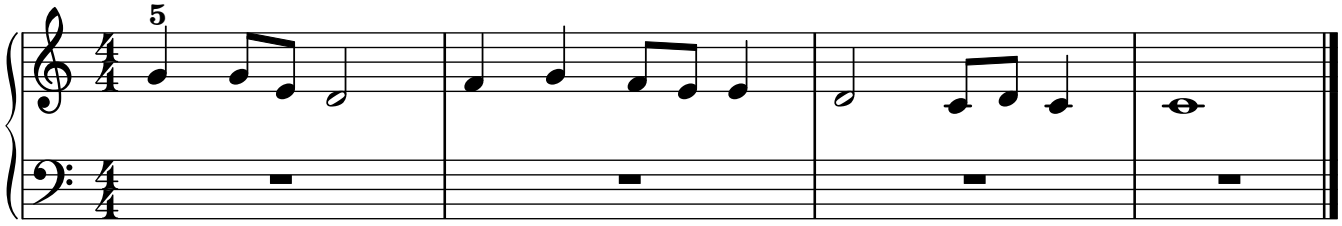
☐ **9.3**



☐ **9.4**



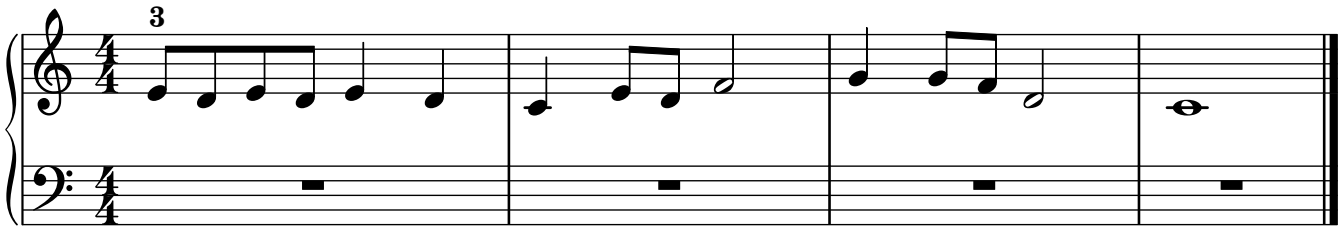
☐ **9.5**



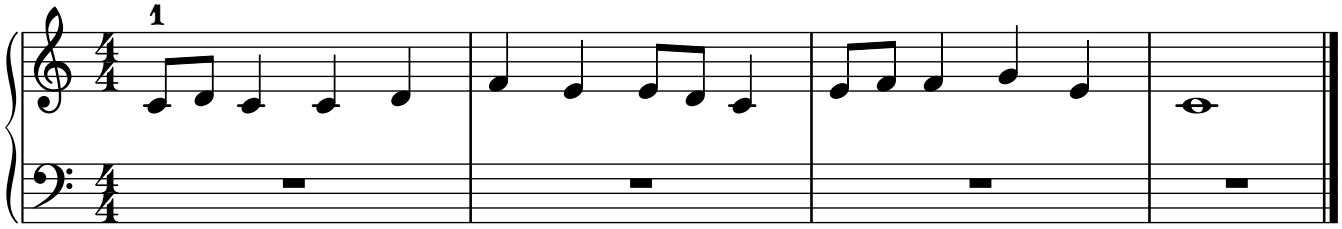
☐ **9.6**



☐ **9.7**



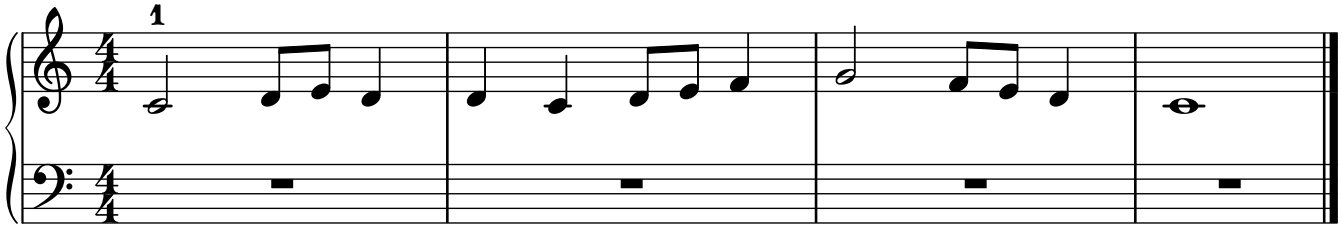
☐ **9.8**



☐ **9.9**



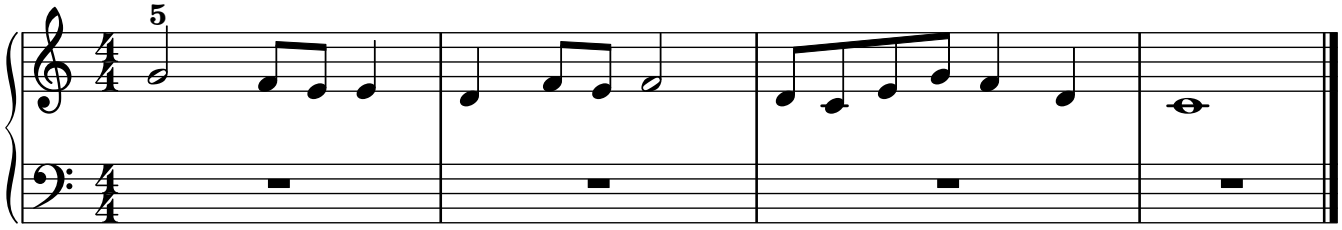
☐ **9.10**



☐ **9.11**



☐ **9.12**



Part B: Eighths, hands together ♩ = 60

Hands together: eighths on top, half notes in the bass.

☐ **9.13**



☐ **9.14**



☐ **9.15**



9.16



9.17



9.18



☐ **9.19**



☐ **9.20**



☐ **9.21**



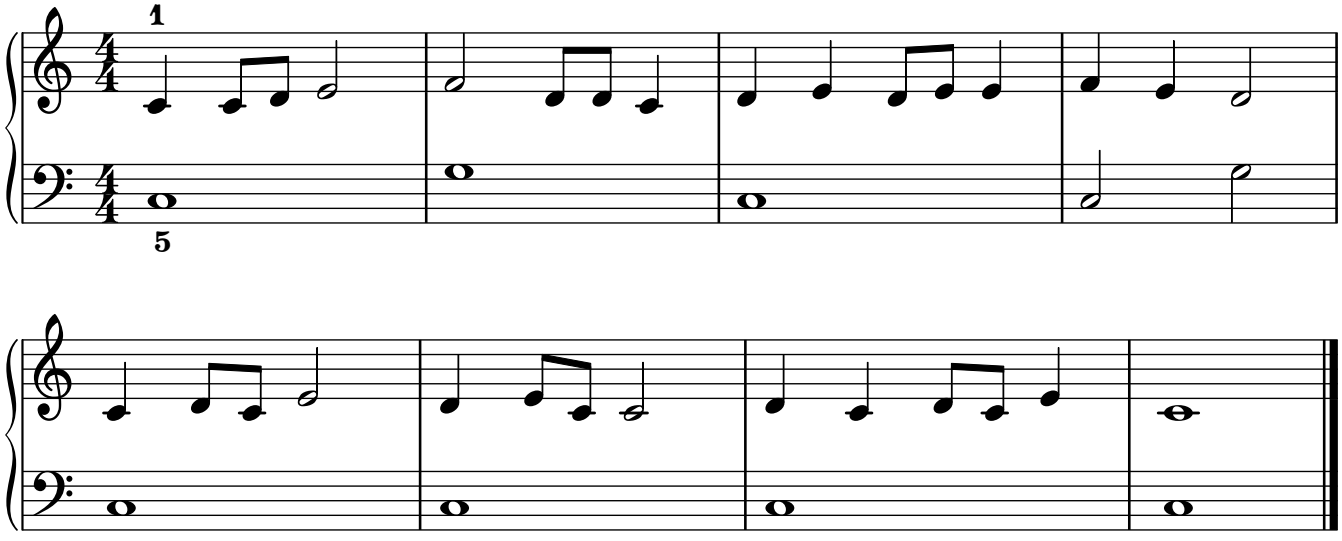
☐ **9.22**



☐ **9.23**



☐ **9.24**



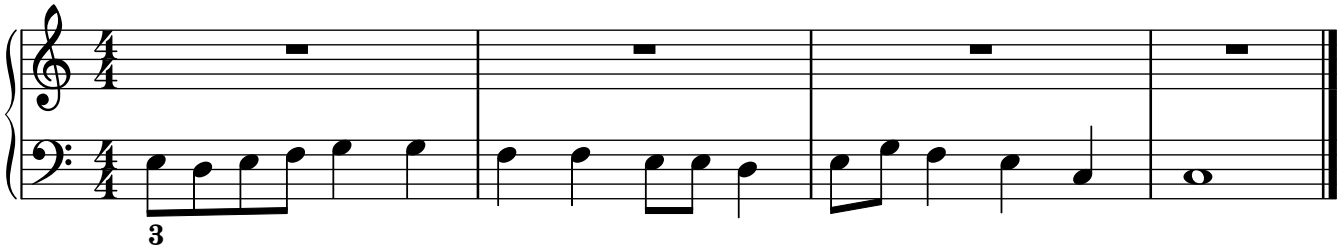
Part C: Eighths in the left hand ♩= 60

Eighth notes in the left hand.

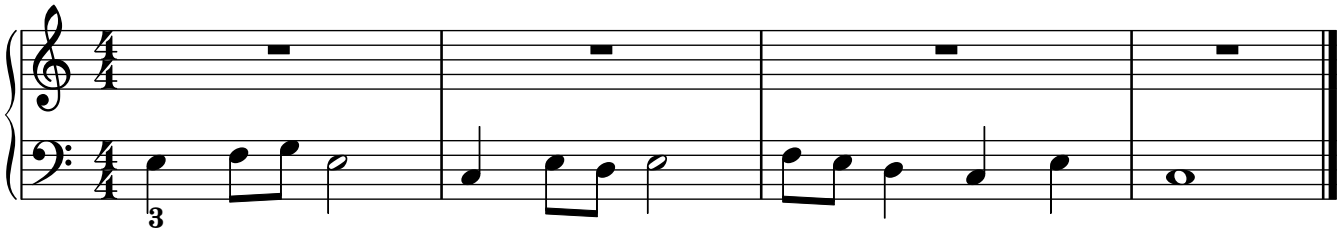
☐ **9.25**



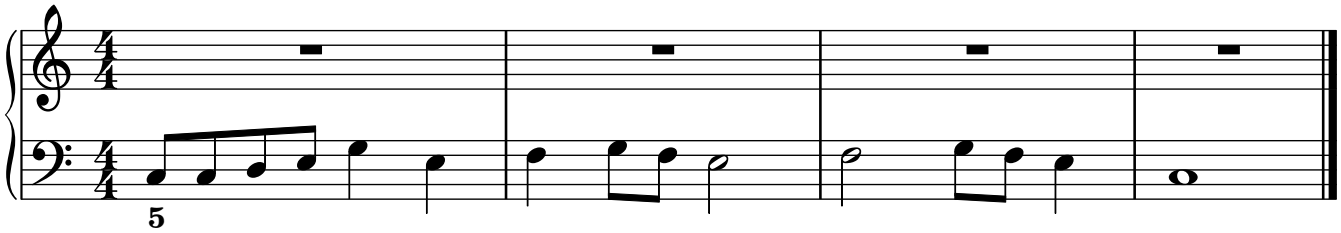
☐ **9.26**



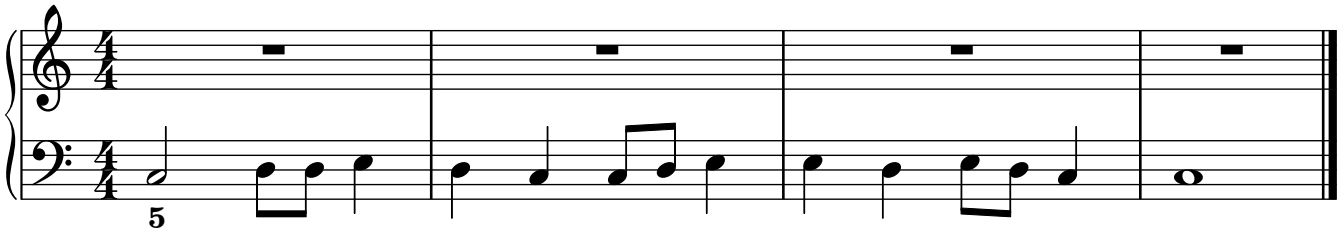
☐ **9.27**



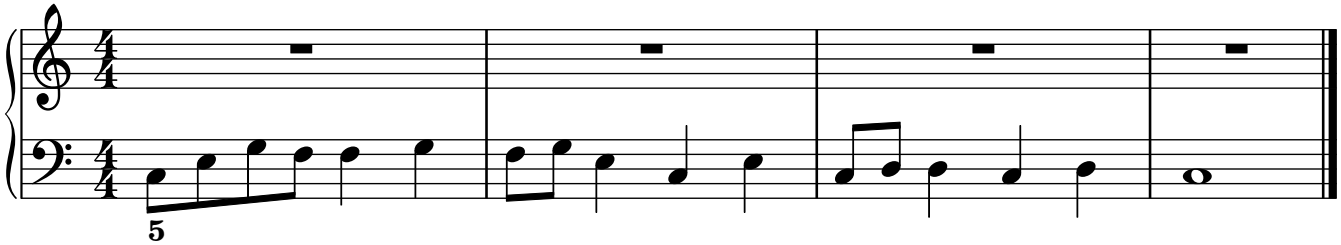
☐ **9.28**



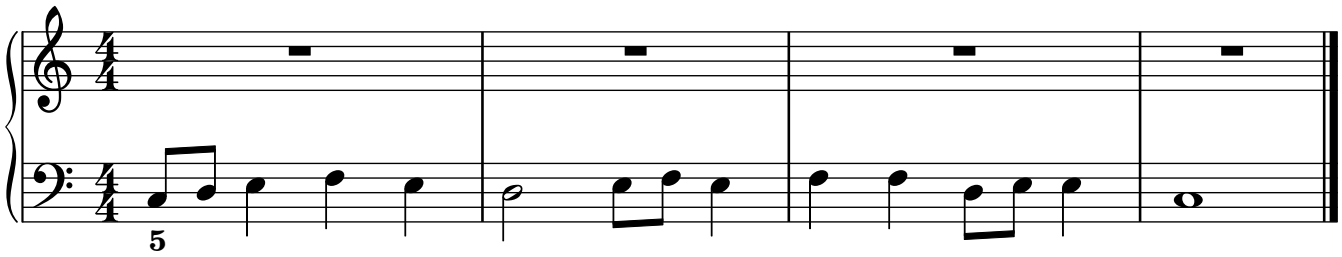
☐ **9.29**



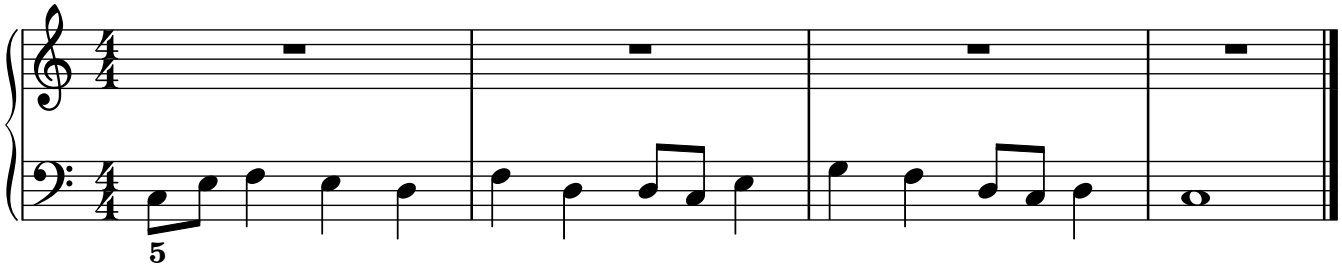
☐ **9.30**



9.31



9.32



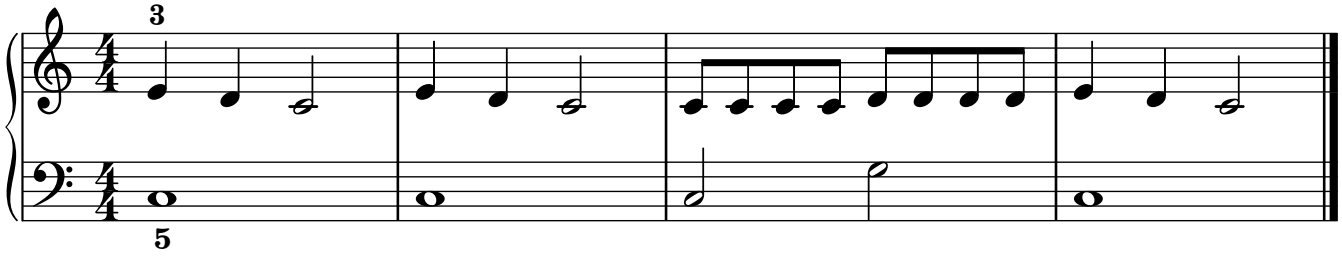
Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Hot Cross Buns (real rhythm) ♩ = 72

Traditional

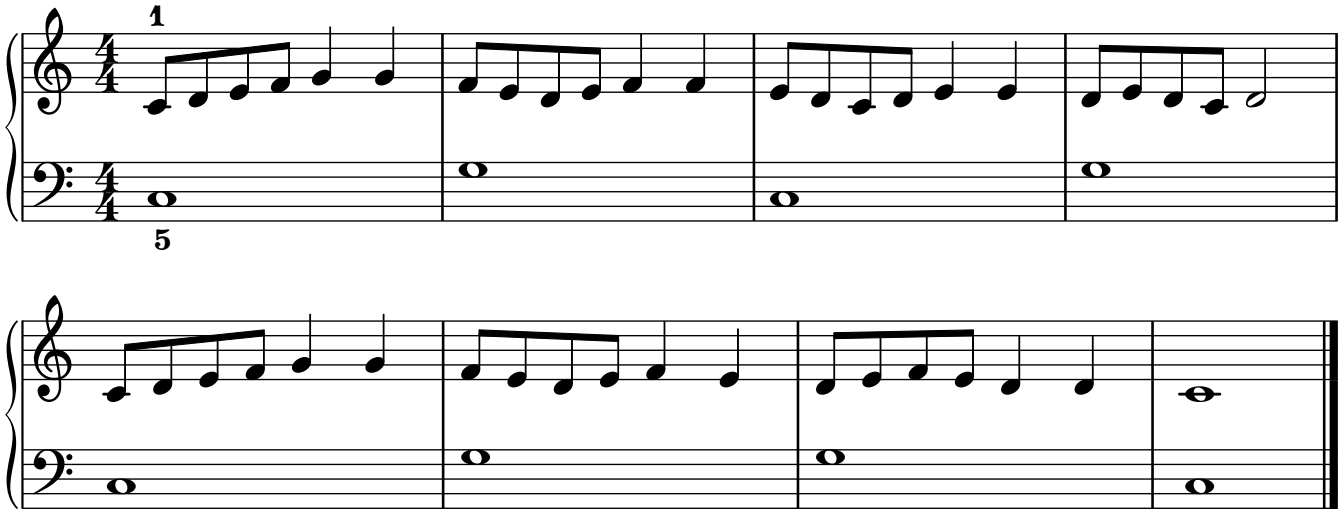
Now bar 3 has its real rhythm: 'one a pen-ny, two a pen-ny', four eighths on C, then four on D.



Running Water ♩ = 66

Original

Four eighths run up or down, then two quarters rest the stream. Keep the eighths even.



Little Dance ♩ = 80

Original

A waltz with an eighth-note pair on beat 2. Count '1, 2-and, 3'.



Jingle Bells (chorus) ♩ = 92

James Lord Pierpont (1857), simplified

Sixteen bars on four lines. Bar 3 has a 5th, from G down to C, and bars 6 and 14 end with an eighth-note pair.



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 10?

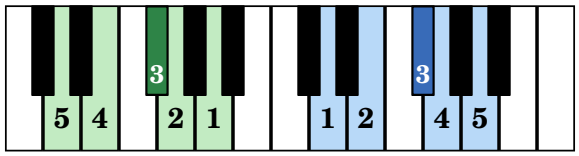
- Play five Part B exercises you have not played before, at 60 beats per minute.
- Pass if the eighth notes stay even and the beat never speeds up.
- Pass if you play no more than one stop per exercise, and at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 10, the last unit of Volume 1.

Unit 10

Sharps, Flats and Review

New: Sharps, flats and key signatures (D and F positions); review of Units 1-9

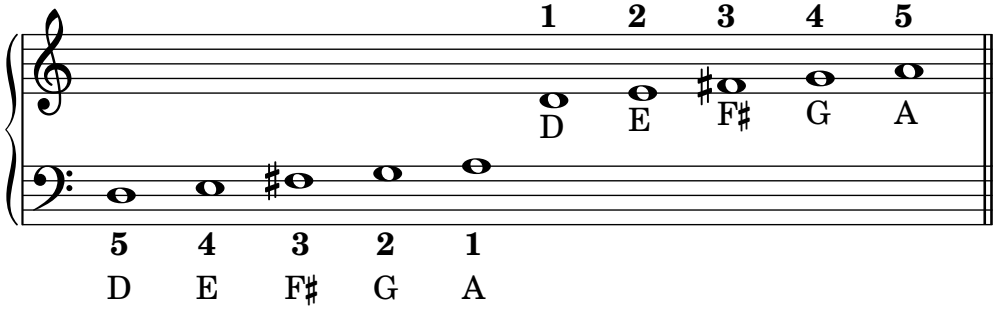
Until now you have played only white keys. Sharps and flats take you to the black keys. This unit adds two new positions that each use one black key, and shows how a key signature tells you about it once, for the whole piece. The unit ends with a review of everything in Volume 1.

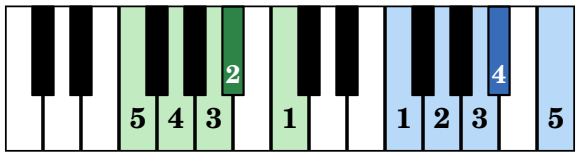


Middle C

Left hand D position and Right hand D position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes

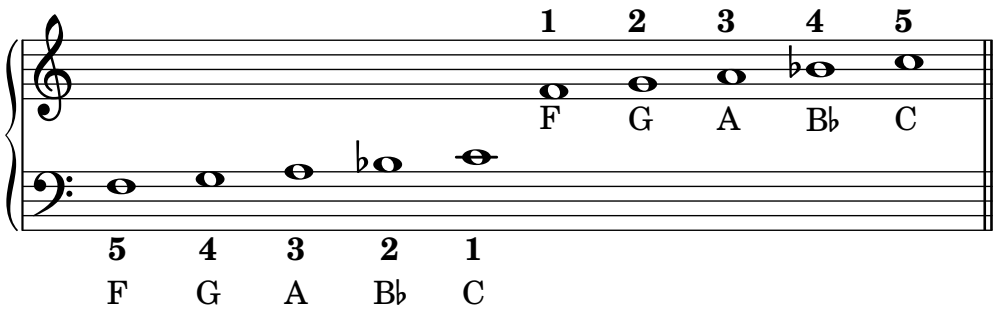




Middle C

Left hand F position and Right hand F position (green: left hand, blue: right hand)

Your notes



What is new

Sharp

A sharp sign before a note means: play the very next key to the right (higher), usually a black key. F-sharp is the black key between F and G.

Flat

A flat sign means: play the very next key to the left (lower). B-flat is the black key between A and B.

Natural

A natural sign cancels a sharp or flat: play the white key.

How long an accidental lasts

A sharp, flat or natural written in front of a note lasts until the end of that bar.

Key signature

Sharps or flats at the start of every line apply to every note with that letter name, all the way through the piece. D major has F-sharp and C-sharp; F major has B-flat.

The two new positions

D position is D E F-sharp G A, with finger 3 on the black key. F position is F G A B-flat C, with finger 4 on the black key.

Reading tips

1. Check the key signature first; it is now part of your 10-second scan.

2. In D position, finger 3 sits on the black key F-sharp and stays there, so every F is automatically F-sharp.

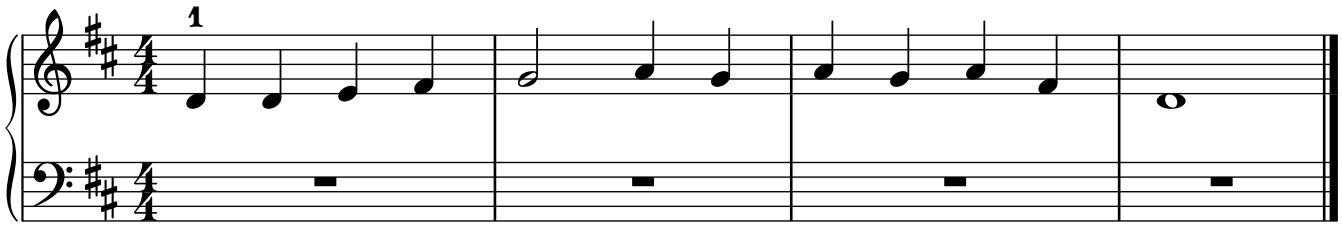
3. In F position, finger 4 sits on B-flat. Put it there before you start.

4. The review part mixes everything: rests, ties, eighths, skips and 5ths. Scan for each before you play.

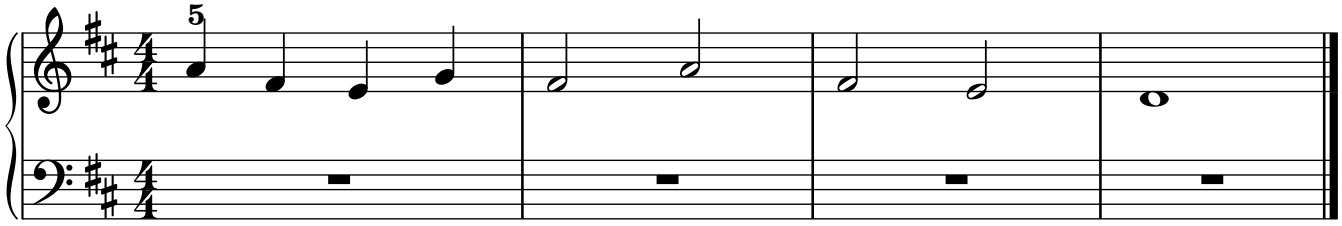
Part A: D position: F-sharp ♩= 60

Right hand in D position, with the D major key signature. Metronome 60.

☐ **10.1**



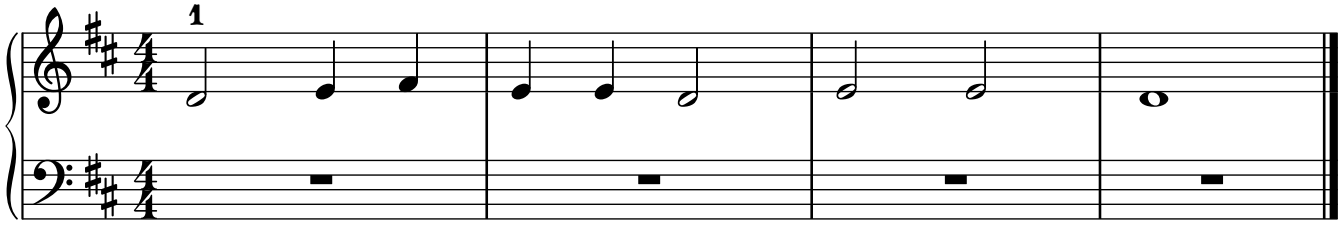
☐ **10.2**



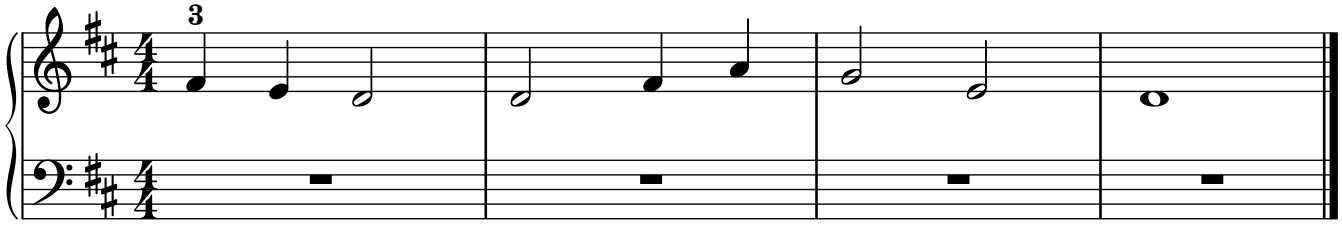
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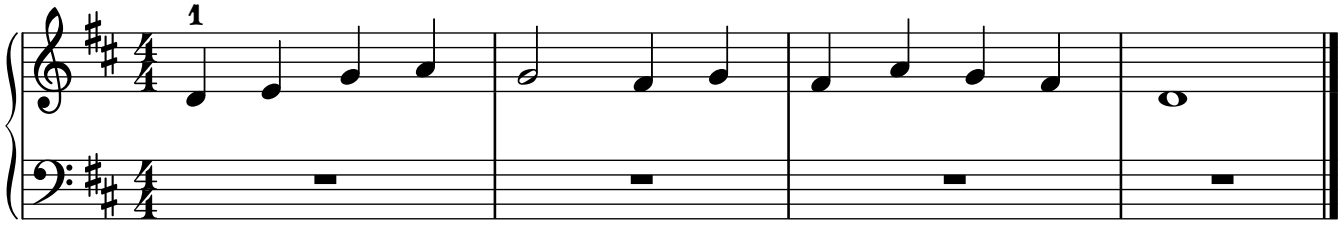
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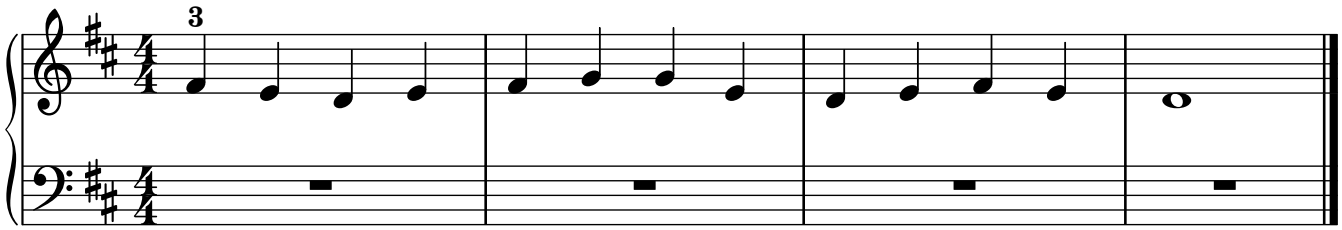
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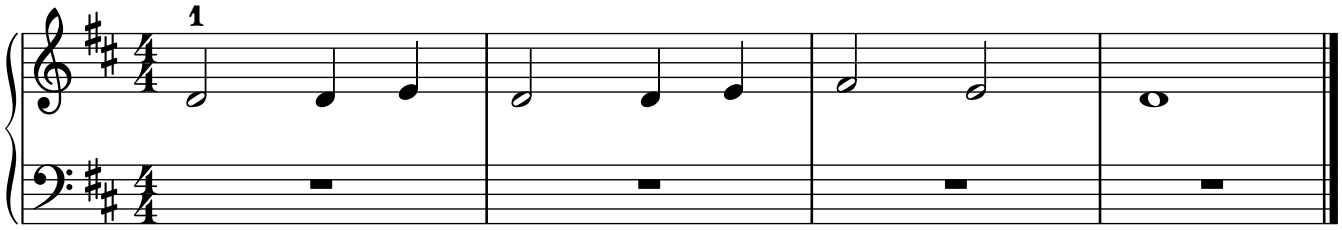
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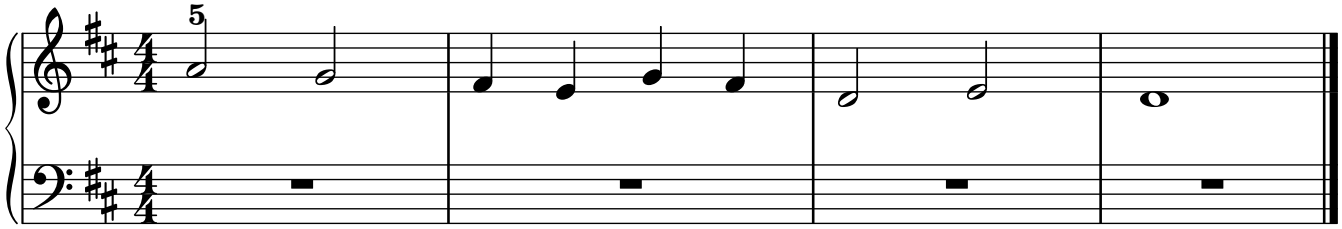
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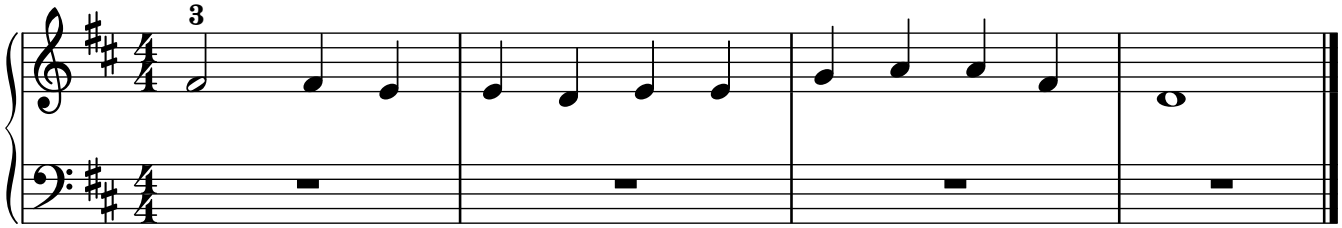
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☐ **10.9**



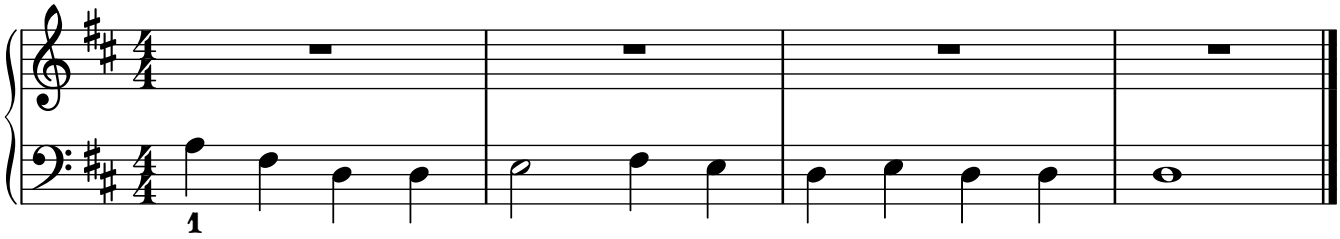
☐ **10.10**



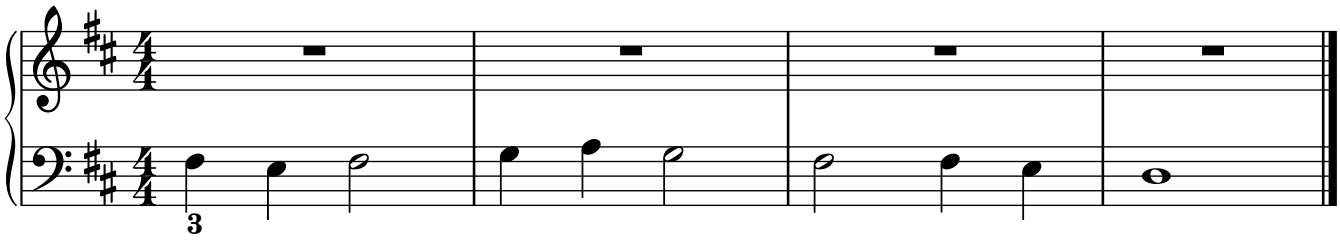
Part B: D position, left hand ♩ = 60

Left hand in D position. Bass D is the middle line, and F-sharp is the fourth line.

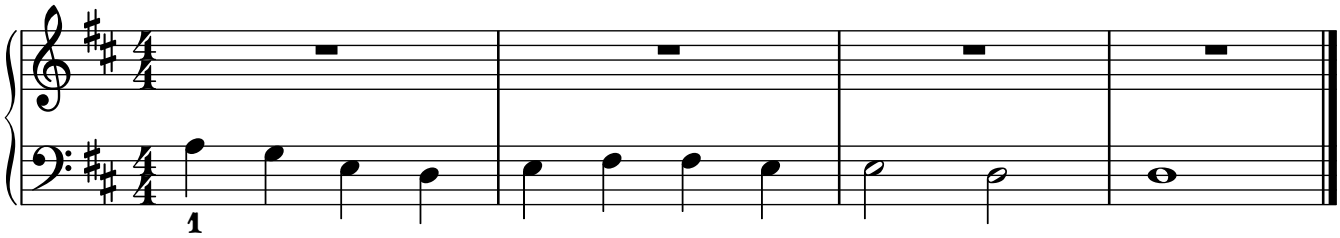
☐ **10.11**



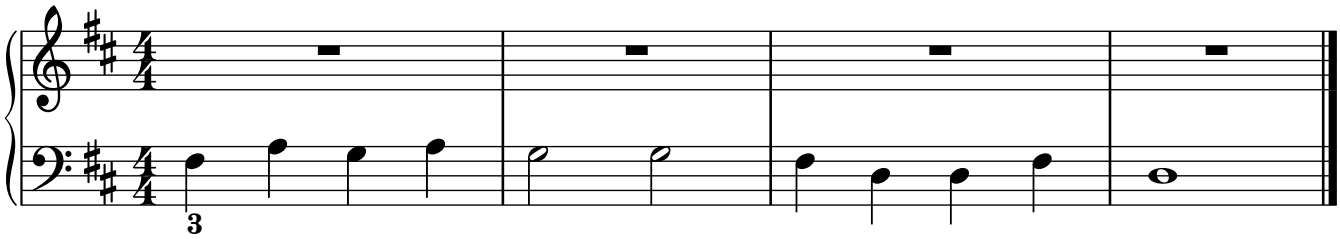
☐ **10.12**



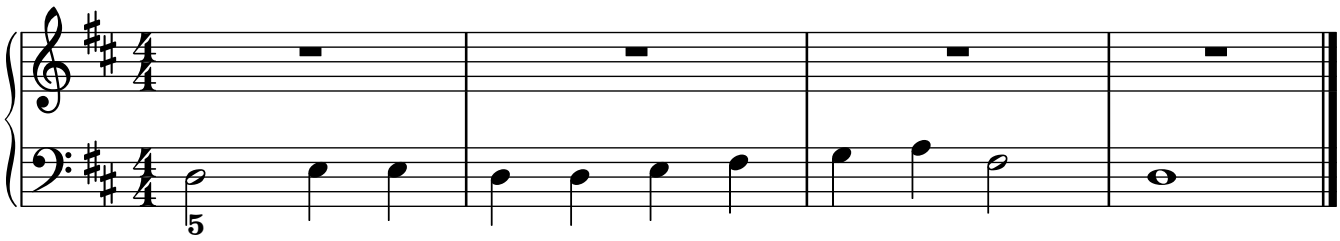
☐ **10.13**



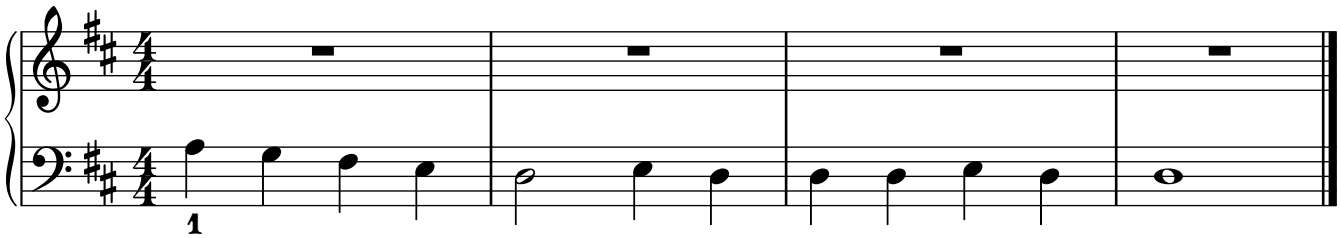
☐ **10.14**



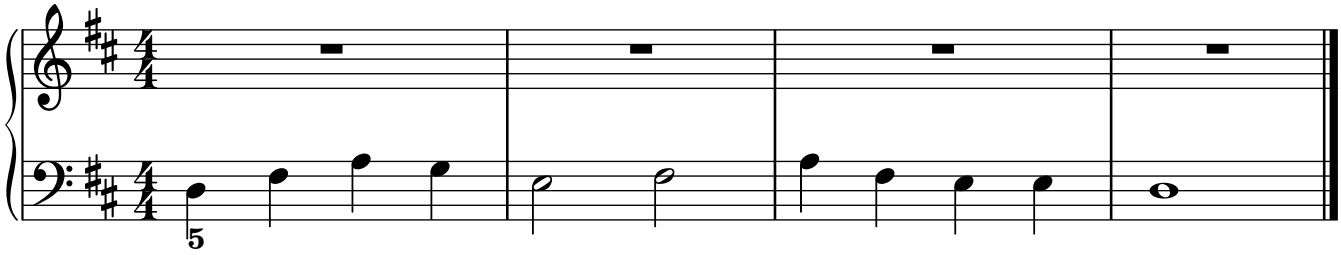
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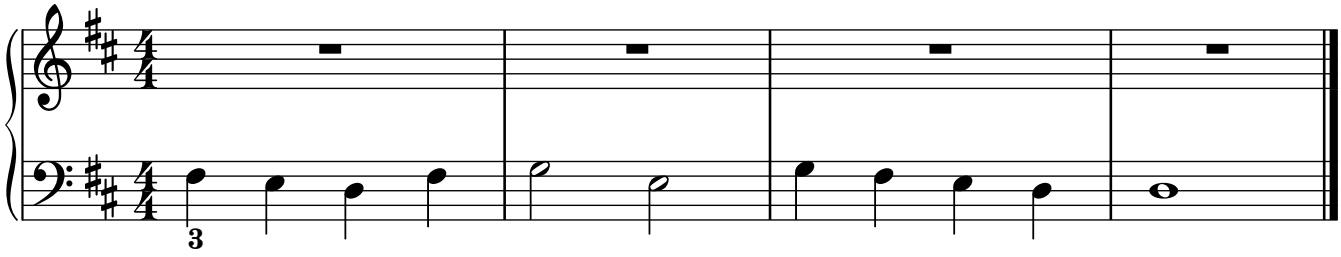
☐ **10.16**



10.17



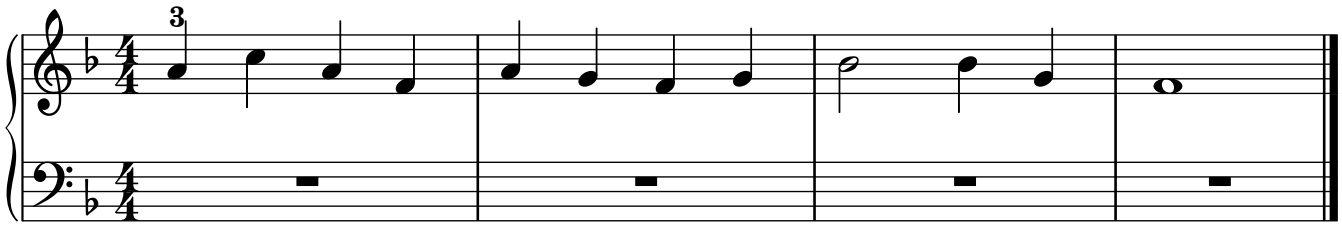
10.18



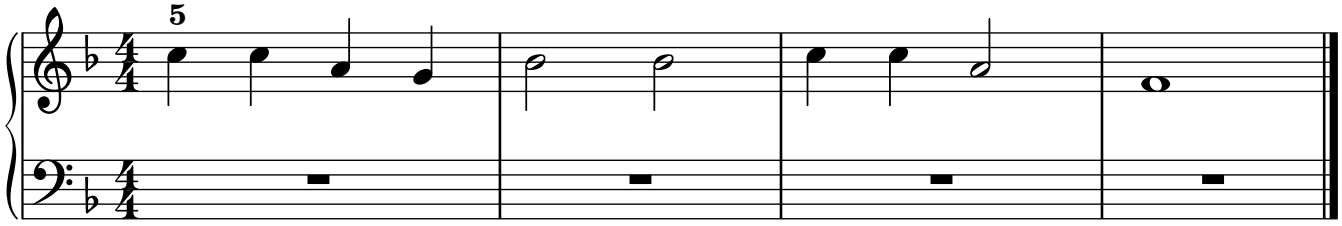
Part C: F position: B-flat ♩ = 60

Right hand in F position, with the F major key signature (B-flat).

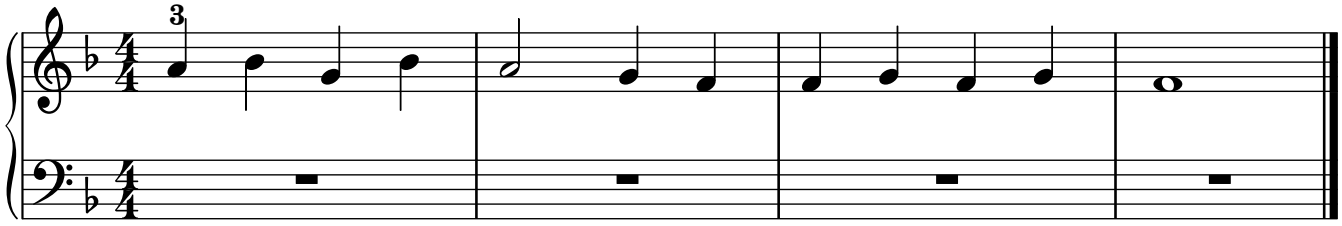
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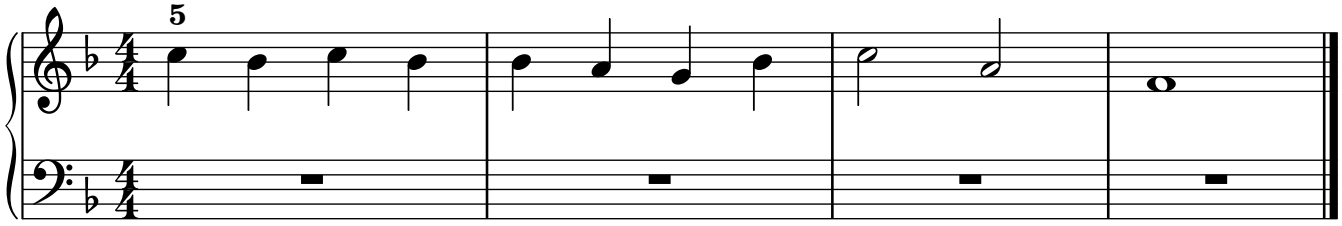
☐ **10.20**



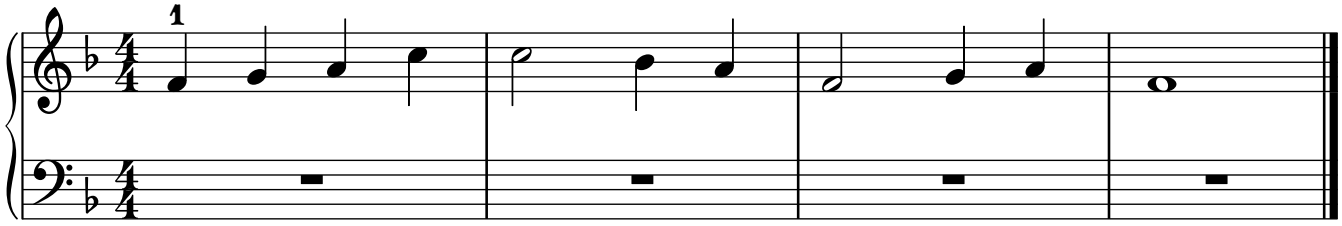
☐ **10.21**



☐ **10.22**



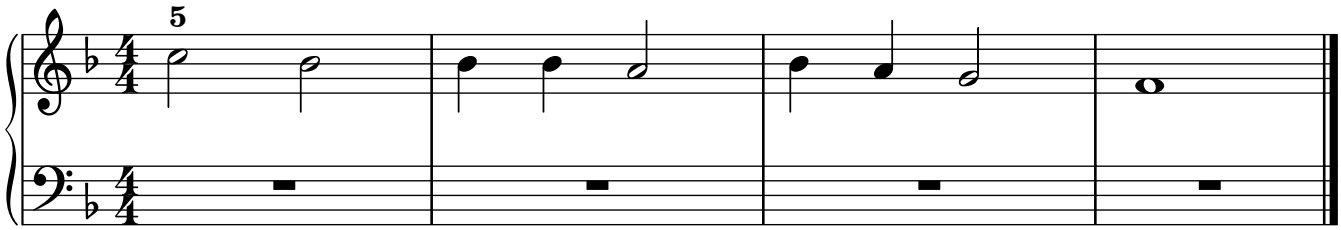
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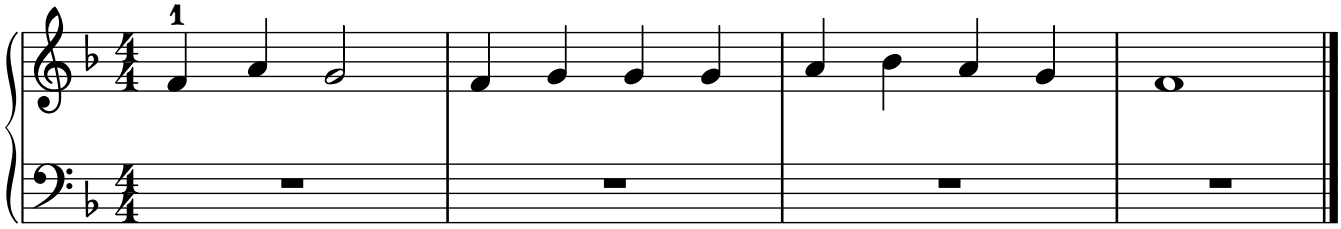
☐ **10.24**



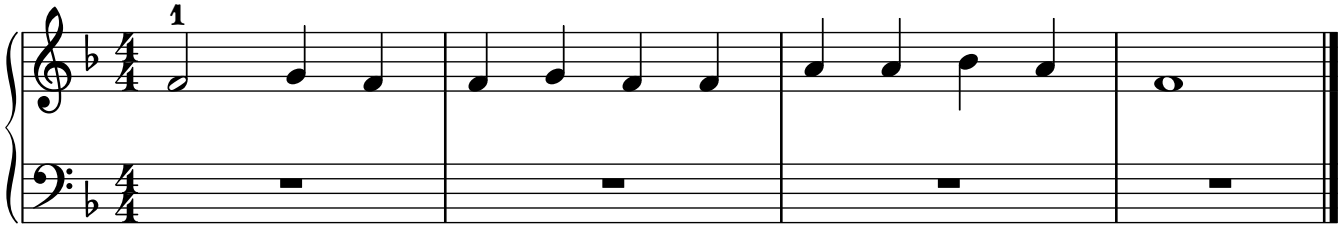
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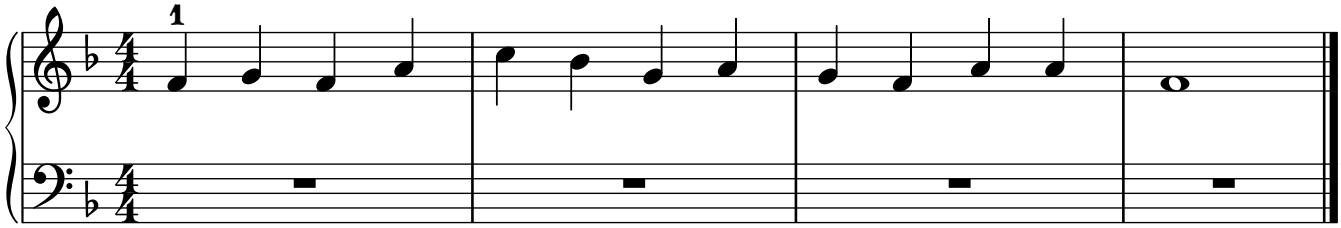
☐ **10.26**



☐ **10.27**



☐ **10.28**



Part D: Review: everything together ♩ = 60

Review: hands together in C position, using everything from Volume 1.

☐ **10.29**



☐ **10.30**



☐ **10.31**



10.32



10.33



10.34



10.35



10.36



10.37



10.38



Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Au clair de la lune in D ♩ = 76

Traditional French song (opening)

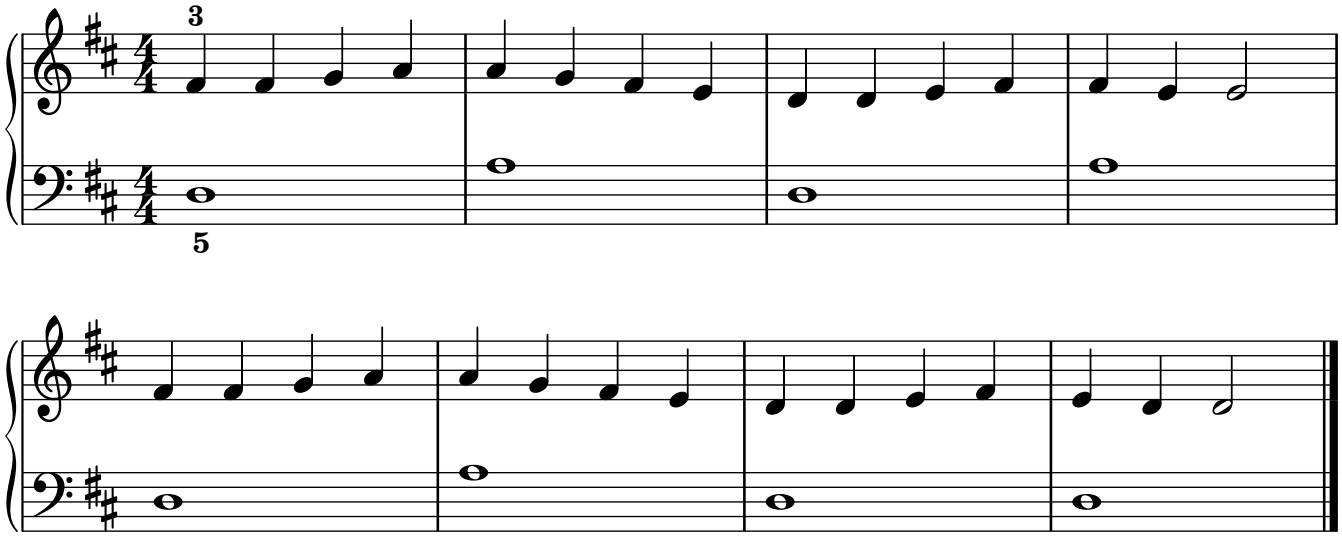
The tune from Unit 4, now in D position: every F is F-sharp because of the key signature.



Ode to Joy in D ♩ = 76

Ludwig van Beethoven (1824), simplified

Finger 3 starts on the black key F-sharp. The bass alternates D (finger 5) and A (finger 1).



Song in F ♩ = 72

Original

Finger 4 plays B-flat every time. The bass alternates F (finger 5) and middle C (finger 1).



Farewell Waltz ♩ = 84

Original

A goodbye to Volume 1, using skips, a 4th, eighths, a tie and a rest. Scan for each one before you play.



Checkpoint: ready for Volume 2?

- Play five Part D review exercises you have not played before, at 60 beats per minute.
- Pass if you keep the beat going with no more than one stop per exercise, and never miss the key signature in Parts A-C.
- Pass if at least 9 notes out of 10 are right.
- When you pass, you have finished Volume 1. If one skill keeps tripping you up, go back to its unit and read some Part C exercises again.